

***The Home Group - Our Responsibility
and Link to A.A.'s Future***

**THE FORTIETH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

***1990
Final Report***

Omni Park Central Hotel, New York City, April 22 — 28

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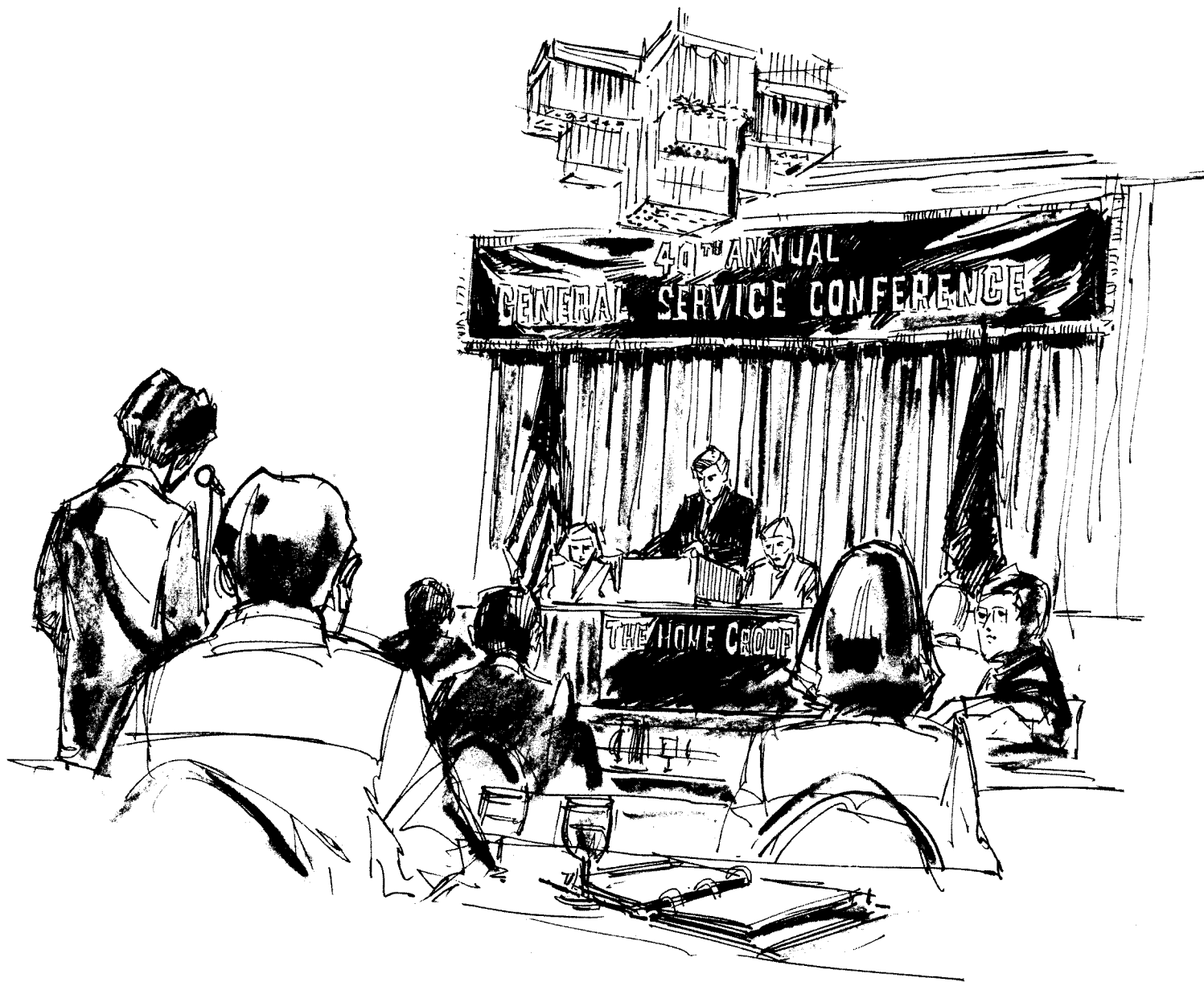
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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses, just as A.A. directories do.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



“The Home Group— Our Responsibility and Link to A.A.’s Future”

“... a ‘place of refuge’ ... ‘a haven’ ... the ‘basic unit of the Fellowship’ ... ‘a microcosm of the whole of A.A.’; ... ‘the key to A.A. survival.’”

These comments are from a workshop based on the theme of the 40th A.A. General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous—“The Home Group—Our Responsibility and Link to A.A.’s Future.” Held April 22-28, at the Omni Park Central Hotel in New York City, A.A.’s week-long business meeting is made up of 135 Conference members; delegates from the 91 service areas of the United States and Canada, Class A (nonalcoholic) and Class B (alcoholic) trustees, and directors and staff of the two corporations, Alcoholics Anonymous World Services and the Grapevine. The 40th Conference was co-chaired by Michael Alexander, chairman of the General Service Board, and Wayne Parks, G.S.O.’s general manager. General Service staff member Eileen Gatza was Conference coordinator.

Conference week began Sunday afternoon with a reception and registration, where Conference members received their bright yellow binders, packed with agendas, reports, financial information and much more. A brief program followed. In his opening remarks, chairman of the board Michael Alexander stressed to Conference members the need to be flexible in considering items for Conference Actions, and asked that they not make every suggestion into an Action, but leave some leeway for the persons responsible for executing these Actions. The Conference, Mike told the audience, “is the active voice and conscience of the Fellowship,” and, quoting the late chairman of the board Bernard Smith, the “preserving arm of this great Society that is ours.”

The calling of the roll by general manager Wayne Parks marked the formal opening of the 40th General Service Conference. Following greetings from Conference delegate chairperson Reba Warren of Eastern Pennsylvania, (see page 6), Eileen Gatza reviewed some of the mechanics of Conference week, and the Conference Manual and agenda.

Sunday evening an A.A. meeting, chaired by Robert Barros (Arkansas), followed the opening dinner. Karen Norbert (Southern Wisconsin) led the meeting. Speakers were: Ann White (Washington, D.C.), Gareth Davis (Northwest Ontario), Vicente Mejía (G.S.O. staff), Jane Murphy Schulberg (Grapevine director) and Jan Whitney (East Central regional trustee).

Monday morning’s session began with the keynote address by Eastern Canada trustee Tom Hills (see page 7). Throughout the busy week presentations/discussions covered The Importance of the Home Group; Finance; Self-support; General Service Trustee and Sponsorship (see page 16). Interspersed throughout the general session new delegates of Panel 40 gave Area Service Highlights (see page 48).

In the General Service Board Report Monday morning, board chairman Michael Alexander spoke of the challenges facing the Fellowship in the 1990s. The budget for 1990 has been “picked clean” and “with a lean budget we are in good shape.” He asked that A.A.s look at our primary purpose of delivering the A.A. message to those still suffering—only one half of newcomers stay at least three months. “Isn’t there something we can do to improve this?” he asked. Mike pointed out that the traditional contribution that goes into the basket is \$1—but that “30 and 35 years ago it was also \$1.” “I’ve raised questions,” Mike told Conference members, “if you agree that they are relevant, let’s find answers this week.” (See also page 28.)

Enthusiasm ran high Monday evening when a progress report was given on the upcoming 1990 International Convention in Seattle. The session was moderated by trustee Ruth Jagodzinski,

who chairs the trustees’ International Convention Committee. Lois Fisher, G.S.O. staff member who is the coordinator of the International, and Lonnie Williams, delegate from the state of Washington, each gave informative reports. Following these presentations all assembled were given a pink and green enameled pin of the Seattle Space Needle, a memento of A.A.’s 55th Birthday celebration.

Two “What’s on Your Mind?” sharing sessions were held during Conference week, during which many topics of interest to Conference members were discussed. Questions and sharing covered were: the A.A.W.S./Intergroup Seminar; that conferences and conventions holding A.A. meetings are in keeping with A.A. Traditions; the General Service Office; anonymity breaks; and the agreement to move the site of the 41st and 42nd Conferences to Rye, New York.

Wednesday afternoon the Conference elected two new regional trustees. Greg Muth, of Kaneohe, Hawaii (a former Panel 37 delegate) will become the first trustee from the 50th state, replacing Ruth Jagodzinski as Pacific U.S. regional trustee. Marc Pineau, of Iberville, Quebec, will be the first French Canadian in 12 years to represent the Eastern Canada region. Marc, a Panel 36 delegate, replaces Tom Hills. New general service trustee will be Jean Smith, of New York City. Jean is no stranger to the board, having served as an A.A.W.S. director since 1987.

One of the important issues on the agenda was the report of the Ad Hoc Committee on Group Registration and A.A. Directories, which was established by a 1989 Conference Floor Action to review the handling of A.A. directory listings and group registration. The committee, which met several times during the last year, gave their report and recommendations, suggesting that the group information forms and directories contain the six points definition of an A.A. group as listed in “The A.A. Group” pamphlet (another agenda item up for complete revision). A long discussion on the six points followed and the Conference could not reach unanimity on the recommendation. As a result, the Conference Literature Committee met with the Ad Hoc Committee, and reported back to the Conference. The final recommendations were accepted and all present witnessed first-hand the spirit of our Traditions in action. (See Advisory Actions 2, 3, 4 & 5, page 10.)

Each morning the General Service Conference Serenity Group met at 7:30 in the Forum Room Lounge for an open A.A. meeting. Chairing the meeting was Frances Cherry (South Florida/Bahamas/V.I.). Secretary/treasurer was Reba Warren (Eastern Pennsylvania). A different delegate led the meeting each morning, with discussion revolving around an opening reading from *The Language of the Heart*. After expenses, this self-supporting A.A. group turned over \$186.00 to the General Service Office.

The major work of the Conference takes place during the meetings and deliberations of the twelve standing Conference committees. Delegates review material and recommendations from the corresponding trustees’ committees, weigh and discuss issues and the resulting committee recommendations are taken to the entire Conference for a vote. Most of these recommendations result in Conference Advisory Actions (see page 10).

Saturday morning Conference members gathered in the Corinthian room for the closing brunch. Delegate chairperson Reba Warren said that it was “God’s love for all of us that we are here together.” Then she introduced the delegate chairperson for the 1991 Conference, Vera Martin (Southwest Ohio); John Evans (Kansas) will be the alternate chairperson.

Then it was time for farewells from rotating trustees. General service trustee Bill Croke expressed his gratitude for being able to serve, and said that the “gift of the quality of people I have been with was the greatest gift—and the ticket in was my sobriety.” Pacific U.S. regional trustee Ruth Jagodzinski spoke of the need for communication, and talking (without fear), for “as long as we are talking we can reach a solution.” Ruth closed with a message she had once received on an A.A. anniversary card: “Some people come into our lives and leave footprints on our hearts, and we are never the same.” I thank you for your footprints.”

Last came “the fearsome Tommy Hills that no one wants to follow.” Tom Hills, Eastern Canada trustee, who was sober 34 years, 3 months and 21 days that Saturday, cautioned the Conference members, “Let’s not take A.A. for granted . . . have faith in the process of A.A. and everything is going to be okay.” The reason no one ever wants to follow Tom is because he has very good material and funny stories, so the farewell talks—usually a poignant sad time—ended with the upbeat, healing laughter that is so basic to every A.A. room.

In summary, Michael Alexander said, “This Conference has opened up lines of communication. Each Conference has a form and character of its own. This was a secure and mature Conference. It is the first where I can remember that a vote was taken, the minority view was heard and the Conference body changed its position. You can’t do this if you’re not secure. The minority voice was heard.”

The members of the 40th General Service Conference went out into the warm New York streets—each going their separate ways—by subway, cars, trains and planes. Their destination, however, was the same. They were all returning to their Home Groups—where it all begins, where our future lies, where our simple primary message is carried. To quote again from the workshop reports: “The group must ‘pass it on,’ remaining ever vigilant to adhering, as closely as possible, to A.A. Traditions, realizing that the health of the group is the health of A.A.”

Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

As I welcome you today, I’m filled with gratitude for the miracle of sobriety and reminded once again of the wonderful opportunity we have in A.A. to carry the message and to practice the principles of our Twelve Steps in our lives. This great gift is one of love. Love and respect for ourselves and for others. And we all play a part in keeping it alive.

The safekeeping of A.A. has been entrusted to us, the members of the 40th General Service Conference. During the coming week, our Conference committees will address the directions A.A. will go in and the challenges that will need to be met to ensure that our spiritual principles may continue to be passed on to all A.A.s and to those who are still suffering.

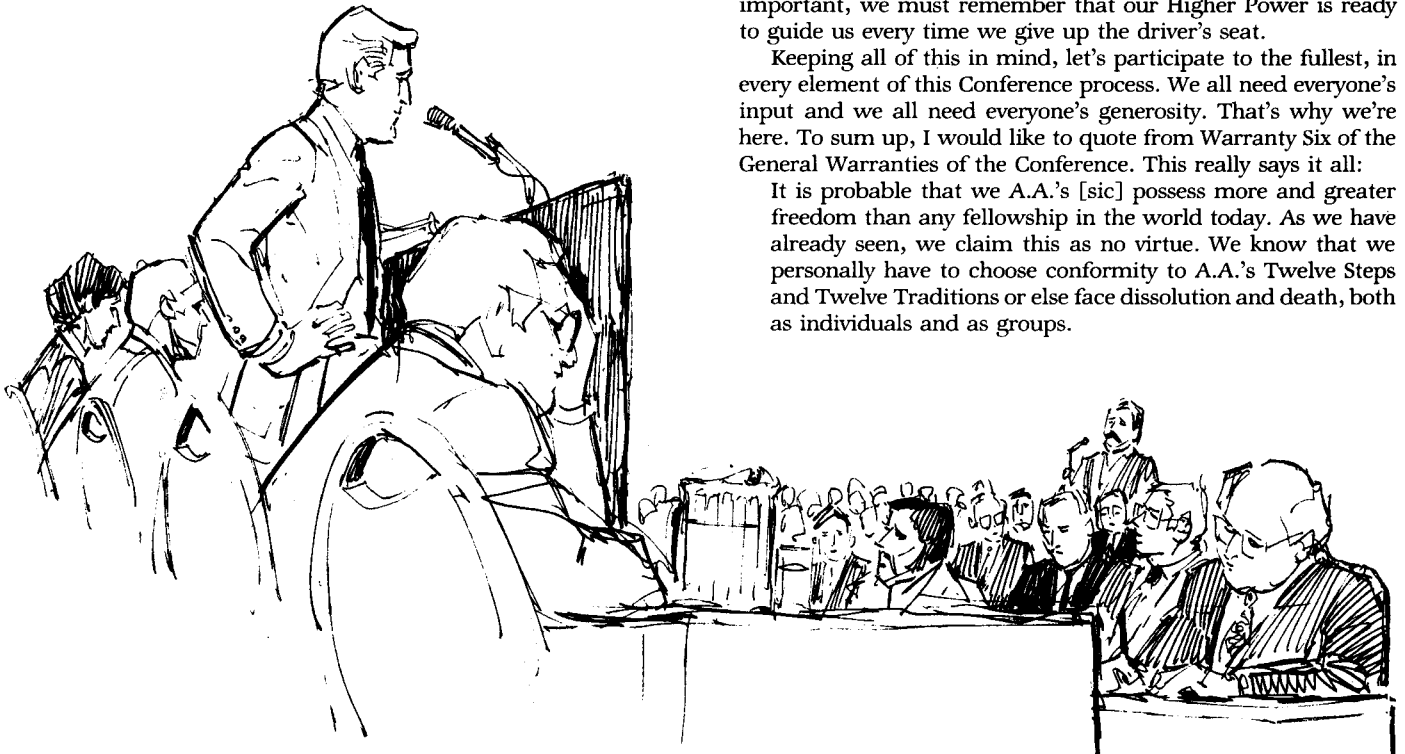
The home group plays an essential role in carrying the message. Experiences in our own home groups should remind us of where we all came from and why we are here. It was in my home group that I learned the spiritual principles that keep me coming back and that today govern A.A.s at all levels.

It is a Higher Power, rather than any virtue or skill of our own, that is responsible for our existence. Our common bond helps us to identify with each other but we do not compare ourselves with others. We respect each other, no matter where we came from, whether from Yale or from jail. We are gentle to others but hard on ourselves. We are tolerant and understanding and, without love, our collective wisdom would not survive.

Paramount among our responsibilities this coming week is to place our common welfare first. It is this common welfare, as we recall from the Declaration of Unity made at A.A.’s 35th Anniversary, that we owe to A.A.’s future. Unity should be the goal of our week here together. To achieve it, each needs to relearn and remember not only that we are servants but also that we need to trust our committee system and each other. We must remember that we can best discharge our duties in a spirit of confidence and love, even when we don’t get our way. Most important, we must remember that our Higher Power is ready to guide us every time we give up the driver’s seat.

Keeping all of this in mind, let’s participate to the fullest, in every element of this Conference process. We all need everyone’s input and we all need everyone’s generosity. That’s why we’re here. To sum up, I would like to quote from Warranty Six of the General Warranties of the Conference. This really says it all:

It is probable that we A.A.’s [sic] possess more and greater freedom than any fellowship in the world today. As we have already seen, we claim this as no virtue. We know that we personally have to choose conformity to A.A.’s Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions or else face dissolution and death, both as individuals and as groups.



Because we set such a high value on our great liberties, and cannot conceive a time when they will need to be limited, we here specially enjoin our General Service Conference to abstain completely from any and all acts of authoritative government which could in any way curtail A.A.'s freedom under God. The maintenance of these freedoms in our Conference is a great and practical guarantee that the Conference itself will always remain democratic in action and in spirit. (*The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 73.)

Reba Warren (Eastern Pennsylvania)
delegate chairperson

Keynote Address

I took my last drink 34 years, three months and 16 days ago on Saturday, January 7, 1956; went to my first meeting two days later and joined the Unionville Group on Wednesday, January 11, 1956. I have not been away from that group for longer than three weeks since. That is the importance that my home group has for me.

I can only speak about the group in personal terms, so I hope you will bear with me as I attempt to share my feelings concerning the importance of the group to our Fellowship. Implicitly, it entails personal responsibility and by accepting such responsibility, we are the direct link to a successful future.

It was impressed upon me by the chap who became my sponsor that it was essential that I have a home group and that there was no reason for being absent. If attending a funeral were the excuse, it better be my own. Nor could I belong to more than one group. My responsibility was to the *one* home group. More than one—and I was a bigamist.

Those early days made a deep impression on me. I never thought for one moment that it was possible to stay sober. I'd stopped drinking many times before. The problem was that I couldn't stay stopped. In truth, I had become a binge drinker and would have to be nursed back to health by my wife, who was a registered nurse by profession.

At the time we had three children, ages five, three and one. I was 35 years of age and my wife was 30. She was fed up with the whole situation. We were on the verge of breaking up and I was hanging on by my fingertips. I had a commission job that was still paying me some of my old commissions; a house with a tremendous mortgage; and a car on which the payments were barely being made. My wife had learned to drive because I was in such bad shape with "my nerves" that often she had to pack the kids into the car and drive me to make my calls, if I were capable.

I never dreamt on January 7, 1956, that I had taken my last drink, nor did my wife. As I began to stay sober and the days increased, I accepted as gospel the advice I was given by the members of my home group. It grew on me gradually that sobriety was a possibility—if I stayed. I came to believe that it was the group and its members who were doing this for me. As the days continued and the sobriety remained, I decided that I must adhere to the principles these people were advocating. What had seemed impossible was becoming the impossible come true.

Without the group there would be no sobriety for Tom Hills, nor for all the other Tom Hills, because he was just another alcoholic, another drunk. Some have said that without the Big Book, there would be no A.A. Without G.S.O. there would be no A.A. Without the Steps and Traditions there would be no A.A. Before any of these, there were the people who got together as

members. How many times have we been told that there only had to be two drunks and a coffee pot and it became a group? The bottom line was and is that without the home group there would be no A.A. Believe it!

Bill and Bob did not call themselves a group, but that's what they were. From them came the pyramid—first with the group in Akron—and from there to New York. Belonging to a group is absolutely vital. By the time most of us reach out for A.A., we have lost our places in society. No one wants to be bothered with us. Even the people I drank with had dropped me because drinking with Tom meant trouble. When you drank with me, you could count on getting into some kind of difficulty. So, nobody wanted me—my wife, my brothers, my mother, friends, army buddies, neighbors, fellow employees—nobody.

At this point I had lost my place in conventional society and also in my drinking society. I had become a loner who still had someone to look after him to some degree because of my wife and those little kids. I was still allowed in the house and that was rapidly reaching its end. When I was home alone, if someone came to the door, I would take my bottle and go into the closet, sitting on the shoes with the clothes hanging down—a real goofy "closet drinker."

That's the person I took to the group to which I still belong. I'll never forget the welcome I received. I'd been sober Sunday, Monday, Tuesday, and the part of Wednesday before I went to the group at 8:30 in the evening on a cold winter night. I was still shaking and the sweat was pouring out of me. The old church that had been built in 1870 had a low ceiling in the basement and had wooden rafters and pillars. The kitchen was ancient and the plumbing facilities were out of the Dark Ages. Because of the low ceiling, the cigarette smoke was a real health hazard. There were about 15 or 20 people present and about ten members. There was only one lady member and it remained that way for many years.

I had put on a suit and tie and was sweating right through my underwear, shirt and suit. Everybody shook my hand and told me how glad they were to see me. It brought tears because I knew what I looked like and was well aware of what they were saying about me outside of A.A. It was clear that they accepted this mess that was me. They had accepted responsibility for me and my sobriety.

The group was the beginning of the road back. It was the start on my return to a place in society. The process had begun. I began to learn how to get along with the members and what I learned there helped me at home. Everything I learned helped take me back into the society that I thought had been lost to me forever, back with all those people that I mentioned before. It only came with a commitment on my part. It required a willingness to become involved. The roles had been reversed. The group had been responsible for me and now I had to accept my responsibility for the group.

Having been given everything I thought would ever be mine, the First Tradition applied most aptly: "Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends on A.A. unity." My personal recovery depended first and foremost upon the unity of the group. The unity of A.A. depends upon the unity of the groups.

The first sentence of Concept One states, "The A.A. groups today hold ultimate responsibility and final authority for our world services . . ." If this is the case, then it merely confirmed that the responsibility for the group depended upon each of us as members of that group. And the groups together were responsible for all of A.A. It was our individual responsibility to keep the doors of our groups open so that A.A. as a whole would keep the doors open to carry the message to the world.

That little group of ours in Unionville—the regular Wednesday evening open meeting—has, to my knowledge, never been closed. There have been times when the Friday night closed discussion meetings have been missed but not the Wednesdays. We are convinced that someone should be there in case a person needs a meeting for whatever reason—new, coming back or just having a bad night—not to mention the one who just wants to attend another meeting for personal maintenance. The group has been open on Christmas Eves, Christmas Days, New Year's Eves, New Year's Days, Good Fridays, and on horrible Canadian winter nights when traffic is not moving anywhere. We feel that someone should be there in case that specific moment for getting sobriety happens to be Wednesday night. That is the responsibility of each of us.

The group members became interested in me and in time I became interested in them. I must admit that I have known members with longer sobriety than mine who do not have a home group. They are, in many respects, lonely and unhappy. They may be sober but they are not contentedly sober. They are missing out on the best of Alcoholics Anonymous. It is the issue of unselfishness, of being concerned about another drunk, that is best displayed at the group level.

A group is like a family. They may fight a little amongst themselves but let anyone try to interfere from outside and they band together. I guess that's where a lot of the autonomy of the Fourth Tradition fits in.

We are told that resentments start all kinds of new groups and this may be true. I can remember my sponsor telling me that if I went to another group or started one because of a resentment, the first person I would meet at the new place would be myself. No matter where you go, you are eventually going to run into the same problems, so you might as well resolve them right where you are.

Responsibility for my group is personal and applies equally to each of the other members. If I want to stay sober, if I want A.A. to be there for others, it is up to me to ensure that the group is there for those who want it and need it in the future. From the group comes direction for the whole Fellowship.

How I feel and act in my own group is reflected in the group conscience and eventually in the General Service Office. If I am not generous when the Seventh Tradition basket goes around, this is reflected in all levels of service. If I am not generous with my time when asked to participate in service functions such as P.I. or C.P.C., this will be reflected in the attitudes of those outside the Fellowship toward us. If I am not willing to give time to treatment facilities and correctional facilities, this indicates an unwillingness to spread the message in areas where it is needed.

The compassion, the bonding of one alcoholic with another, begins at the group level. The handshake and the eye contact start at the door to the group. The Seventh Tradition basket and the business meeting that keeps everyone informed of news from G.S.O. and of the local church's increase in rent, are the items that form the building blocks of our future.

That which comes from the group provides the means for our survival. When considering the future of A.A., it is important to remember Bill's original vision of the structure of A.A. He structured A.A. so that the groups were the foundation blocks. The group is the basic ingredient in A.A.'s future. The group and the members are at the apex. Instead of remembering this, there is a tendency to think in terms of the standard organizational chart, and thus to look at the General Service Office as being at the top.

The Concepts state unequivocally that the General Service Conference is the actual voice and effective conscience for our whole society. The A.A. General Service Board is the chief service arm of the General Service Conference. Yet our structure is deliberately reversed. The ultimate responsibility for A.A. belongs to the groups, which means that this responsibility lies with individual group members. In essence, the groups have responsibility for all entities. The home group has the responsibility for, and is the link to, A.A.'s future.

In 1956, my entry date, there were approximately 5,200 groups in the U.S. and Canada, and 6,200 in the world. In 1989 there were 45,500 groups in the U.S. and Canada and 85,000 groups worldwide. The growth speaks for itself. Alcoholics Anonymous has proved itself by the results. It has not been a theoretical exercise. Our links to the past have been forged in those numbers. They have been the home groups for almost 920,000 members in the U.S. and Canada and 1,700,000 members worldwide.

Home groups have been essential to personal sobriety. My own home group has been essential to mine. If I, in turn, as an individual member, accept my responsibility for my home group, as most of the 920,000 do for the rest of the 45,500 groups, then the future of A.A. is secure.

The application of individual responsibility is going to determine the collective responsibility for A.A. as a whole. The links to the future will be forged in the bonds of home group responsibility exercised by individual members who have welded the structure that will link us forever to those who will inevitably follow.

Tom Hills, Eastern Canada regional trustee



Workshop

Wednesday Conference members split up into small groups of 12 to 14 for a workshop discussion based on the Conference theme, "The Home Group—Our Responsibility and Link to A.A.'s Future." Following are the workshop questions and a summary of the report backs.

1 What are the advantages in having a home group?

a To the individual A.A. member?

The home group, it was generally agreed, is a "place of refuge," "a haven," where new and old members experience a valued sense of belonging, security and stability; it is where we're introduced to the idea of sponsorship and to the concept and practice of service, and the value of our vote in A.A. affairs. It is "like a family," where people get to know us and where, in sharing our vulnerability, in looking at ourselves, we can also learn about discipline.

b To A.A. as a whole?

As the "basic unit of the Fellowship," the home group nurtures strong individual sobriety which, in turn, strengthens unity and helps the group live up to A.A. Traditions. Participants uniformly agreed that the home group is where members learn about service and A.A. structure, and also how to "express their voice," to share diverse opinions and to "carry the only message we have." Not only is the home group a microcosm of the whole of A.A.; it is "the key to A.A. survival," and it assures self-support.

2 Should an A.A. member have only one home group?

a Why—Why not?

"One group, one vote, one family," expressed the view of the majority of participants, who noted the value of "group conscience participation" that results from one-group membership. Membership in—and identification with—only one home group helps to nurture: "a sense of family," commitment, self-honesty, and a clearer experience of allegiance, which is often diluted if an individual belongs to more than one group. A minority view among the participants held that if a member wants to belong to more than one group, it is his or her choice and is in keeping with Tradition Three.

b Who votes in your home group?

The majority view on this issue held that "only group members" should be allowed to vote but that, in practice, many groups allow "anyone who's there" the right to vote. Each group is autonomous, so it's up to the group's conscience to decide. For statistical purposes, the one group-one vote idea is obviously preferable, but exceptions are often made when a member lives and/or works in two areas. Groups are ultimately "self-correcting" in these matters.

3 How do you encourage continued attendance in the home group?

a Among your newcomers and oldtimers?

Making a point of welcoming and encouraging the participation of newcomers and oldtimers alike was agreed by all to be a top priority of groups. Other helpful practices are instituting temporary sponsorship programs, having phone contacts, keeping birthday lists, maintaining literature racks, holding an annual "Oldtimers' Day," having greeters at the door, awarding 30, 60, 90-day chips to newcomers, enlisting oldtimers into service jobs. Almost as important are fellowship periods before and after meetings, topics meetings which emphasize recovery from alcoholism, and the rotation of group service responsibilities.

b Among your members who are sick and physically challenged?

Participants uniformly agreed on the importance of maintaining meeting lists indicating which ones are handicapped-accessible, in addition to taking meetings to sick members, keeping lists of sick and handicapped members, and providing car pools.

4 How is an A.A. group that is designated for women, men, young people, gays, an effective home group?

a What are the advantages?

It was agreed that many members claim an ability to talk more freely and to feel more comfortable at special interest meetings. Some members would not attend meetings otherwise. Workshop participants agreed that A.A.s are certainly entitled to attend such meetings in accordance with Tradition Three. The Fellowship must "meet the needs of members who identify themselves as needing those meetings." But while participants respected the "different needs" of certain members who feel "less intimidated" at special interest meetings, many believed that those meetings should be springboards into the regular A.A. community.

b What are the disadvantages?

Such meetings can "foster a sense of uniqueness, isolation and segregation," many workshop participants stated. And so they work against helping members return to or become a part of A.A.'s mainstream; they "hurt A.A. Unity"; "cause tunnel vision"; frequently emphasize "other things besides alcoholism"; divert attention from our primary purpose; limit the sharing of experience; foster the idea of "exclusivity rather than inclusivity."

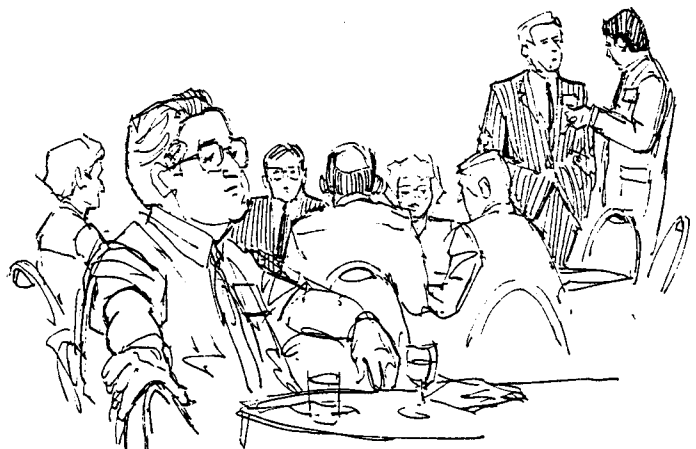
5 What is the home group's responsibility?

a To the district/area/worldwide?

There was virtual agreement that a home group be responsible in: carrying the message, encouraging the participation in all levels of service, upholding the Traditions, and formulating the group conscience. No less important is the group's responsibility to help the entire Fellowship be financially self-supporting, as well as "well-informed, trusted servants."

b To A.A.'s future?

The group must "pass it on," participants agreed, remaining ever vigilant in adhering "as closely as possible" to the Traditions, realizing that "the health of the group is the health of A.A." By "always being there for the newcomer," the group is answering to future generations, some participants said, while others urged caution by advising "a careful look at proposed changes; move slowly." Cooperating with treatment facilities to direct alcoholics to A.A. is a strong tool each group ought not overlook. All groups should maintain a close link with the whole of A.A.



Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole, or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the Conference.

FLOOR ACTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 1 There be a pamphlet on "Bridging the Gap" developed through the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee in conjunction with the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee; and that it be brought back to the 1991 General Service Conference for consideration.
- 2 The trustees' Literature Committee and the Conference Literature Committee consider the paragraph containing the 6-point definition in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, and bring a report and recommendation regarding this back to the 1991 General Service Conference.
- 3 The Domestic Directories be retained as formatted, and distributed to area officers, D.C.M.s and intergroup/central offices, and be made available for purchase by A.A. groups and members.
- 4 A.A. Domestic Directories and the group information forms include the following:

Third Tradition (Long Form)

Our membership ought to include all who suffer from alcoholism. Hence we may refuse none who wish to recover. Nor ought A.A. membership ever depend upon money or conformity. Any two or three alcoholics gathered together for sobriety may call themselves an A.A. group, provided that, as a group, they have no other affiliation.

Fifth Tradition (Long Form)

Each Alcoholics Anonymous group ought to be a spiritual entity *having but one primary purpose*—that of carrying its message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

In his discussion of the Ninth Tradition our co-founder, Bill, cautions: "Unless there is approximate conformity to A.A.'s Twelve Traditions, the group . . . can deteriorate and die."

- 5 The General Service Office delay processing new A.A. group information forms for 30 days in order to allow the local A.A. structure to participate in the process.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 6 The format of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner of the 1991 General Service Conference be as follows: the chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be chair of the meeting, with his or her duties limited to introducing the meeting leader and monitoring the time allotted by means of a light-timer system; and the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be leader of the meeting, introducing five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, and two other A.A. members alternating from among the A.A. staff, Grapevine staff, archivist, and corporate boards.

7 In order of preference, the theme for the 1991 General Service Conference be selected from among the following: "Sponsorship: Gratitude in Action"; "Sponsorship: Our Three Legacies"; "Sponsorship: The Hand of A.A."

8 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1991 General Service Conference:

- a) Sponsorship
 - 1 Help and Hope
 - 2 I am Responsible
 - 3 A Way of Life
- b) Our Collective Humility
 - 1 How We Identify Ourselves
 - 2 Anonymity—Our Spiritual Foundation
 - 3 In All Our Affairs
- c) Self-Support Project—Five Years Later
- d) G.S.O. Finances

9 One workshop be held at the 1991 General Service Conference, with the topic to be on the Conference theme.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 10 The revised pamphlet "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous" be published, with minor changes, once the present supply of the old pamphlet is exhausted.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

- 11 The trustees' committee recommendation for publication of a collection of correctional facilities stories from previous Grapevines (and other A.A. sources) be approved.
- 12 The trustees' Literature Committee consider adding a story of a young person who entered A.A. while in prison to the pamphlet "Young People and A.A.," because of an expressed need for correctional facilities material addressed to young people.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 13 No change be made to the newly revised pamphlet "Self-supporting Through Our Own Contributions," which emphasizes the commitment on the part of the individual A.A. member; and that any relationship to intergroups be left to the Conference, and the results of such actions then be reflected in the Self-support pamphlet.
- 14 There be a reaffirmation of the 1977 Conference Advisory Action which reads: "A suggested prudent reserve for a group be dependent on local needs; and that a suggested prudent reserve for central offices, intergroups, and area committees preferably be one to twelve months operating expense, depending on local needs."

John O'Connor (Western Massachusetts), who works for the post office, weighed the pre-Conference material he received from G.S.O. and other delegates: 24 lbs. 6 oz!

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

15 The words "one-time trial distribution of complimentary Grapevines to nonsubscribing groups" in 1988 Conference Advisory Action #25 no longer be considered binding.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

It was recommended that:

16 The Site-selection Guidelines for the International Convention in the year 2000 be approved as presented.

17 The 1990 International Convention posters in English, Spanish and French be sold in the registration area as mementos.

18 The 1976 Conference Advisory Action, that a request from a bidding city's convention bureau for the names and addresses of Site-selection Committee members be denied, be reaffirmed, and this information be included in the bidding information sent to delegates.

19 The 1991 General Service Conference select three cities for the International Convention in the year 2000; and that the Convention Site-selection Committee not determine its preference of first, second, or third choice; and that the top three cities be given equal consideration by the 1991 General Service Conference. The final selection of the site will be made by the General Service Board in October 1991, following an inspection trip by representatives of the Convention Site-selection Committee.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

20 ~~The revised manuscript~~ for "The A.A. Group" pamphlet be approved with the following specific change:

The first sentence in the section on *Group Inventory*, manuscript page 47, be changed to read: "Many groups periodically hold a 'group inventory' meeting to evaluate how well they are fulfilling their primary purpose: to help alcoholics recover through A.A.'s suggested Twelve Steps of recovery."

21 The A.A. History book project continue to completion, and that the time frame covered be expanded to include 1955 to the present.

22 The manuscript of the daily reflections book be approved with the following specific changes:

- a) All references to "we" be changed to "I."
- b) The page for June 17 delete the words "(Psalm 130)" from line 1 of the reflection.
- c) There be an addition of a page for February 29; that page to be the "alternate" for March entitled "True Tolerance."
- d) That these words be imprinted on the cover of the book: "This is a book of reflections by A.A. members for A.A. members."

23 The text and illustrations for the proposed Twelve Steps Illustrated pamphlet be referred to the trustees' Literature Committee for rewriting of the easy-to-read text, with the recommendation that this language be further simplified and shortened into simple statements that would direct attention to the illustrations, without attempting to rewrite the Steps; and bring the text back to the 1991 General Service Conference for approval.

24 The proposal for a pamphlet on the spiritual aspects of A.A. not be approved, because there is not sufficient need at this time.

25 The trustees' Literature Committee study the feasibility of updating the "Circles of Love and Service" filmstrip and video, because of the need to include current information and conditions, and report their findings to the 1991 Conference Literature Committee.

POLICY / ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

26 The alternate delegate from Colorado be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate who is ill and unable to attend.

27 The 42nd General Service Conference be held April 26-May 2, 1992, since this week will not conflict with Easter or Passover.

28 The 43rd General Service Conference be held April 18-April 24, 1993 with an alternate date of April 25-May 1, 1993, based on hotel accommodations and availability, realizing the need for reserving hotel space well in advance.

29 A standing committee for central and intergroup offices not be formed at this time. The committee felt that many of the problems expressed by central offices and intergroups are "home issues," and that the doors of communication need to be opened at the area level. The committee would like to stress the importance of delegates establishing contact with offices in their areas and assuring them they do have a voice in the Fellowship through their existing area service structure. The committee suggests that the sharing received by this committee from areas and central/intergroup offices, regarding their experiences of cooperation and communication, be reviewed by the G.S.O. staff with the idea of incorporation into the Guidelines on Central/Intergroup Offices.

30 There be a continuation of the Conference International Convention Ad Hoc Committee, which would also address issues of Regional Forums, through 1995. This committee, to be composed of one delegate from each region, could serve as the Site-selection Committee for the International Convention in the year 2000. The committee suggests this recommendation be reviewed in 1995 by the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

31 "The A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet, the one-way display and the poster be updated to reflect the findings from the 1989 Membership Survey.

32 "The A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet, the one-way display and poster reflect all the findings of the 1989 Membership Survey. The answer to Question #14 in the A.A. survey pertaining to drugs should be presented as follows:

"In addition to their alcoholism, X% of members indicated they were addicted to drugs," and include the disclaimer "A.A.'s primary purpose is recovery from alcoholism."

33 The trustees' Committee on Public Information review the background of the entire survey and each question on the survey questionnaire, to determine which questions should be included or deleted from the 1992 Membership Survey. This information should be given to the 1991 Conference Public Information Committee as promptly as possible.

34 The trustees' Committee on Public Information consider the feasibility of developing video and television public service announcements with the focus on younger A.A. members and all minorities, within the framework of A.A.'s desire to carry its message to all alcoholics, and bring a recommendation back to the 1991 General Service Conference.

35 The trustees' Committee on General Service Conference consider a Conference theme, workshop or presentation on the question of affiliation, to be presented as soon as possible.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

36 There be a revision of the Twelve Concepts section in *The A.A. Service Manual*, printing the short form of the Concepts as the "Table of Contents," followed by the long form and introduction.

37 The following text appear in *The A.A. Service Manual* in the section "Working Together—General Services and Local Inter-group Services," following item 7 on the election of trustees:

"Some areas find that a liaison between central office/inter-group and the area committee is very helpful. In some areas the liaison has a vote, in others the liaison has a voice but no vote.

"There is more information regarding working together available through the General Service Office and in the pamphlets 'The A.A. Group' and 'Self-supporting Through Our Own Contributions,' as well as in the Guidelines on Central Offices and Intergroups."

And, to delete the following:

"In areas where there are central offices providing the services mentioned previously, general service committees do not attempt to duplicate these services; but in those areas where there is little or no central office activity, the general service committee has frequently undertaken to provide many of these services."

38 The General Service Conference *Final Report* continue to be distributed at no charge in English, French and Spanish; and that an informational sheet to ascertain the Report's usefulness be included with each copy, requesting it be returned to the delegates for forwarding by them to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter by April 1, 1991, as background in planning future distribution.

39 The present text in *The A.A. Service Manual* on "Use of A.A.'s Trademarks and Logos" be replaced with the A.A.W.S., Inc. amended policy.

40 Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section in the Conference *Final Report*.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

41 The film "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous" be accepted as presented to meet an expressed need from the A.A. members carrying the message into treatment facilities; and that the film be translated into French and Spanish, and be captioned for deaf and hearing-impaired alcoholics, consistent with recommendations for our other recent videos.

42 The following 1988 Conference Action be reaffirmed:

"The newsletter drafted by the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities for annual distribution to treatment facilities chairpersons be a quarterly newsletter whenever possible, and reflect shared experiences from other areas on how they are solving problems related to treatment facilities."

43 The Treatment Facilities Newsletter mailing list be expanded to include district committee members, as well as delegates, alternate delegates and trustees; and that the 1991 Conference reevaluate the need for this newsletter.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

44 The following slate of officers and trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April 1990 (see page 39; the Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee).

45 The following slate of directors for the A.A.W.S. Board be elected (see page 39; slate of directors approved).

46 The following slate of directors be elected for the Grapevine Corporate Board (see page 39; slate of directors approved).

47 The following revised text be approved for substitution and inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*:

There Are . . .

Two Trustees-at-Large

The trustees-at-large (2) serve as members of the trustees' International Committee and other trustees' committees or as directors of the corporate boards. They may fill in for regional trustees, as needed and/or requested.

The trustees-at-large—one from the U.S. and one from Canada—serve as the World Service Meeting delegates representing the U.S. and Canada. World Service Meeting delegates participate in two World Service Meetings which are held once every two years, the meeting place alternating between New York City and a location outside the U.S. and Canada. World Service Meeting delegates should have the same qualifications as any trustees, and also have time both to attend the World Service Meetings and to present and carry out any decisions reached at these meetings.

The trustees-at-large are requested to attend all Regional Forums in their own country and be available on a rotational basis to participate on Forum programs.

The trustees-at-large are also available for other A.A. service activities as requested by areas or regions and additional activities as may be requested by the board of trustees.

There Are . . .

Four General Service Trustees

General service trustees are active on one or more of the service corporate boards and must be available, not only every quarter, but any week and, sometimes, any day, for the solution of problems on which G.S.O. or Grapevine staff members need help. Because of this requirement, all general service trustees originally came from New York City or its commuting area and were sometimes known as "in-town trustees." The current practice of selecting general service trustees for both the A.A.W.S. and Grapevine corporate boards will continue, but these positions are no longer restricted to residents of New York City or its vicinity.

While there are no "specialists" in A.A.—only recovered drunks—it has been possible to choose, for general service trusteeships, men and women with the kind of business or professional acumen that is particularly applicable to the problems at hand, whether their backgrounds are in publishing, public relations, or administration. This brings up the question of what qualifications count most in the selection of a trustee

Additional Committee Considerations Which Did Not Result in Recommendations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Conference Report." These items, listed by committee, are as follows:*

AGENDA

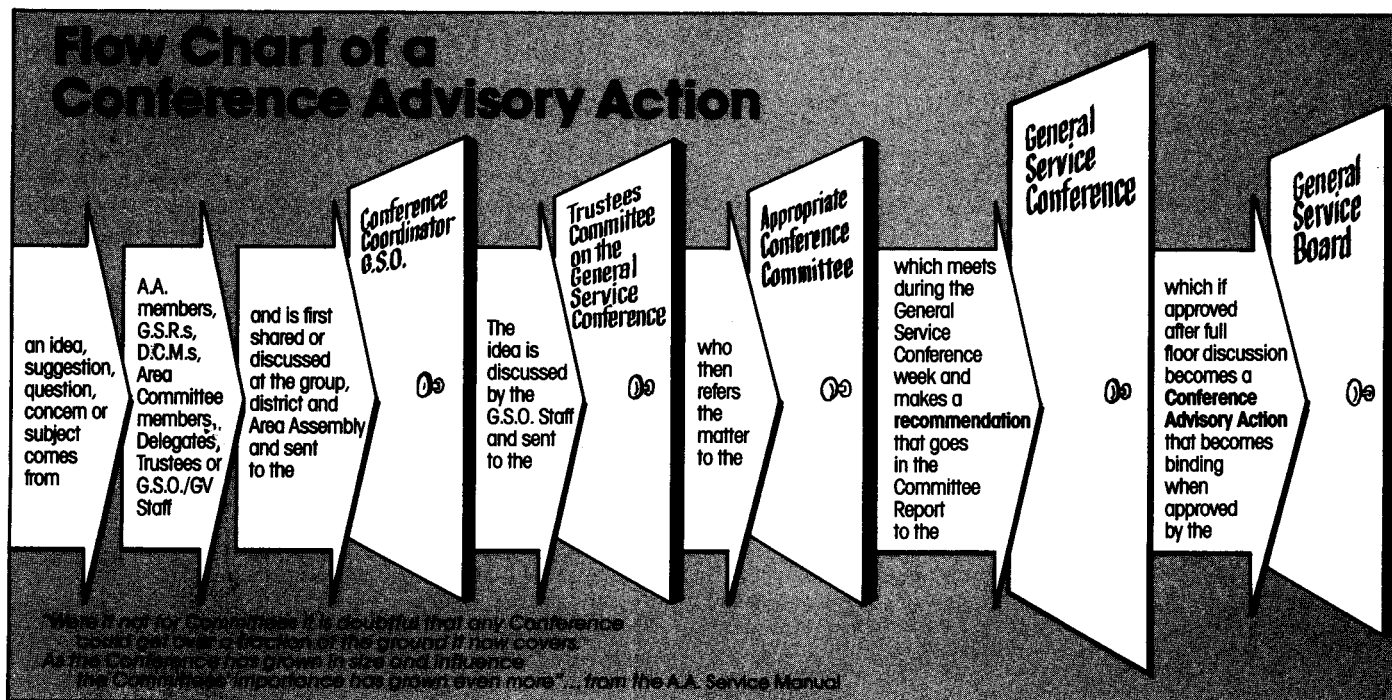
- The committee suggested continuation of a "What's On Your Mind?" session early in the week.
- The committee agreed that the chairperson write the Conference Policy Admissions Committee, requesting it stress the need for Conference members to be present at all Conference sessions.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee discussed the feasibility of making a video for C.P.C. committees and suggested that the need for a video did not seem practical at this time.

- The committee accepted the trustees' C.P.C. Committee's recommendation to delay the printing of the pamphlet "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" until current supply of "A.A. and Occupational Alcoholism Programs" is exhausted.
- The committee considered developing additional displays for C.P.C. work and sale and/or loan from G.S.O. It was suggested that a letter go to area C.P.C. committees asking if they would be interested in purchasing or leasing a tabletop display, similar to the one displayed at the General Service Conference. A picture would be enclosed. The results would be reported to the trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees.
- The committee accepted the report regarding regular updated changes in the C.P.C. Workbook and tabled the suggestion to change "What Professionals Are Saying," section 1, pages 6-8, until after the 1990 International Convention.
- The committee reviewed ideas for future issues of *About A.A.*, the newsletter to professionals. They encouraged having one issue devoted to minorities, and another issue on the A.A. Grapevine.
- The C.P.C. Committee reaffirmed the minority initiative based on the 1988/'89 Conference C.P.C. Committee Advisory Actions and encouraged area C.P.C. committees to reach minority populations through the following ways: a) provide A.A. literature through individual and committee efforts; b) make available to professionals the *About A.A.* newsletter and c) exhibit A.A. literature at professional conferences and health fairs.
- It is the Conference C.P.C. Committee's hope that the minority initiative continue to reflect A.A.'s primary concern for helping all alcoholics.
- Local experience with Court Programs was discussed in detail. The Conference C.P.C. Committee encouraged more area as-

* The International Convention and Public Information Committees did not have items in this category.



semblies to have workshops on Court Programs, using A.A. Guidelines on Cooperating With Court, A.S.A.P., and Similar Programs. Problems occur when these matters are not shared through the district or area. There are solutions and they come through the area committee system and the Twelve Traditions. We wish to continue to cooperate with Court Programs since many A.A.s get sober through these efforts.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee discussed methods of stimulating interest in correctional facilities service work and all agreed that there is a great need for A.A. service workers to carry our message to suffering alcoholics who are incarcerated.

Following are some ideas that were shared:

1. Hold Open Meetings and/or Special Breakfast meetings at A.A. conventions using incarcerated A.A. members as speakers who can demonstrate the positive results of carrying the message into correctional facilities. This is done in areas and/or provinces where the prison system allows some prisoners out on pass for this purpose.

2. In some areas A.A. groups accept responsibility for A.A. meetings in a single facility for one month a year. This has been done through G.S.R.s and also through intergroup service structures. This is more easily done in states and provinces that do not have extremely complicated clearance procedures for those visiting prisons.

3. Hold Corrections Workshops and/or a Unity day, where A.A. members already involved in service work share about the rewards of this kind of service. Forms could be developed giving A.A. members a choice regarding the kind of corrections service work they want to do . . . i.e., speaking at A.A. meetings inside correctional facilities; corresponding with members who are incarcerated through the Correctional Correspondence Service; participating in a prerelease sponsorship program or a program to help prisoners in "Bridging the Gap."

The committee requested that this shared experience be added to the Correctional Facilities Workbook, and that delegates and correctional facilities chairpeople be urged to forward further shared experience regarding stimulating interest in corrections work to G.S.O. for inclusion in the Workbook.

- The committee discussed methods of financing area corrections committees. Most areas support the committees' travel and meeting expenses and provide some money for literature. A few area committees have substantial budgets for providing literature for correctional A.A. meetings. In many, literature is funded at the district level, and sometimes even the group level.

- The committee discussed the usefulness of audio tapes in correction service work and felt that correctional facilities committees should be encouraged to use the tapes available from G.S.O. and the Grapevine where possible.

- Some committees also use speaker tapes extensively to help carry the message to those who are incarcerated, but feel this should be done as a *supplement* to one-on-one conversations between A.A. members on the outside and suffering alcoholics who are incarcerated.

- The committee also discussed the fact that the video "It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell" has not gotten sufficient exposure within the prison system in the United States and Canada and suggests that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider de-

velopment of a storyboard on the video and/or other public information material to increase use of the film within the penal system.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed various aspects of self-support and agreed that the following items be considered by the General Service Office, and the Self-support Committee:

1. Need a way to relate group services to group contributions.

2. Need to emphasize the Birthday Plan.

3. Emphasize individual participation at the group level.

4. Reaffirm the goal of the self-support effort and recognize the need to use publishing income to fund increased services required by our growing Fellowship, striving for more effective communications, keeping them simple, direct, and consistent.

5. Request the Grapevine consider writing an article on the Birthday Plan and use Birthday envelopes.

6. Request the Grapevine consider enclosing a regular contribution envelope each year.

7. Suggest that the Self-support Committee become a standing committee of the A.A.W.S. Board.

- The committee discussed the order of "examples" in the self-support pamphlet be considered by the 1991 Conference Finance Committee to perhaps give emphasis to the area first, then district, followed by the G.S.O., and then the intergroup/central offices last.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the revised manuscript for the Grapevine Representative Handbook and agreed that the text was satisfactory. The committee suggested that the format be more inviting and that a rough copy of the redesigned Handbook be sent to the committee for review before publication.

- The committee discussed the fact that hotel locations have been eliminated from the Grapevine Calendar of Events and, since editorial space is needed for A.A. sharing and information is available from other sources, the committee agreed that listing hotel locations is not necessary.

- The committee suggested that the 1989 background information sheet on Grapevine financial support be updated and distributed to Panel 39 and 40 delegates.

- In an effort to help area treatment facilities, correctional facilities, public information, and cooperation with the professional community committees carry the A.A. message, the committee suggested that when available the Grapevine periodically distribute back issues through the delegate for the use of these committees.

- In response to a letter from a delegate that arrived too late to be on the agenda, the committee discussed singleness of purpose as reflected in the Grapevine and came to no conclusion. The committee felt that the topic should appear on the Grapevine committee's agenda for the 1991 Conference.

- In light of previous Conference Actions the committee discussed the importance of the area and district service structure in increasing awareness of the Grapevine and emphasized the role of the area delegate in the process.

LITERATURE

- As part of the commemoration of the 50th anniversary of the book *Alcoholics Anonymous*, the 1989 Conference Literature Committee suggested distribution of the Big Book Workshop Questions to all delegates with the hope that delegates would encourage Big Book Workshops at regional, area district and group gatherings. An overview of the responses received prior to this Conference was reviewed by the committee and it was obvious that those areas participating had experienced renewed interest in our Big Book.
- The committee reviewed a request for consideration of a new Conference-approved pamphlet based on "Who Me," a pamphlet produced in Canada some years ago. The committee saw no need for an additional piece of literature of this kind.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee reviewed the 1990 Conference Evaluation Questionnaire and suggested no changes be made for 1991.
- The committee discussed a request from ICYPAA that a member of their advisory council be allowed to attend the General Service Conference as an observer. The committee denied this request because their interests are being served through their area general service structure.
- The committee discussed the election procedure for committee chairperson and alternate and suggested the present policy of election by plurality rather than drawing from the hat be reviewed by the Policy/Admissions Committee in 1991.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed whether reference need be made in *The A.A. Service Manual* about the necessity of a person being present at an area election assembly in order to be eligible for election to an area position. It was the sense of the committee that this was a matter for area autonomy.
- The committee discussed whether reference need be made in *The A.A. Service Manual*, in the event a delegate elect decides before January 1 that they cannot serve, the persons who had the second largest number of votes (or the other name in the hat)



or the newly elected alternate delegate should serve as new delegate. It was the sense of the committee that this was a matter for area autonomy.

- The committee considered publishing *The A.A. Service Manual* in a ring-binder format and decided against it, due to cost of \$4.00 each as compared to a present 54 cents, and the inconsistent rotation of G.S.R.s.
- The committee considered adding a list of special terms to the "Glossary of Terms Frequently used in General Service Activities" and decided not to since this would be repetitive, as well as imposing on local autonomy.
- The committee reviewed the rough draft of the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9*.
- The committee established a deadline for examining the rough draft of the 1990 *Final Report* of the General Service Conference.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee reviewed the Treatment Facilities Workbook and agreed with the suggestions of the trustees' Committee on Treatment Facilities' regarding the suggested revisions and additions to the Workbook.
- It was suggested that in the section on "Informing Treatment Facilities Personnel About A.A.'s Policy Regarding Nonalcoholic Drug Addicts," a paragraph be added offering two alternatives when the subject situation exists. They are:
 1. Ask C.P.C. committees to meet with the treatment facilities personnel.
 2. Refer to the section "Treatment Facilities: Substance Abusers and A.A. Meetings" in the Workbook.
- The committee suggested that the following, from the 1986 Treatment Facilities Conference recommendations, be included in future Treatment Facilities Newsletter:
 1. "... Play some Grapevine cassette tapes—always good listening and learning, and leave some copies of the A.A. Grapevine."
 2. "Each area treatment facilities committee conduct workshops, as frequently as needed, to effectively utilize the Treatment Facilities Workbook."
 3. "Treatment facilities committees send liaisons to other service entities' meetings in their area and in turn, invite them to send liaisons to the treatment facilities committee meetings."
- The committee suggested that the "Information Program" piece developed by a district in Southern Minnesota be referred to the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee for review and report back to the 1991 Conference.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Trustees and suggested the following addition: To have the Conference Committee chairperson maintain consistent contact with the trustees' Nominating Committee chairperson.
- The committee discussed a letter from a Panel 39 delegate suggesting that the resumes of nominees for regional trustee and general service trustee be sent to all delegates. The committee determined that the current procedure for mailing resumes is adequate.

Presentations Highlight Home Group and Other Key Themes

THE IMPORTANCE OF THE HOME GROUP

The first presentation session of the 1990 Conference began at 11 a.m. Monday morning. John King, Class A trustee, moderated the session, which focused on the 1990 Conference theme, The Home Group – Our Responsibility and Link to A.A.'s Future.

... In Recovery

In my experience as a member of Alcoholics Anonymous, I have found that the importance of my home group's role in recovery is endless. We say that, "We do together what we cannot do alone." We also claim that we cannot individually be responsible for someone else's sobriety.

It is my understanding that the home group is responsible for providing the environment that allows me to stay sober. Additionally, the home group gives me the incentive to want to practice the Twelve Steps for my own recovery, which also provides me with the opportunity to help the alcoholic who still suffers. The Big Book tells me that it is obvious that I cannot transmit that which I haven't got. Having admitted that I was powerless over alcohol and that my life had become unmanageable, I came to the understanding (with the help of my fellow group members) that I needed to change my thinking and my attitudes.

Through all these years I have attended many meetings and have met lots of people in the Fellowship, but the relationship that I maintain with the members of my home group has been the most rewarding because they know me well enough to tell when I am hurting or when I am all right. Being dishonest for most of my drinking days, I have learned that I had a chance to recover if I had the capacity to be honest. The Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous have given me this new way of life, but the home group has provided and will continue to provide me with the means to want it.

I remember when I first walked through the doors of the Friday Night Del Valle Group in La Puente, California. People greeted me, offered me a cup of coffee and welcomed me. They really did a good job of making me feel at home. All of this attention gave me the desire to keep coming back. My sponsor, Leonard, took the time to share his life with me. He took me to other meetings and explained that, if I had a desire to be restored to sanity, the rewards of attending as many meetings as possible were great.

How can I forget my wonderful friend, good old Judy, who was restricted to a wheelchair. I'd encountered some financial problems, like so many alcoholics do when they're new to the program. By the grace of God, Judy stepped in and said, "Don't you think it's time to start working your Third Step? To make a decision to turn your will and your life over to the care of God as you understand Him? Give God a chance to manage your life. After all, your financial problems did not come about overnight, so most likely, they won't be resolved overnight."

Some of these early experiences in my sobriety proved to me that God works through people when a working relationship is maintained. Judy was taken ill and was confined to a convalescent hospital. She asked the group to bring a meeting to her once a week, for her own recovery.

One day I thought I'd drop by to see her because I was going out of town for a few days on an A.A. commitment, as I was chairman for a California Spanish convention. She was very glad to see me and said, "I wanted to tell you for some time that I have enjoyed your friendship and I knew from the first time you set foot in your first meeting that you were going to stay." Two days later she passed away.

The Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous have been the instruments of my recovery. They have allowed the joy of living to enter my life. This is where we find emotional sobriety together



and where we talk about love that has no price tag. All of this had its beginning in the home group, where people welcomed me and knew what I needed. I believe I can go to many places and have fun, visit other groups and make friends, but I must always remember that I have a home group waiting for me. This is the main reason for my entrance into this wonderful program of recovery.

Juan Martinez, California (Southern)

. . . For Unity

I doubt that there is anyone here today who doesn't understand how important the home group is for unity within Alcoholics Anonymous. The home group is the basic unit of A.A.; the vessel in which the message is carried and the very foundation upon which our society is built.

From my earliest sober beginnings in Alcoholics Anonymous I have been fortunate enough to be connected to a home group. It was in my first home group that I felt a oneness with the other members. It was the common bonds of the disease and of recovery through the Twelve Steps that united us. Yet I believe it was also our willingness to adhere to the direction and guidance found within the Twelve Traditions.

During my time in A.A. I have seen the difference between a meeting and an A.A. group. I have also seen that a meeting can become a group when people care enough to put the effort into it, because it takes effort, individual and collective. It takes knowing, understanding and abiding by the Twelve Traditions. It takes being aware of and talking to newcomers at the meeting and offering temporary sponsorship to them so that they don't fall through the cracks. It takes attending and participating in group conscience meetings and allowing other home group members to voice their opinions and concerns without criticism. It takes having a responsible G.S.R. and intergroup representative so that the group's voice will be heard at the local and national levels. It takes carrying the message, as a group, to institutions and being of service to the local P.I. and C.P.C. committees.

I could list many more things that "it takes"—meeting content, literature, fund raising and spending—however, all these things are already addressed within our Twelve Traditions. The Traditions weren't written as a nice companion piece to the Twelve Steps. They are the result of lessons learned from past mistakes. Fortunately, our predecessors cared enough about us to write them down.

I used to live my life according to the Monroe Doctrine. You know what the Monroe Doctrine is, don't you? It's isolationism! At one time, people weren't a necessary part of my life. In fact, when the song entitled "People" was popular, I hated it. What an absurd thought ". . . people who need people . . ." To me, needing anyone was a sign of weakness.

Thank God I was not allowed to continue living in that sickness. Just as I could not exist in that vacuum of false self-sufficiency, an A.A. group cannot exist by itself, for itself and without any thought or concern for the rest of the Fellowship. We all know of groups that operate under that premise. Such groups refuse to talk about or even to read the Twelve Traditions. They never hold group conscience meetings because they don't know who the group members are and thus are run by the dictates of one or two people. Their idea of self-support is to build up their own treasuries. They don't have representation outside their group because they don't want to get involved with all that "political stuff."

In my opinion, these factors mark the difference between a meeting and a group. Should such groups be excommunicated

from A.A.? Of course not! No human authority may dictate a course of action to an A.A. member or to an A.A. group. What usually happens is that they fade away because they fail to serve the needs of the still-suffering alcoholic. Or, as I mentioned earlier, they change and put the effort into becoming an A.A. group.

Most of us have heard of the Washingtonian movement. The Washingtonians did us a great service for which we should be grateful and ever mindful. They showed us what happens to a society that fails to bond with a common purpose and that lacks a uniform message to deliver. Such a society lacks a structure in which to develop a message. It gets diverted by other issues and sets itself up for controversy. It encourages sensationalism in its drive for members. Probably one of the greatest lessons we can learn from them is what happens to a society that becomes centered on personalities rather than on God.

A.A. is not the *only way* but it has proved, over time, to be the best way for thousands of alcoholics to recover. What happens in our Fellowship, whether in our own back yards or across the globe, is important. It's important for our own sobriety and for the chance for sobriety for those yet to come. God has given us a precious gift. Our co-founders and early members have put it into place. Let us always be vigilant in keeping this gift in place—whole, intact and unchanged.

Rosemary Palmeri, New York (Central)

. . . For Service

Service in the Fellowship can range from the initial Twelfth Step call to our General Service Office for national and international action. Service also includes meeting places, hospital cooperation, intergroup offices, pamphlets, books, committees, delegates, trustees, conferences and voluntary contributions from within our Fellowship. These services, whether performed by individuals, groups, areas, or A.A. as a whole, are utterly vital to our existence and growth as stated by our co-founder, Bill W., in A.A.'s *Legacy of Service*. (A.A. *Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Services*, pp. S7-S21.)

During my early recovery in the Fellowship, I was introduced to service by my sponsor in our home group. I began by chairing meetings and went on to become an elected officer of my home group. As I learned about the different functions of each office, the members expressed love and concern for me and I was made to feel a part of my home group.

My responsibilities increased and one day I discovered that I was to become the new general service representative. My home group introduced me to the service structure and explained how communication flows from the A.A. group to our General Service Office via the area delegate and then back to the group by way of their G.S.R. This helped me to understand the importance of the G.S.R., specifically, the relationship of the G.S.R. to the group and the link between the group and G.S.O.

My home group is love- and service-oriented. We have informed group conscience meetings based on accurate information that we have learned in service. When I hear expressions such as "let the minority speak," "right of decision" and "right of participation," I smile because it lets me know that the members are learning about the Twelve Concepts and our Third Legacy.

In my home group there are three D.C.M.s, an intergroup representative, a G.S.R., an area literature chairperson, a GvR, an area officer and me, the delegate. We share our service experience, strength and hope with each other by sponsoring members into service and by providing transportation for new G.S.R.s to the district and area assembly meetings. Additionally, we conduct

monthly workshops on the *A.A. Service Manual* that includes a questionnaire developed by one of our D.C.M.s aimed at helping new G.S.R.s learn about service.

We also use a traveling service display that was created by one of our home group members. This enhances the service panel presentation that our D.C.M.s, Grapevine representative and area officers make to groups. During the presentation, the service panel is substituted for a lead. The topics covered are the G.S.R., the D.C.M., the Grapevine, the delegate, G.S.O., voluntary contributions, the Challenge of the Seventh Tradition and the importance of the group's full participation in helping the Fellowship become self-supporting.

My home group has found this service panel presentation to be an effective way to carry the service message throughout the area. The group's enthusiasm for service has generated tremendous interest throughout the area and it all began with the members in my group who wanted to be informed through service.

Finally, we ask all the home group members to attend our mini-conference, which consists of workshops on the theme of the General Service Conference. For many members, this is their first opportunity to actively participate in the workshops, have a voice in what happens and observe the members reach a collective conscience through the A.A. process.

The early foundation in love and service that was given to me by my home group was important because not only has it enriched my sobriety but the experience has resulted in my standing before you this morning as a trusted servant, committed to passing on our Legacy of Service.

Mary Branche, Ohio (Northeast)

FINANCE

As Monday afternoon's final presenter, Ed Gordon, G.S.O.'s director of finance, delivered a report and led a discussion on a topic of great import to Conference members.

In the Financial section of this Report are several statements, including G.S.O.'s Income Statements for 1988 and 1989, our Budget for 1990, Income Statements for the Grapevine for 1988 and 1989, its Budget for 1990, Combined Balance Sheets for G.S.O. and Grapevine for 1988 and 1989, plus comparison shortfall presentations for 1988, 1989, and Budget 1990.

Beginning with the 1989 Income Statement, our current formula for allocating income and expenses is to capture them in three major categories: (1) Publishing, (2) General Service Board – Office Expenses, and (3) General Service Board – Other Expenses of the Board.

Income, by category:

A.A.W.S. Publishing reflects the income from literature sales, discounts taken by purchasers, the cost of production of the literature sold, the royalties paid on literature sales, and interest earned. The net of all this is publishing income.

G.S.B. General Fund – Office reflects the contributions received from A.A. groups and members and interest earned on bank accounts in which contributions are held before paying expenses.

G.S.B. General Fund – Other. There is no income in this category. In the year of an International Convention, the net income of the event would appear here.

Expense: The expenses charged against Publishing and the G.S.B. – General Fund are allocated as shown into three cost centers: publishing and two kinds of service expense, separated for historical reasons. This allocation was highly arbitrary in

some cases but the totals are reasonable. If you refer to the note at the bottom of this income statement, it addresses this "allocation."

We have been addressing the issue of this "allocation" of expenses. We have tested the allocation by applying two separate methods of broad-based allocations and have made progress in a third test in using a computerized general ledger application of functional costing. All three of these tests have supported the overall result of the current method. In fact, they all result in supporting the position that the publishing operation would run at a lesser cost and services would attract more expense.

Following is an explanation of each line item of expense under each category.

Salaries: These represent the salaries of all positions or departments as allocated to Publishing or to General Service Board – Office.

Pension: This represents all the costs of our pension and retirement plan, including funding costs, audit and administrative expenses for all employees.

Rent and electricity: We currently occupy five floors at 468 and 470 Park Avenue South, representing 40,100 rentable square feet, and 35,090 usable square feet. The Grapevine occupies about 7,800 rentable square feet. The amounts in this report are exclusive of the Grapevine share.

Box 4-5-9: This includes the costs for writing, editing, printing, and mailing this bimonthly periodical. The income from paid subscriptions has been treated as a reduction of these expenses, as the cost of each subscription sold is greater than the income received.

A.A. Directories: Includes the cost of typesetting, printing, binding, and mailing of the directories given away (one to each group and district committee member). These include the Eastern U.S., Western U.S., Canadian, and International Directories. Those sold are included in Publishing sales and production costs for those sold are charged to cost of products.

Other service material: This represents the cost of producing hundreds of thousands of service pamphlets and material that are distributed free of charge. Some of 1989's distribution included "A.A. at a Glance" (1,000,000 copies), "Message To Teenagers" (800,000 copies), "Where Do I Go From Here?" (700,000 copies) and "Information About A.A." (200,000 copies). (See "Other Service Printing")

Shipping and mailing: This represents two major areas at cost. The major portion, about 80%, are costs related to the shipping of A.A. literature from our New York office and the warehouses in the U.S. and Canada. This includes postage, UPS, warehousing charges, and packaging (material) costs. The balance of the costs are attributable to postage and UPS costs for correspondence, special mailings where the costs have not been charged to the function (such as Box 4-5-9 mailings), and free literature distribution.

A Conference first

For five years, as they moved through the service structure in separate states, Roger Crist (Central Michigan, Panel 39) and Chuck Crist (Oregon, Panel 40) looked forward to the day when they would serve together as delegates. This is the first time in 40 years that two brothers have served as delegate to the same Conference. After their early years growing up in Michigan the brothers had little communication until each found the Fellowship. Although both feel this experience is hard to absorb and articulate there is one thing for certain—they consider it "God's gift."

Other office expenses: The expenses charged against *Publishing* represent furniture and office equipment, loss on bad debts and selling expenses. The expenses charged against *Office Expenses* reflect the costs of stationery and office supplies, telephone, furniture and equipment, and office service and expenses (including maintenance contracts).

Insurance and payroll taxes: This represents the costs of office insurance including fire, liability, inventory, and employee benefit coverages (hospitalization, major medical, and life), and payroll taxes. Again, this covers all employees.

Professional services: This represents the cost of outside auditors and attorneys' fees only. The costs allocated against *Publishing* represent audit expenses; legal costs represent general corporate work such as labor matters; trademark; copyright and royalty matters. The costs allocated to the General Service Board – Other Expenses mostly reflect audit expenses.

Board, committee and staff meetings: Under the *Publishing* column, the amount primarily represents the expenses associated with the monthly A.A.W.S. board meetings (travel, hotel, meals) as well as the expenses for the fourth Central Office/Intergroup Seminar (about \$23,700). The expenses under the *Office* column represent the cost of staff and committee meetings. Costs reflected under *Other* column represent the quarterly meetings of the board of trustees (travel, hotel, meals), as well as unreimbursed expenses related to the travel of trustees.

Writers' fees: These expenses are for projects undertaken each year. Some projects overlap years. Some of the projects reflected in 1989 were: A.A. History book; Daily Reflections book; Spanish edition of the Big Book and other Spanish material, large-print material, and other assorted projects that required writers.

P.I., C.P.C., and travel: The cost under the *Publishing* column represents travel expenses incurred by office personnel connected to office business, such as trips by publishing personnel to printers to inspect major printings; to warehouses to inspect inventories and check out prospective warehouse locations; and to new or prospective printers or manufacturers to ensure quality standards. The costs under the *Other* column reflect the expenses associated with two functions: Cooperation With the Professional Community—most of the expenses are associated with the cost of exhibiting at about 24 health fairs and the maintenance of these professional exhibits and attendance at non-A.A. functions. The costs for the Public Information function vary each year, with the bulk of the costs for 1989 relating to new radio spots.

General Service Conference: Most of the expense represents hotel (rooms, meals), with other key items being delegate travel; the *Box 4-5-9 Early Bird* edition; and writer, production and distribution costs for the *Final Conference Report*, in English, Spanish and French. The balance includes items such as delegate portfolios, manuals, presentations, Advisory Actions and other miscellaneous costs. This is net of delegate area fees and contributions.

EDP systems development: The amount under *Publishing* represents the costs of maintenance, outside programmers, equipment and supplies. The cost under *Other* expenses represents the 1989 portion of the acquisition and implementation of our new computer system.

Regional Forums and other: This represents the costs of Regional Forums, archives, and sundry. Most of this cost was for Regional Forums.

Film projects: This represents the balance of the cost of producing the treatment facilities film.

Leasehold improvements: This represents the cost of leasehold improvements for miscellaneous work of a permanent nature done to the premises.

Self-support project: This amount represents the cost of meetings, distribution of revised D.C.M. kits and a special mailing.

Foreign literature assistance: This is the cost of assistance to other countries to help them get started printing literature in their own country in their own language. Although these are loans to be repaid, the accounting treatment is to expense the loans in the year advanced and to treat repayments as reductions to the expense. The amount shown is net of repayments. In 1989 the A.A.W.S. Board undertook a policy of initiating translations of the Big Book on a systematic basis. In these cases, the entire cost of translating or checking translations, editing, typesetting, production and free distribution may be borne by A.A.W.S.

World Service Meeting: This event occurs every two years, alternating between New York and a delegate country. There is no cost for 1989 as it is an "off year."

Board Expense – International Visits: These amounts reflect the board's involvement in dialogue and visits with A.A. in several Eastern Bloc countries.

Net income: The amounts here reflect the net income or expense by category. The *Total* column summarizes the three categories and reflects the results of the entire General Service Office operation.

The final page in the Financial section highlights the 1990 Budget and illustrates the shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions for 1988 and 1989 and those budgeted for 1990. As you can see, the shortfall for 1988 was \$546,000, compared to the shortfall for 1989 of \$860,000 and a budgeted shortfall for 1990 of \$855,600. The shortfall in 1987 of \$177,000 (not illustrated) was a result of increased contributions in 1987.

This has been primarily a review of the makeup or contents of each line item. Let us not ignore the dollars reflected in these financial statements and, in particular, in the 1990 Budget. It received great scrutiny from the management of your General Service Office, the Salary and Budget Committee of the A.A.W.S. Board, the A.A.W.S. Board, the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee and the General Service Board itself. Underlying the budgeting process is the ever-present question: Is this the best way to spend the A.A. dollar which starts out as the dollar in the basket and comes into G.S.O. in trust?

Edward Gordon, G.S.O. director of finance



NINTH INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

Monday evening Conference members looked forward with enthusiasm as Ruth Jagodzinski, Pacific U.S. regional trustee, introduced reports on A.A.'s upcoming 55th Birthday celebration. Reports were given by the chairperson of the Conference Committee on International Convention (who is also the delegate from the host state) and G.S.O.'s Convention Coordinator.

The Countdown Has Begun!

Let me assure you, the countdown has begun. We are on a roll and counting the days until July when we will all, I hope, be together in Seattle for the 1990 International Convention.

Let me share a few words that my friends on the local committee had to say about the kick-off of volunteers:

At exactly 2 p.m. on October 1, 1989, the doors opened and 2,200 members rushed into the room to the strains of the Overture to the Wizard of Oz. The dimly lit space was dominated by a set depicting the glowing Emerald City of Oz. When the crowd was seated, the lights dimmed further and spotlights highlighted the flag parade as it wound from the back of the huge room up to the stage. Perhaps there were only 14 flags but the impact was terrific. The applause was thunderous as each nation was announced.

The appearance of the Russian flag was particularly dramatic because it symbolized our continuing effort to reach the suffering alcoholic, regardless of boundaries. Those of us who participated in the meeting and those who attended were deeply affected by the staging of the event and by the spirit and enthusiasm that we experienced.

That was indeed a memorable day and the spirit has not dimmed. The local volunteers are hard at work, even as we speak, to ensure that everything they can do to be ready for you will be done. The hats and the vests by which many of the volunteers will be identified are ready now, or will be before you arrive, so that you will know who to call on for help.

The Seattle area continues to enjoy a favorable economic climate. Boeing is hard at work as the largest commercial aircraft manufacturer in the world and Microsoft has continued its winning ways in the computer field. Our port is among the largest container-handling facilities in the world and tourists flock to this most livable city. All is well economically in our city but let me quickly add more. The beauty and majesty of Mount Rainier, which rivals that of Kilimanjaro or Fuji, must be mentioned in any description of the Seattle area. Another attraction is the ability to go from salt water to the ski slopes in one hour. It is indeed a beautiful land and you will be arriving at a beautiful time of year.

The thrill of being part of a throng that we estimate to be more than 50,000 members of the Fellowship and to have this gathering in Seattle is truly a blessing.

We wish for you the time to enjoy our world-class zoo, to take a visit to the colorful Pike Place Market, which is known for its fresh foods and its arts and crafts. Maybe you will have a chance to visit the campuses of one or more of our universities. A ferry ride in the late afternoon will provide you with the opportunity to catch Seattle and Mount Rainier in the glow of one of our spectacular sunsets.

Our major meetings will be held in the Kingdome, home of the Seattle Mariners and the Seattle Seahawks. Other meetings will be held in the new Convention and Trade Center. Further activities will take place at the Seattle Center, a legacy of the World's Fair held in Seattle.

We look forward to seeing you and we welcome you. Do come!

Lonnie Williams, Washington

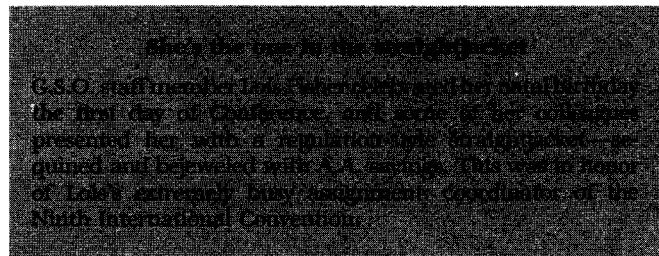
Report/Discussion

Our Ninth International Convention celebrating A.A.'s 55th Birthday has been a work in progress since April 1986 when the 36th General Service Conference recommended that Houston, Seattle and Vancouver be considered for 1990. The trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums and board accepted the recommendation of the site-inspection team and we were on our way to Seattle.

By the end of February we had a total registration of 25,400, which is comparable to the advance registration for Montreal at that time. For planning purposes, we asked for relevant data on the registration forms. Of the total, 73 percent of attendees are A.A. members. By age, those in the 40-55 age group are in the majority but at least 11 A.A.s between 12 and 15 years of age will be there. We will also have a significant number of attendees who are over 65 years of age. By years of sobriety, the largest group is in the 4-10 years category and almost 1,600 (by March 1) had more than 20 years of sobriety. A.A. works! Every state and province will be represented, with 21 percent from California. Of note, 63 percent of attendees will be attending their first International Convention.

Registration figures indicate that this will be our most "international" Convention to date. We expect more than 300 A.A.s and Al-Anons from Mexico and more than 1,000 from overseas—including, for the first time, A.A.s from the U.S.S.R., Rumania and Czechoslovakia. Simultaneous translation for the Big Meetings in the Kingdome will be provided in Spanish, French, German and possibly Italian. There will also be scheduled meetings during the day in those languages. We have received approximately 50 requests for sign-language interpretation and we plan to provide professional interpreters for selected workshops and meetings throughout Friday and Saturday in addition to the Kingdome events.

The process of mailing registration forms began in September and the best laid plans went awry. The intent was to schedule the mailing in stages—overseas, Canada, Western U.S. and Eastern U.S.—and ideally, all would land at approximately the same time to give everyone an equal opportunity for the 4,400 rooms in downtown Seattle. The mailing did not go as planned and we started receiving frantic calls from A.A.s worldwide. In an attempt to be as fair as possible, the registration data processing firm was asked to delay processing until October 16. By that time, thousands of registration forms had reached Box 1990, creating a massive backlog. The result was an unfortunately long lag period between the mailing of a registration form and receiving notification of housing. By the end of December, the rooms in downtown Seattle were gone and people were being assigned housing in the Sea-Tac and Bellevue/Kirkland areas. By February, the Housing Bureau was placing people in Everett and Tacoma and we were looking for additional housing in Bellingham—60 miles north of Seattle. There were some surprises regarding housing. A surprisingly high number of registrants were asking



for two-bedded rooms to accommodate two people. The average room occupancy was 1.9 people rather than 2.3 as experienced in Montreal. In trying to accommodate requests for two-bedded at moderate prices, the Housing Bureau kept reaching further out. At the height of the frenzy, a "happy face" helium balloon mysteriously appeared at the door to my office with the message, "I need a room in downtown Seattle! Hotel with pool, please." To accommodate those housed out of town, we are implementing a shuttle bus system which will be operational July 4 through the end of the Convention.

Five "get-acquainted" dances are scheduled to kick off the Convention on Thursday night, July 5 from 8 p.m. to 11 p.m. Two big bands, a country/western group and music from the '50s, '60s and Top 40 music will all be playing. At midnight on Thursday the A.A. Marathon will begin at the Sheraton Hotel and will run continuously until 8:45 a.m. Sunday.

Workshops, regional alkathons, topic meetings, panels and meetings of special interest will take place Friday and Saturday from 9 a.m.-5 p.m. at the Seattle Center, the Washington State Convention Center and at the Westin, Sheraton and Holiday Inn Crowne Plaza hotels. The big events will take place at the Seattle King County Stadium, known as the Kingdome, where the Flag Ceremony and Big Meeting will take place on Friday night from 8-10 p.m. The Big Show with professional entertainment will be in the Kingdome on Saturday night from 8-10 p.m. We will meet for the last time in the Kingdome on Sunday morning for a spiritual meeting.

In all, more than 250 sessions are planned with approximately 900 participants, not counting the hundreds or thousands who will participate in the three-mile Fun Run scheduled for Sunday morning at 7 a.m. The run will start and finish at Seattle Center.

The schedule includes a Central Office Luncheon hosted by Seattle Intergroup and the Past Delegates/Past Trustees Luncheon hosted by the delegate from Washington and his committee.

As delegates, you have been contacted several times and asked to make suggestions. Your response to our request for minority participants, the names of long-timers planning to attend and suggestions for topic-meeting speakers were terrific and greatly appreciated.

The host committee is unbelievably enthusiastic and well-organized. A Convention of this size would be impossible without strong local support and we feel extremely grateful to Eric B., past Pacific regional trustee, who was appointed to chair the host committee. His chief aides, Denis F. and Burke D., have spent countless hours organizing the approximately 3,000 volunteers who will be greeting you at the airport and be stationed in the lobbies of the hotels to answer questions about restaurants or directions.

Other volunteers will set up and take down thousands of chairs on Kingdome field. Multilingual volunteers will help staff the registration area.

This will be our first International Convention without our beloved Lois Wilson and other giants in our history—Dr. Jack Norris and Milton Maxwell. The board has invited Nell Wing, Bill's secretary for many years and A.A.'s first archivist, to accept the ten millionth copy of the Big Book. In addition, Bob Smith and Sue Windows, Dr. Bob's son and daughter, will be honored, along with Ellie Norris, widow of A.A.'s beloved Dr. Jack, and Charlotte Maxwell, wife of longtime A.A. friend and former chairman of the board, Milton Maxwell. Dennis Manders, our former director of finance, will also be honored.

All of us who are working on the Convention want to do everything we can to make July 5-8 a wonderful and memorable weekend of A.A. sharing.

Lois Fisher, G.S.O. staff

SELF-SUPPORT

Wednesday afternoon's presentations began with the topic of self-support. Harold Greene, general service trustee, moderated the session.

An Introduction

Storm clouds gathered in the summer of 1985 when the general manager of G.S.O. determined that income from A.A.W.S., Inc. was increasingly used to support group services. Further, A.A.W.S. publishing income came from literature sales to outside organizations such as Hazelden, CompCare and some universities as well as to the A.A. groups. This meant that outside entities were contributing to the operation of the General Service Board.

In 1985, 30 percent of our literature was sold to nonmember groups yet, because of our pricing policy, these sales were responsible for over 45 percent of net income from publishing. If the trend continued, by 1991 we could expect this amount to increase to 65 percent of net income. The treasurer of the General Service Board undertook an inquiry to determine how to restore the balance between sales to outsiders and sales to groups. Additionally, the trail of funds to group services needed further identification.

It became apparent that we were in violation of the Seventh Tradition, which states, "Every A.A. group ought to be fully self-supporting, declining outside contributions."

An additional problem came to light regarding the Sixth Tradition and our affiliation with outside entities. If G.S.O. became dependent on outside income, changes in outside entities might affect funding for our service work. For example, in 1987 the Hazelden Foundation cancelled a \$300,000 order, which created a shortfall in the A.A.W.S. budget.

General Service Board chairman Gordon Patrick developed a five-year project aimed at the board's self-support and compliance with our Traditions. This project became known as "The Challenge of the Seventh Tradition" under the direction of the Self-support Committee.

It was clear that we needed to communicate the problem to the Fellowship through our service structure. It was necessary to develop a communications network through the D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s that would lead us to the groups. We focused on the D.C.M. and tried to incorporate group participation within the service structure. This strategy would increase the number of groups participating in the service structure and consequently increase contributions without direct solicitation.

A self-support workbook and self-support posters were developed. We made suggestions to the G.S.R.s and looked for ideas on how to increase group participation in the service structure. All of these actions had an extremely positive effect and contributions increased dramatically.

At that time we considered reducing literature costs due to increased contributions. This idea was met with considerable favor by all entities, including A.A.W.S. and the trustees' Finance Committee. A decision to proceed was made at that point.

The following presentations will address changes that have come about since then.

Harold Greene, general service trustee

1986 to the Present

In March of 1986 members of the A.A.W.S. Board and staff met to define the details required to achieve the self-support goal. The tasks were 1) to provide a new five-year financial forecast;

2) to consider assignment of expenses to various cost centers and to evaluate how these changes would affect the budget forecast; and 3) to review all material relating to self-support.

Three months later, in June 1986, the general objectives of the self-support project were outlined. These included need, solution, theme and issues. In addition, the self-support project became the Self-support Committee, which met monthly.

By the end of 1986, self-support articles began to appear in *Bar* 4-5-9. The articles emphasized the Seventh Tradition and stated that services should be financed by contributions, not literature sales. Subsequent articles addressed the "power of the purse," which keeps authority in the hands of the groups.

During 1987 the Self-support Committee was hard at work. The Fellowship responded with a 37 percent increase in contributions and literature prices were subsequently reduced twice during the year. It appeared that the problem of self-support was solved and that literature profits were no longer necessary.

In 1988, however, the increase in contributions began to level off. The number of groups contributing also began to drop. Contributions for the full year were 6.8 percent over those of 1987 but the number of contributing groups dropped one percent over the 1987 figure. Expenses for services continued to rise as expected, yet publishing income was unavailable due to the decrease in literature prices.

The Self-support Committee realized that the huge increase in contributions in 1987 occurred because the Fellowship thought we were in financial trouble. We had asked for more money for all the right reasons but the message was not clear.

In 1989 we tried various messages in hopes of achieving a clear understanding of self-support. Quarterly letters and posters emphasized self-support. Trustees and directors attempted to reinforce the message at Regional Forums.

Contributions were not declining, which compounded the confusion. The *percentage increase* in contributions was declining while *expenses* continued to increase. To put it more simply, expenses were increasing at a faster rate than income.

We were now using the Reserve Fund to cover the excess expenses. We no longer had publishing income to cover the difference between contributions and service expense.

In late 1989 the trustees' Finance Committee and the A.A.W.S. Board agreed to raise literature prices to previous levels to cover the increased expenses. The A.A.W.S. Board also decided to abandon the five-year plan to be self-supporting but would continue the effort over a longer period. To date the Self-support Committee continues to meet and work toward that goal.

The effort throughout the service structure to fully support G.S.O. through contributions and thus reduce and then eliminate literature profits has highlighted broader needs in the Fellowship. Service workers are faced with compelling challenges generated by the welcome growth of our Fellowship to international proportions. Growth in the Eastern Bloc countries that were once thought to be inaccessible illustrates that we are custodians of a program that provides an answer around the world.

Hugh Freyer, A.A.W.S. director

The Need for a Simple Message

One of my favorite quotes is Dr. Bob telling Bill Wilson, "Let's not louse this up. Let's remember to keep it simple."

I am afraid that in the past, those of us on the Self-support Committee have occasionally forgotten this. In talking today about going forward I will try to keep it simple.

First of all, we have attempted to keep our participation in this presentation brief so that you may share your thoughts,

comments and suggestions on this subject. Probably no topic discussed in the past year at A.A.W.S. has generated as much talk as self-support. It is clear to me that we have sent out confusing messages to the Fellowship and this is an attempt to clear up some of the confusion.

The A.A.W.S. Board has adopted the Self-support Committee's recommendations. Following are highlights of these recommendations.

- A.A.W.S. reaffirms self-support as a worthy goal but probably one that will not be achieved within the original five-year projection.
- A.A.W.S. will continue to strive to become fully self-supporting, recognizing that increased services required by our growing, changing Fellowship must not be compromised.
- A.A.W.S. reserves the right to use income derived from publishing to fund these services whenever contributions fail to do so.
- A.A.W.S. openly and honestly admits that we miscalculated when we prematurely dropped literature prices and overestimated the amount of contributions we expected to receive in 1989.
- A.A.W.S. believes that we are on firm financial footing in 1990.
- A.A.W.S. will continue to move forward to make the total operation of A.A. fully self-supporting through our own contributions.

A.A.W.S. director Jean Smith gave us some very sound advice at our last meeting. Jean said, "People don't give if they don't know you're there. People don't give if you don't ask, or to put it another way, if you don't ask, the answer is always 'no.' We need a general, simple message that everyone can relate and respond to."

I think the first two points are clear. We need your help in letting members know we are here and we need their support. Let me briefly expand on the third point—the need for a simple message.

We at A.A.W.S. were once discussing 16 different suggestions and messages to send out to the Fellowship. I think we can reduce these to two. First, we must continue to strive to raise the participation of group support. In 1989, only 56.2 percent of all groups contributed. Just raising that participation 10 points would probably eliminate all the problems we currently have about money. We need your support in this effort. Second, we should have one simple message. I would suggest that if in 1990 we just concentrated on the Birthday Plan, which I understand is the cornerstone of the Oklahoma success, we would achieve more than we would by sending out 16 different messages.

We do not have to reinvent the wheel. The Birthday Plan works. Wherever it is pushed, members respond. If in 1991, another type of appeal works, we should consider doing it.

However, we would like to hear from you. Please share with us your plans, comments, criticism, questions on this extremely important topic.

I began by quoting Dr. Bob and I would like to end by quoting the Declaration of Responsibility that was adopted by the 1965 International Convention in Toronto. "I am responsible . . . When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible."

The hand of A.A. that originally stretched from Ohio to New York and then throughout the country and across most parts of the world is now literally reaching out for help in the Soviet Union, Poland, Romania, Czechoslovakia and all of Eastern Europe. It takes money to carry the message to these places and I want us to carry the message there. I hope you do also.

Michael McPherson, A.A.W.S. director

THE GENERAL SERVICE TRUSTEE

Following Wednesday afternoon's Panel 40 delegate's report on area service highlights, moderator Joan Jackson, Class A trustee, moderated a session on the general service trustee.

Time for Reassessment?

The general service trustee is a familiar topic to many of us, particularly over the last couple of years. Time for reassessment? Seems to me that we have assessed, examined, taken apart, put back together and reassessed this trustee position until I'm not sure there's much more I care to say, or could find to say. Actually, Bill [Croke] should have given his presentation first, to explain about the role. However, since we've all had a little background recently, I am going to take the somewhat dangerous position of assuming that we are all fairly knowledgeable about the words that have already been printed about the general service trustee.

Rather than use quotes or explain official or unofficial positions, or even interpret someone else's views, I decided to share my observations and my opinions about who and what these general service trustees are and how they serve us.

I have had four years and a total of 16 General Service Board meetings and 24 A.A.W.S. meetings in which to do this—accumulate these observations and opinions, that is.

First and foremost, no matter what type of trustee we are, Class A, Class B (regional, general service trustee and two at-large trustees), we are serving A.A. as a whole, not just a region, a country, or part of our organization. Serving the Fellowship as a whole may be a little easier or more comfortable for the regionals and two at-large trustees. Usually, we have had the benefit of hearing many voices—from our home group and our district to our area and region—because most of us have come up through “the process.” My observation of this is that the more successful survivors have learned that it is more blessed to listen than to speak.

We have four general service trustees, two on A.A.W.S. and two on the Grapevine. Where do our general service trustees come from? Candidates are usually but not necessarily directors of both corporate boards. However, not all directors become trustees. As directors, we are also known as nontrustee directors. Those of us who serve on either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine boards are legally known as corporate board directors, whether we're trustees or not. Directors are chosen by the boards for their professional backgrounds.

For the Grapevine, professional backgrounds for potential directors may include finance, and more often, publishing, writing and editing, which are all skills needed to direct a monthly publication. For A.A.W.S., directors are concerned with publishing our books and literature and operating our G.S.O. We may need to have expertise in public relations, publishing, personnel, administration, and of course, financial skills.

To use current examples, we currently have one general service trustee who has a public relations, finance and marketing background on the Grapevine board and we also have one trustee on the same board who is a CPA. Similarly, on the A.A.W.S. corporate board we have one trustee whose background includes administrative and personnel experience and one trustee who has a background in public relations, business administration and marketing.

Two of the three directors (nontrustee) on the A.A.W.S. board currently have strong financial backgrounds, and therein lies the balance. Directors and general service trustees who have specific professional expertise are balanced by two regionals, one G.S.O. staff member and the general manager. The G.S.O. staff member

and the general manager may have appropriate professional backgrounds and generally possess lots of what I call “A.A. process,” which is expertise in the A.A. service structure. It is hoped that their skills include the ability to perceive how the Fellowship will perceive things, both at the grassroots and service levels. However, this last ability is not a requirement for their positions.

Let's discuss now the little-known and little-discussed aspect of filling this position. I'll use my friend Bill as an example. However, what I am about to say is true of all general service trustees. The A.A.W.S. Board meets once a month and the Grapevine Board meets eight to nine times a year. For a general service trustee, over a four-year period, that comes to 48 monthly meetings. This excludes subcommittee meetings of the board, and for example, the A.A.W.S. Board has three or four subcommittees. This meeting amount also excludes subcommittees of a trustee committee, such as those of P.I., C.P.C., and Literature. Directors and general service trustees serve on three trustee committees and trustees may chair one of these.

Let's get back to Bill. He was a director on the A.A.W.S. Board for three years prior to his election to general service trustee. Add another 36 monthly meetings to the 48 I've already discussed, and the total is 84. That's an incredible commitment.

Delegates, you know something about time commitments and you probably travel around your area a lot as well. How about six, seven, or eight years of it? That's what we ask of a general service trustee—and I haven't even counted the Regional Forums, central office seminars and other board activities. I served on A.A.W.S. for two years. As chairman of A.A.W.S. for one of those two years, Bill would always call for input on the agenda, background information and opinions each month. In addition, impromptu meetings are held which directors or general service trustees attend to carry out their duties and fulfill the requests of the whole General Service Board.

In closing, I will say that it is my opinion, and hopefully that of others, too, that the balance of professional expertise brought by the general service trustees and the directors is invaluable. We would be severely challenged were we forced to operate without it. I think, however, that it makes little difference where some of them live, and I say “some of them” because financial prudence would preclude all members coming from “out there.”

The backgrounds, professions and expertise that we need can be found in or around many metropolitan areas and it might even add another dimension to have a general service trustee who lives and works on the West Coast, in middle America or in Canada.

After the background is examined, the key to choosing the general service trustee is in their level of interest, their ability to work with others and above all, in their commitment to fulfilling the position, especially to fulfilling the required time commitment.

Some people may think that the regionals could fill these positions. I think not. Do we need to break down or to restructure our larger, more populated regions? Maybe, but more or different regions is a separate topic. We regionals are not chosen for our education, professional background or any expertise other than our apparent ability to communicate in a trustworthy manner with the Fellowship, and on our past record as trusted servants for A.A.s in a particular region.

So, time for reassessment? Other than recognizing that on occasion, directors and general service trustees can be found outside the New York area, and therefore, would allow us to choose the best, no! You and I and our Fellowship need them just as they are for the continued growth and welfare of A.A.

Ruth Jagodzinski, Pacific U.S. regional trustee

A Key Element of the Service Structure

"Bill had a sound reason for this, and one that has worked well over the years."

My name is Bill Croke and I have had the privilege of serving as a general service trustee since 1986.

The "sound reason" referred to in that quote, of course, is from page 118 of the *A.A. Service Manual* and has to do with general service trustees—how they are elected, why they are not like other Class B trustees, and why they must come from an area reasonably close to New York.

Well, the office *is* here in New York—the two corporations are here, so is it not reasonable to expect that some of our trustees would be here in New York as well?

Some say no. They say general service trustees should come from anywhere in North America. From Seattle or Spokane. From Sarasota or Saskatchewan. In theory, this might sound democratic. Why not open up all the jobs in A.A. to any one of us, from anywhere? But is it practical?

The office is here (I know, I was over there just the other day—twice in fact). The two corporate boards are headquartered here. And, of course, I don't have to tell you about the growth of our Fellowship, the challenging times we are now entering, etc. A company the size of A.A.—any company—produces quite a tremendous volume of work, as I'm sure you can imagine.

Well, we've got a staff and a good one, too. But a quick look at the numbers shows that the growth of our Fellowship has far out-paced the growth of the staff, e.g., from 1974 to 1989, the number of staff people at G.S.O. went from nine to 11 (plus one Spanish Services coordinator), an increase of 33 percent. The number of A.A. groups, however, grew 104 percent, or *five times* that rate. During the same period, membership was up 177 percent and literature pieces distributed or sold were up 181 percent, *six times the growth in the size of the staff*.

As you know, there are 21 trustees on the General Service Board. Back in 1962, when Bill first recommended sweeping changes to the board, 12 of the then 15 trustees were from New York (when they had a screw-up, you *knew* it was New York). But today, A.A.W.S., which represents over 90 percent of the total volume that we generate, has two general service trustees on the board, one of whom lives in Washington, D.C. So, in fact, there is really only one general service trustee (out of a total of 21) who is actually here in New York and available to A.A.W.S. on a day to day basis. Do we really want to make that zero?

Though I hate to have to do it—because it sort of sounds like I'm having to defend something which should need no defense—let me take a moment and give you a quick look at a typical quarter in the life of a general service trustee (in this instance, the fourth quarter, 1989): Attended three A.A.W.S. meetings at G.S.O.; attended three self-support meetings at G.S.O.; attended four 1990 budget planning meetings at G.S.O.; attended two General Service Board Audit Committee meetings at G.S.O.; attended two Literature Committee meetings and four Literature subcommittee meetings at G.S.O.; attended two real estate planning meetings at G.S.O. (our lease is up in 1991); interviewed five A.A.W.S. director candidates at various locations around New York, including G.S.O.; and last, but not least, attended one Regional Forum in Kansas.

I get tired thinking about it. And that doesn't include a lunch here and there or any of the many phone conversations we have, not only back and forth with the office, but also with other trustees. Because a general service trustee's job cuts two ways. On the one hand, we are nearby because the office and the corporations are here. But we also represent the other trustees, who are *not here*.

So to those who say, "I don't want to change the role of general service trustees; I just want to open it up so anyone from anywhere can be one," I have to ask: Do you really believe the role as I described it would not change if a general service trustee were from Seattle? If you say general service trustees can come from anywhere, you are in fact talking about *changing their role*. I know. I am a general service trustee.

Also, if you opened it up so general service trustees could come from anywhere, you'd be spending substantial additional money in the process. For example, if I had lived in Spokane, Washington, during the fourth quarter just past, and my service schedule was as I described it, the monetary cost on an annualized basis to truck me back and forth would have exceeded the total increase in group contributions projected for the full year 1990 from the entire Fellowship. Money which, in my opinion, would have been spent unnecessarily.

To those who I've heard say, "Let's just make the change. The boards will only choose people from nearby anyway," again, I would have to ask: Why in the world would you make such a change in the first place?

I have a couple of other concerns I'd like to share with you:

1. I trust and hope that this whole issue has not taken on a life of its own: "You know, they didn't do it last time." "Well, let's make 'em do it this time." I hope that you will take the time to review all the work that's been done in an effort to fully inform you on this issue and that you—each of you—singly and separately—will then judge it *on its merits*.

2. Some also say, "I only want the best." I'm sorry, but that strikes me as a cop-out if I ever heard one (you don't think Bill wanted the best?). In any event, again, I hope that *you* will look at this issue in terms of its *real impact*.

So, where am I coming from on this whole thing? Silly question. But seriously, I honestly want what's going to help us best serve our membership and to carry A.A.'s message of hope to as many still-suffering alcoholics as we possibly can. And I truly believe the way we will best be able to accomplish that is to maintain the *minimal* general service trustee presence in New York that we presently have.

In my travels this past year, I've come to the conclusion that a great many folks out there really are *not aware* of what a general service trustee does back here. Just like I don't know what it's really like to be a D.C.M. in Kansas (at least, I didn't until I attended their area assembly last month). But this lack of awareness isn't really surprising. Most of the trustees only get in here once a quarter. And I'd guess most of the rest of you get here even less than that. Still, I'd have to say, "If *you* don't know enough about us, that's *our* fault." And like many of the problems I've seen in A.A. service, better communication is usually going to solve it. The more we share, the more openness we try to introduce (as Mike Alexander has been doing this past year) the fewer our problems and misunderstandings are going to be.

In closing, let me say that I believe we presently have a structure on our General Service Board that is delicate in this balance, but which has genius at its roots. And I feel very strongly that we should not disturb that delicate balance. As Dr. Jack Norris, esteemed past chairman of the General Service Board, said: "The policy of having four general service trustees has been very important to the prudent stewardship of the Fellowship—and particularly the General Service Office." Like you, I'm sure, I find a great deal of support for my feelings on this issue in our Concepts. But Bill's words in Concept VI struck me as particularly relevant to this moment in our history. Let me quote: "... all of our present arrangements, including the status of A.A.'s Trustees, are based on a great amount of experience, which it is the purpose of these writings to make clear. When this is done, we

shall not be hampered later on by such a lack of understanding that we could be tempted into hasty or unwise amendments.” (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service, p. 27)

So let's all do our homework. Read all that stuff the Nominating Committee sent you. And then—and most importantly—vote your conscience on this issue. Do what you think is going to best help us achieve our primary purpose—to carry A.A.'s message of hope to still-suffering alcoholics *everywhere*. And to share this wonderful gift of sobriety that we are all so fortunate to have been given.

Bill Croke, general service trustee

SPONSORSHIP

Following the Friday afternoon coffee break, moderator John Quinn, trustee-at-large/U.S., introduced three Panel 39 delegates who gave presentations on Sponsorship.

... In Recovery

By May 13, 1976, I had lost all my forces. Overburdened by a chronic dependance on alcohol and crushed with pain, I had become indigent. Finally, after all these years of despair, empty-handedness and total despondency, I felt the “soul poverty” that seems to be the first condition for God's love.

A man whose name was Charles, if I remember well, had received the grace of God through the A.A. Fellowship seven or eight years before. He could then transmit what he had received. Charles has been my tacit sponsor. He didn't limit himself to showing me the A.A. path because I already knew it. For two years I was reconditioning in any way that I could between two drunks, my body and my spirit.

Charles listened to me, followed me and gave me his time. He knew how to plunge into my alcoholic wounds. Charles spoke to my heart. He didn't teach me anything; instead he devoted to me the part of himself that had been sanctified by God, and that part was his dependance on alcohol. He used to say that “the rest is accessory to the fundamental problem.”

Charles showed me the terrible diagnosis of “this mental obsession doubled by a physical allergy that forces us to consume until madness or death come.” He recommended that I buy the Big Book and he imperceptibly guided me to the spiritual principles. He helped me make the first steps toward turning my problem and my life over to a power greater than myself. After approximately two months of close follow up, Charles silently stepped out of my path.

Fourteen years later I am at the General Service Conference and close to the heart of our beloved Fellowship. Yet I feel that I am no model in the subject of sponsorship in recovery.

I received much more than I can ever give back. In fact, beyond taking the Fourth and Fifth Steps under the benevolent shield of a sponsor chosen specifically for that purpose, my life in A.A. is devoted to service and this includes sponsorship activities. Everything revolves around A.A. services.

Sometimes I have the impression that, in a gesture of love, my area elected me its delegate and continues to exercise sponsoring relations with me. A great deal of solicitude is directed toward me.

My recovery was fulfilled under the benevolent care of members who guided and supported me with tolerance on my path. My path was realized through taking action and accomplishing tasks at the group level and in other A.A. situations. As the Steps made more and more sense to me, I helped attract certain newcomers to service work.

Isn't that the essence of our Fellowship? My reason for living my life according to the A.A. principles is manifest in my actions. How can I dissociate sponsorship in recovery from the service path or rather, from the path that leads to serving our A.A. brothers and sisters?

Dr. Bob said that those who pass by service pass by the most beautiful gift A.A. could give. His wife, Anne, added that faith without works is a dead faith.

Isn't sponsorship, then, the path that leads to providing true service? Isn't this the path to be considered a privilege by our members? Isn't it through this path that we may perceive the interior poverty that allows us to reach God and happiness?

Serge Filion, Northeast Quebec

... For Service

What I share with you are examples of my service experiences. Most of us can probably look back to when we first became involved in service, when someone simply drew us in by their own example.

I've been fortunate since I came into Alcoholics Anonymous because people have taken time to share with me the idea that there is more to this wonderful Fellowship than just recovery. Service is a vital link to our future.

I remember one of my first A.A. meetings. I was sitting in my home group in Cassville, Missouri and just a few minutes before the meeting began a man walked through our doors carrying a briefcase. I knew instantly that we had an important visitor. This cat was definitely different than most of us in Cassville at that time. He had a sparkle in his eyes that most of us didn't have. He even walked and talked differently. I was sure I had met the president of Alcoholics Anonymous and I was truly impressed.

A short time later I learned that this guy was called a D.C.M. I really didn't know what that meant but I was still impressed. He had just stopped by our group to see how we were doing and to pass on some information. He was simply leading by his own example.

Then, a few years later, this D.C.M. became the delegate in our area. He was giving a report of some kind at an area assembly and I truthfully don't remember but one thing he said. It was simply this, that there's no “they” out there, just “us,” and that it was up to us to be the caretakers of this Fellowship. I hope all of us will remember those simple words. Again, this same man had sponsored someone through his own example without even knowing it.



Another example comes from a man I met in Arkansas. I lived on the Missouri-Arkansas border then, so I attended several meetings in Arkansas early in my sobriety. One little fellow always caught my attention because it seemed like people were always asking him questions. Everyone just seemed to like to hang around him. I got curious myself and started hanging around him too. I sure didn't want anyone else to know something that I didn't know.

In a short time his involvement and dedication to service work started rubbing off on me. It didn't take long to see that service work was an important part of this gentleman's sobriety. Before long I asked this man to be my sponsor. Even today he's still up to his eyeballs in service work. He's still sponsoring by his own example.

Whether it is sponsoring in recovery or sponsoring in service work, our own example sets the trend for those who follow us. Sometimes we may be sponsoring someone and not even realize it. What are we like when we go home from one of our area assemblies? What will we be like when we go home from the Conference this year? I hope we'll let people see by our own actions what service work has done for our own sobriety.

Bill W. and Dr. Bob have helped sponsor everyone here this week. They shared the importance of service work with those who came before us and those folks, in turn, shared its importance with us. Now it's our turn to pass it on. I hope we will. Every A.A. member who is involved in service should be a service sponsor. All we need to do is to let people know how important service work has been to us. Being a service sponsor isn't that tough. You simply sponsor by your own example.

John Sullivan, Missouri (Western)

... For Unity

As a member of Alcoholics Anonymous I am given the opportunity to sponsor a number of people. As a delegate I have had the opportunity to share with G.S.R.s throughout our area and to emphasize the importance of the home group, self-support and communication. In district meetings, district workshops and area workshops, we discuss responsibilities at the group, district, area and G.S.O. levels. I truly believe that the real strength of our Fellowship lies in a loving God as He expresses Himself through our informed group conscience. In electing G.S.R.s, we must remember that they are the future D.C.M.s, delegates and trustees.



I have a sponsor who leads by example and who lives by and practices all the principles of our Fellowship, including the Steps and Traditions. She reminds me to do the job I have been asked to do and to allow others the opportunity to fulfill their responsibilities. I am grateful for the lady who exemplifies, for me, "Sponsorship for Unity."

During my first year in Alcoholics Anonymous, I found a home group and a sponsor. I began learning about recovery through the Steps. Somewhere toward the end of my second year of sobriety, I was elected G.S.R. and had to be taught about unity and service.

Unity means "joined for a purpose." It does not mean we all have to agree on everything without conflict or difference of opinion. Sponsors and sponsees are joined for the purpose of helping each other stay sober another day. As members of groups, we join together for the purpose of providing a meeting of Alcoholics Anonymous for those who come after us. As group members, sponsors, G.S.R.s, delegates, trustees, directors and G.S.O. staff, we are all united to assure the future of Alcoholics Anonymous.

At my first assembly I began to learn that my home group was but a part of the greater whole. There were people from all over the state working together for the good of Alcoholics Anonymous. We did not agree on everything that came up at that assembly but I heard about "substantial unanimity" and that the minority was given the opportunity to speak. Even though everyone did not agree, I left with the feeling that love and service were true expressions of unity.

My first General Service Conference truly exemplified unity for me. What an awesome experience it was to serve with 90 delegates from all over the United States and Canada for the common good of Alcoholics Anonymous. My visit to the General Service Office, where I saw the hub from which information is disseminated, was truly inspiring. Of special note was my visit to the office of Bill Wilson, who devoted years of his life in developing our basic principles and our basic text. In reflecting on that experience, it occurred to me that here was a person who, probably more than any other, was responsible for getting across the message that through sponsorship we have unity. I believe unity can be achieved when any two or more are joined together for a purpose.

My sponsor continues to share her experience, strength and hope with me on the Traditions and to explain that they are part of the principles I need to use on a daily basis. Our Traditions are the glue that holds our Fellowship together.

As a sponsor I try to lead by example as I use the Twelve Traditions in all areas of my life. I have to take into consideration what's best for my entire family instead of just what I want. I must recognize that as an individual I must be self-supporting.

I sponsor a young woman whose lifestyle, personal relationships, career choices, age and economic status are entirely different from mine. Using the Traditions on a personal level helps me as I share my experience, strength and hope with those I sponsor to help them become aware that we are joined together to make sure Alcoholics Anonymous is there for those who come after us.

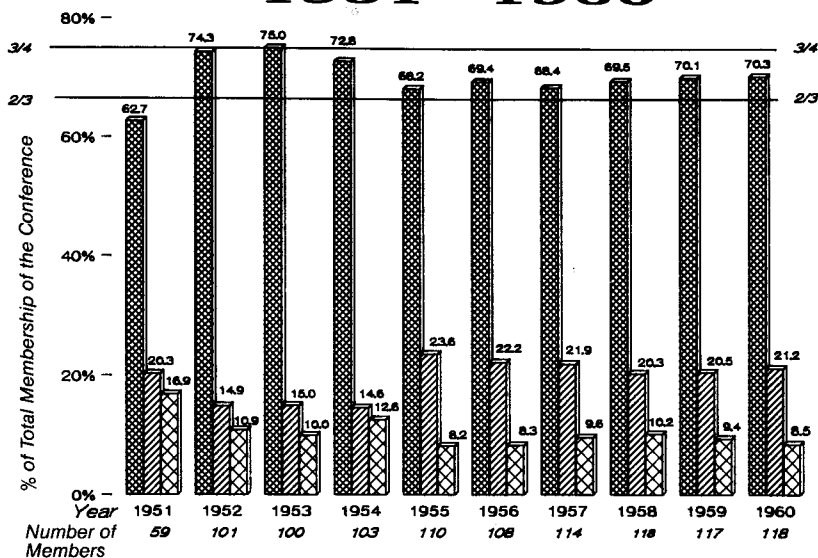
"... Under threats of disunity and collapse, world-wide unity and brotherhood have been forged. In the course of this experience we have evolved a set of traditional principles by which we live and work together and relate ourselves as a fellowship to the world around us." (*A.A. Comes of Age*, p. 79). We can only stay sober by placing our common welfare first.

"Sponsorship for Unity" is summed up in the first words of our First Step and First Tradition—"We" and "Our."

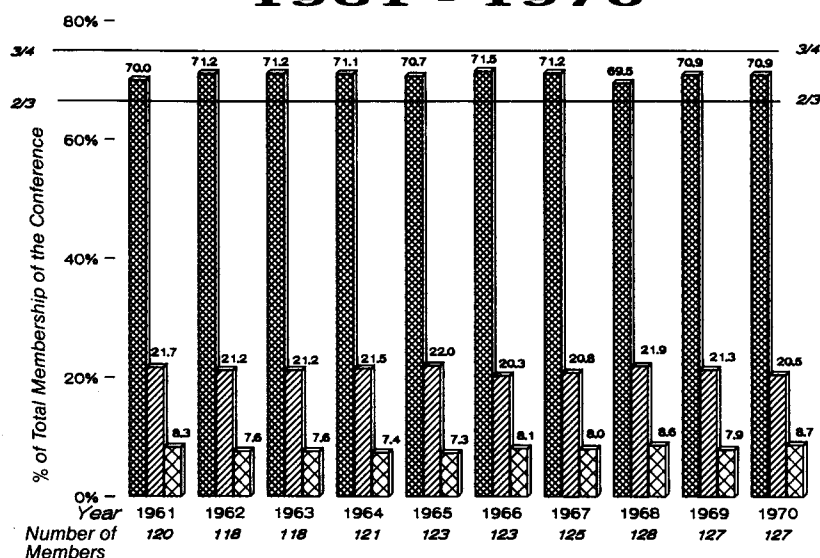
Judy Mize, North Carolina/Bermuda

CONFERENCE MEMBERSHIP – 1951 to 1990

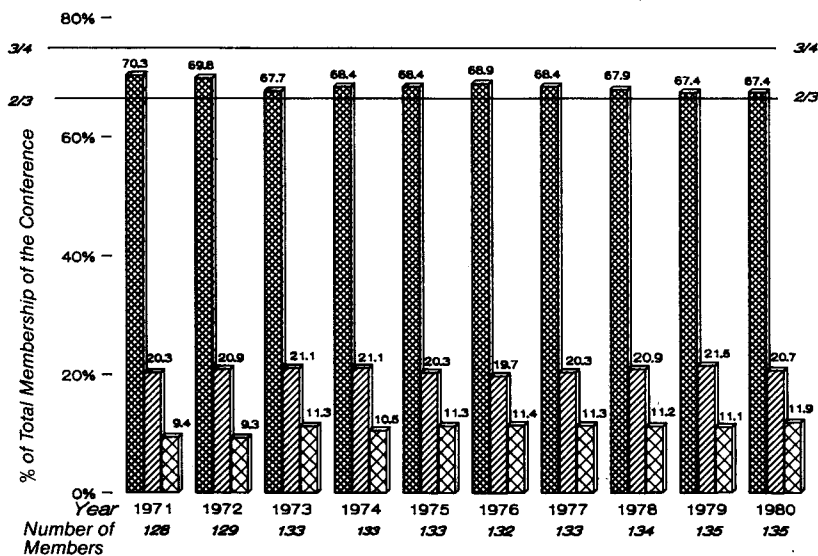
1951 - 1960



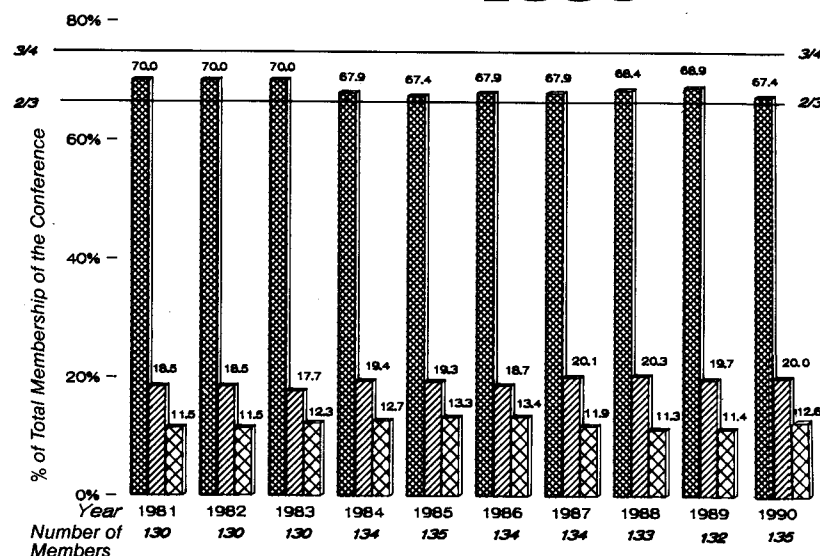
1961 - 1970



1971 - 1980



1981 - 1990



PERCENTAGE OF DELEGATES, BOARDS, STAFFS



Delegates



Boards



Staffs

Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: Finances of the General Service Office got a lot of attention from the trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous in the past year. Two years ago the price of A.A. literature was reduced by about 25 percent. That caused a deficit for the General Service Office in 1988 and another deficit in 1989.

To cover the deficits, the trustees authorized the withdrawal of \$760,000 from the General Reserve Fund in 1988 and \$1,300,000 in 1989. As a result, the General Reserve Fund at the end of 1989 stood at \$6,463,000, equal to about 7.9 months of operating expenses of the General Service Office.

Faced with these facts, the trustees took the only action they could take: they directed that the price of A.A. literature be increased. That has been done.

The trustees did much more. They took a good hard look at the proposed General Service Office budget for 1990. For the first time in memory the budget was examined by the trustees' Finance Committee, and virtually by all of the trustees, on a line-by-line basis. The aim was to eliminate any expense that could be safely excluded without diminishing the services rendered by the General Service Office.

The budget process is still under review at this writing. A revised budget will be presented to the trustees during Conference week for their approval. In the interim, trustees have appointed an Audit Committee to conduct a review of General Service Office practices. Through that process the trustees are continuing to search for ways to make the General Service Office ever more efficient, effective and businesslike. The computer system, that is about to start up, will contribute significantly to that effort.

The trustees are also continuing to seek ways of achieving closer cooperation with all Conference members throughout the Conference year. In that respect, delegates and trustees attending Regional Forums are convening for informal sharing sessions; the chairpersons of several Conference committees attended the General Service Board weekend last January; minutes of General Service Board meetings are being sent to delegates who request them; trustees are encouraged to communicate with delegates, staff members and directors whenever it seems appropriate to do so in terms of Conference matters; and a policy of openness is being observed and fostered at all levels of the General Service Office.

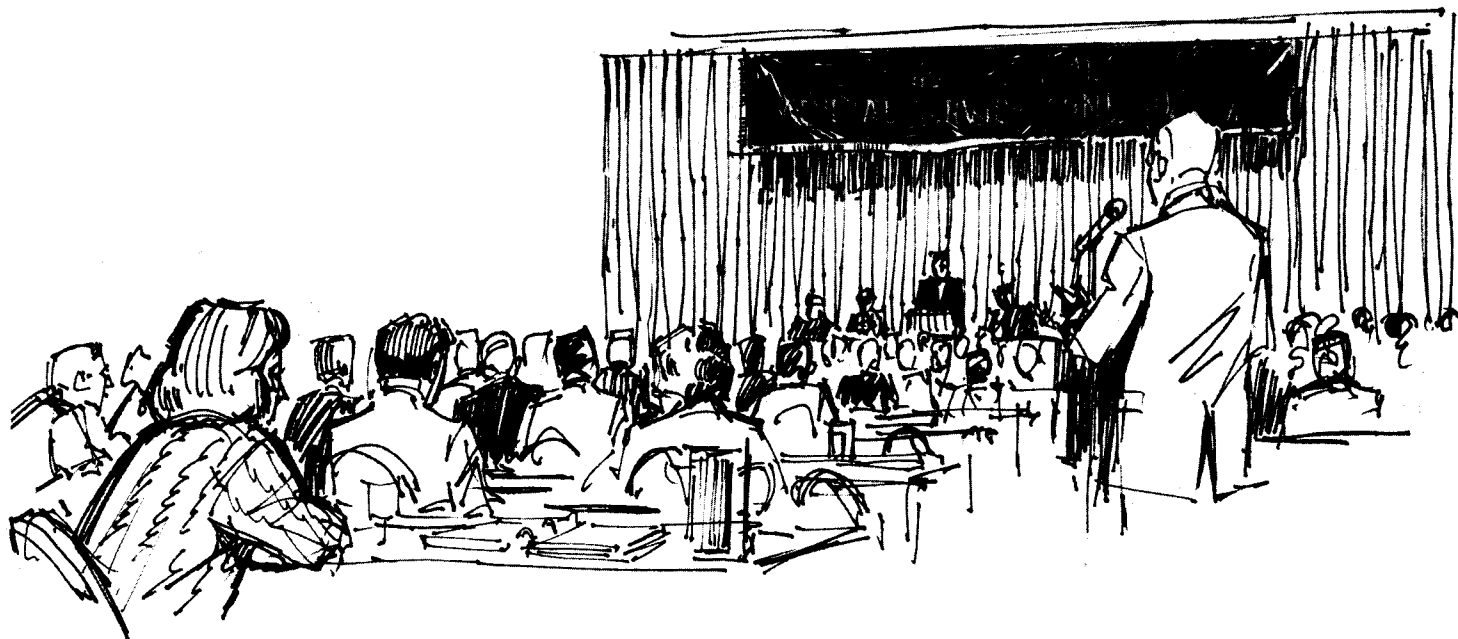
In their work last year, the trustees were mindful of international political developments that were springing up all over the place. The quest for freedom that has dominated world affairs in the past twelve months has profound implications for Alcoholics Anonymous. Our Fellowship is on the threshold of worldwide service that was just a dream only a few years ago.

Since we last met, representatives of the General Service Office, in the discharge of their responsibilities, have visited Chile, Czechoslovakia, England, Germany, Hungary, Italy, Mexico and Poland. Last year the Big Book and the Twelve and Twelve were translated into Russian and Czech; and the Big Book will be available shortly in Hungarian. Additionally, translations are underway in Arabic, Chinese, Turkish, Hebrew, Polish and Hindi.

The pace of international work at the General Service Office is quickening and expanding. This should be gratifying to all members of A.A. for, in keeping with our stated mission, the hand of A.A. should reach out to all alcoholics who may need it, wherever they may be.

A.A. has been thrust into world prominence by events over which it has no control and, by those events, has been presented with responsibilities it cannot ignore. That development brings special significance to this Conference year. Without question, the members of this Conference have a big job ahead of them in the next twelve months. With the grace of God that job will be well done.

Michael Alexander, chairperson



A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: A.A. World Services, Inc. is, in effect, a wholly owned subsidiary of the General Service Board with the delegated responsibility to maintain oversight of the General Service Office. We meet monthly; review budgets, expenditures, and salary policy; establish prices for literature and other materials; approve or disapprove requests from outsiders and A.A. members to reprint our copyrighted literature; discuss matters of G.S.O. administration and publishing operations, and such other business as may arise from time to time. There are nine A.A.W.S. directors. Four are trustees, including two regional trustees; three are nontrustee directors; one is the G.S.O. general manager; and one is the staff coordinator. Also attending our meetings, but not voting, are other G.S.O. staff members, the director of finance, the controller, assistant controller/business administrator, the services director, the publications director, the secretary, and the recording secretary. In addition, a Grapevine staff member is usually present.

The operating departments (Publishing, Finance, Data Processing and Business Administration) report to the director of finance, as does the director of human resources. The A.A. staff, Stenographic/Clerical Department, as well as Archives, all report to the services director.

During 1989 the A.A.W.S. Board met 12 times. The following items of significance are highlighted:

- John Bragg tendered his resignation effective June 28, 1989. Wayne Parks reported for work at G.S.O. on January 17. He assumed the position of general manager on April 3, and president of the A.A.W.S. Board on June 29.
- The 1989 budget was examined and approved in January 1989. It was recommended that \$500,000 be moved down from the Reserve Fund to cover the operating capital required during 1989.
- The total budget projected a contributions increase of 7% and an expense increase of approximately 10.8%, creating a shortfall of contributions compared to service expenses. We transferred \$285,000 to the General Fund to cover deficits remaining after the General Fund had received \$760,000 from the Reserve Fund (in 1988) for the year ended December 31, 1988.
- After reviewing the projected cash position through the end of May 1989, which forecast a negative cash position, we authorized a request to the trustees' Finance Committee to draw up to \$250,000 from the Reserve Fund, if necessary.
- We recommended to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee mid-year budget revisions totaling \$144,000. The adjustments consisted of \$54,200 in operating additions, \$99,200 in operating reductions, and \$189,000 in additional computer acquisition expense.
- We requested authority from the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee to draw up to \$150,000 from the Reserve Fund to cover budget additions.
- In October, we undertook a review of anticipated revenue for the balance of 1989, examining contributions and gross profit from sales. Cumulative results for the first nine months of 1989 showed contributions only 2% over the same point for 1988. It was anticipated that contributions for the balance of 1989 and for the year 1990 would not exceed this 2% trend. An early forecast of 1990 operating expenses combined with this conservative contribution forecast and a desired net excess for all of G.S.O. of approximately \$500,000, required a price increase to most of A.A.W.S. literature to achieve this end. On October 26, 1989, the board approved a price increase package to be effective January

1, 1990, as follows: Big Book and Twelve & Twelve titles to be raised by \$1.00; booklets by 25 cents; pamphlets by 50%; foreign and other material—no increase; dollar discount on other than book and booklets to be reduced from 22% to 20%; quantity bulk discounts to be increased from 5, 10, and 15% to 6, 12, and 18%.

- After a review of the financial situation at the end of October, and projected negative results for the balance of 1989, we recommended to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, that \$400,000 be drawn up from the Reserve Fund to cover the current and anticipated net operating loss for 1989.

- A preliminary 1990 budget was examined and given preliminary approval in December. The A.A.W.S. Board requested that management increase the recommended expense cuts from \$170,000 to \$220,000. The final budget forwarded to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee reflected a net operating income of \$675,900, which indicated an increase in operating expenses of 6.8%, as compared to the 1989 projected actual expenses. It also reflected an additional \$131,200 in cuts in operating expenses made to the preliminary budget. Finally, the budget contained recommendations to the trustees and Conference for further cuts amounting to about \$136,500.

- In view of the downward trend in contributions, the Self-support Committee continued to meet regularly during 1989 to discuss ways in which the trend might be reversed. A subcommittee was formed to look at additional steps to be taken in order to reach our goal of full self-support within the five-year period; a letter was sent to delegates and alternates requesting their input at a session at the '89 Conference; a self-support update was sent out in January '89; a progress report was prepared on the Challenge of the Seventh Tradition Five-year Plan; a subcommittee was set up which began work on communications addressing potential cuts in service and pinpointed noncontributing groups; one of the new fliers was included on the front page of an issue of *Box* 4-5-9; it was agreed to keep the delegates apprised of the status of self-support; a new communication to the Fellowship designed to improve contributions and widen participation, enclosing a revised Self-support Manual, was prepared; and the suggestion by the Grapevine to have G.S.O. contribution envelopes bound in the January 1990 issue of the Grapevine was accepted.

- We accepted the recommendation of the Self-support Committee that the board consider the original concept of the five-year plan and define the future role of the committee. Further, there will be a Self-support presentation at the 1990 Conference.

- The computer implementation project moved along on schedule to revised target dates set in September. This resulted in Grapevine subscriptions, Accounts Payable and General Ledger applications for A.A.W.S. and the GV being targeted for completion on December 31, 1989. Order Entry, Inventory, and Contributions were rescheduled to March 31, 1990.

- We revised the policy, dated March 1989, on translations of Big Book and other works of Bill W.

- We welcomed three new directors—Phil Cels, Harold Greene, and Mike McPherson, replacing Ruth Jagodzinski, Shepherd Raimi and Joe Rhoads, who left us through rotation. We welcomed two new staff members, Mike Kelley, who reported for work on July 24, and Joanie Moncrief, who reported in September.

- After ten-plus years of service, we accepted with regret Curtis Monahan's resignation on September 1. Lois Fisher, who served as assistant coordinator of the International Convention, replaced Curtis as coordinator.

- We approved the expenditure of approximately \$40,000 (or about \$8.00 a copy) for translating into Russian, typesetting and proofreading, 5,000 copies of *Living Sober* and the Twelve and Twelve.
- We approved the recommendation to provide \$12,109 to cover the cost of typesetting and printing 5,000 copies of four additional sections to be included in the Russian Big Book, *i.e.*: The Foreword, The Doctor's Opinion, Dr. Bob's Story, and a commentary which the Soviets say is necessary for the benefit of Soviet officials.
- We granted the request from the Denmark Literature Committee for \$10,000 to assist them in printing the Big Book under the usual terms, *i.e.*, that the inventory is to remain the property of A.A.W.S. until this total amount has been repaid. (The Denmark Literature Committee has been conscientious in reducing a prior debt.)
- We approved a suggestion from the Conference Correctional Facilities Committee to produce a soft-cover Twelve and Twelve. Such an edition will be available to inmates who are not permitted hard-cover books.
- During 1989, we granted permission/did not object to 117 requests to reprint, and three requests to tape-record/videotape from A.A. literature; we withheld or objected to 28 requests.
- We priced the following material: "A.A. for the Native North American," Big Book on Computer Disks, Big Book (Russian), Video of Chapter 5 of the Big Book in American Sign Language, Twelve and Twelve (soft-cover edition), "A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic," Radio Public Service Announcements, *Conference Report* (Spanish translation), "Is A.A. For Me?," Big Book (large-print edition), increase in yearly subscription to *Bar* 4-5-9, "Circles of Love and Service," and A.A. Guidelines.
- We accepted the recommendations regarding use of literature on computer bulletin boards. These requests to be handled with the same specificity as requests for the use of material generally, and determination handled on a case-by-case basis.
- We approved a Conference request to tape the Pioneer Stories in the Big Book. We reaffirmed the policy contained in the 1977 Position Paper which explains why the board does not wish to publish study guides. However, A.A.W.S.'s position is not binding on any other entity; we neither endorse nor oppose such projects.
- We approved the production of 1,000, 90-minute tapes of basic A.A. recovery literature, at the cost of approximately \$2,830, to be made available for the reading disabled.
- We received a request from the Stepping Stones Foundation for a royalty advance in the amount of \$50,000. As there is potential for tax liability on the part of A.A.W.S., which might exceed money we are holding on account of accrued royalties, we agreed to adhere to the original request we had from the executors not to distribute any monies until the tax question is cleared.
- Members of this board were appointed to meet with members of the Audit Committee to review current programs and the direction of major projects.
- We agreed to a long-range planning committee for 1990. Appointed were Harold Greene, Mike McPherson and Phil Cels.
- We forwarded to the General Service Board our recommendation for space at the expiration of our lease.
- Sarah Price and Vinnie McCarthy took a trip to Munich, Germany in November, to discuss arrangements for the Eleventh World Service Meeting, and to discuss arrangements made with G.S.O. West Germany regarding storage and distribution of over-

seas literature published by A.A.W.S. They also made a side trip to Budapest, Hungary, to meet with members of the professional community who had been in contact with us, as well as members of two Hungarian A.A. groups, and to discuss publishing arrangements for the Hungarian literature which is currently in the translation stage.

- Toronto, Canada, was the site of the fourth A.A. World Service/Intergroup Seminar, November 3-5. More than 200 were in attendance, up 20% from last year. It was well-received and there was much sharing of experience on a variety of topics.

Jan Kelly Williamson, chairperson

ARCHIVES

Trustees' committee: The committee met three times since the 1989 General Service Conference, and addressed a wide range of archival interests: from budget development; to permission requests to use our collection; to overseeing the inclusions of some very important additions to our holdings. Some of the more notable actions include:

The design was completed and implementation began on a former trustee's proposal to gather the experiences of former trusted servants and apply these to current issues confronting our Fellowship. Shortly, we plan to begin getting a group conscience from former trustees, delegates and staff members on the feasibility of this undertaking and what shape it should take. The concept seems to fit soundly within the nature of an archives, *viz.*, to have gathered the past experiences in an organized body to facilitate access to whatever relevancy these may have to our present needs.

The "Don't Throw Me Away, I Belong to A.A." Program was redistributed to delegates, intergroups and central offices. The plan, developed several years ago, has been successful in encouraging earlytimers and other members to contribute their archivally significant items to the local archival center or in places where there is none, to G.S.O. Bookmarks, stickers, a descriptive brochure of the plan, and proposed letters to reach these individuals were sampled in the mailing.

A "Friend of the Archives" plan was considered, which would give some recognition to contributors to our collection at G.S.O. After careful consideration of the spiritual as well as budgetary aspects of such a plan, it was decided that it was better left as we presently acknowledge contributors, *viz.*, with a thank you letter sent personally on behalf of the trustees' Archives Committee and the Fellowship.

Committee members also helped in inviting participants for the Archival Workshop scheduled at the International Convention, Friday, July 6, 9:30-11:00 a.m.

John E. King, chairperson

Archivist's report: Judging from the volume of mail and telephone calls relating to the study of our past, interest in archival matters is running high within our Fellowship. For example, demand upon our lone smaller exhibit depicting the early influences on our history was such that the trustees' Archival Committee approved the construction of a duplicate. The two "juniors" join the larger, multi-paneled unit in coverage of a range of conventions, round-ups and forums throughout the U.S. and Canada. The addition of a P.C. to our department makes scheduling these items more precise. Soon the computer will save hours of research time as we are able to place more of our finding aids, indexes and catalogues into this format.

The computer arrived at an auspicious time since, during 1989, our holdings grew markedly. The most important addition was the works of Dr. Milton Maxwell, former chairman of the General Service Board and long-time friend of our society. His association with A.A. spanned a period from the late '30s until his death in late 1988. We were fortunate to receive twelve linear feet of files relating to Milton and his interests in our Fellowship. Next to Bill's writings, his forms the single largest component to our collection.

Many areas report that, in addition to the proliferation of Traditions meetings—a rare bird in the past—many have begun “History Study” meetings in which *A.A. Comes of Age*, *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*, and “*Pass It On*” are read and discussed. The study of our history seems to deepen an appreciation of the miraculous wonder of the cohesiveness of our Fellowship, for what will soon be 55 years. May it hold together for many, many more.

Frank Mauser, archivist

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee reviewed the 1989 Advisory Actions pertaining to the General Service Conference and recommended to the Conference Agenda Committee that the theme for the 40th Conference be “The Home Group—Our Responsibility and Link to A.A.'s Future.” It was recommended that the Conference Workshop be on the Conference theme. The committee also reviewed suggestions received through the Conference Evaluation Questionnaire, the G.S.O. Post-Conference Sharing Session and other suggestions and recommended the following:

- That a report/discussion by the Ad Hoc Committee on Group Registration/A.A. Directories be included on the Conference Agenda.
- That other facilities in which to hold the Conference, both within and beyond New York City, be investigated—agreement of the Conference members to be obtained before any relocation.
- That a progress report on the upcoming Ninth International Convention be included on the Conference Agenda.
- The committee reviewed topics submitted for 1990 Conference Agenda consideration, and referred each item as appropriate, whether to a Conference committee, Sharing Session, the workshop or trustees' committee. All items were addressed and responded to, including those not placed on the Agenda because of recent Conference discussion, or a matter being for local autonomy.
- The committee reviewed and finalized the Conference Agenda, selecting participants for the various presentations.
- The committee reaffirmed that we refrain from addressing the same committee agenda topics at consecutive Conferences.

Phil Cels, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is a contact for all Conference members and all those serving on the general service committees in the 91 areas throughout the United States and Canada. The responsibilities of this assignment involve coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for the Conference, which is responsible for the leadership once held by the founders of Alcoholics Anonymous, and through its structure,

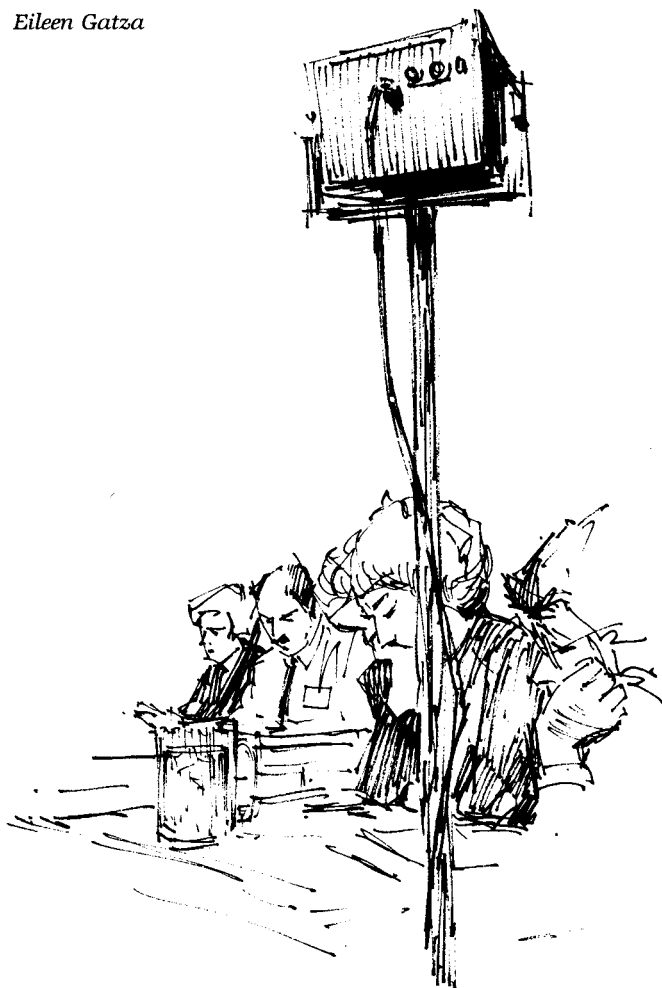
carries the A.A. message. The Conference is the body that expresses the group conscience of A.A.

A.A. members are encouraged to submit suggestions for the agenda. This is usually accomplished through the area delegates. All suggestions are then presented to the trustees' Conference Committee for discussion, for consideration, and for referral to appropriate Conference committees.

The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- Collecting suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are then forwarded to the Conference Agenda Committee and trustees' Committee on the Conference for approval.
- Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Corresponding regularly with delegates in preparation for the Conference Annual Meeting and throughout the year with news from G.S.O.
- Working with the general manager and G.S.O. staff in planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and routing all reports and other material for the Conference Manual, Early Bird Edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the *Final Conference Report*.
- Reviewing minutes, reports and all communications received from area and district committees.

Eileen Gatz



COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community has met three times since the last General Service Conference. At the July 29 meeting of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee, a subcommittee comprising Joan Jackson, Peter Brock and Terry Barrett was appointed to study possible revisions in C.P.C. literature. Mike McPherson was later added to the committee, and Joan Jackson was named chairperson. The subcommittee met October 17, 1989, and made the following recommendations to the trustees' C.P.C. Committee:

- That the trustees' C.P.C. Committee undertake a complete rewrite of the pamphlet "The Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous."
- That a suggested Guideline for Area C.P.C. Committees when setting up exhibits at state and local professional conferences be tabled.
- That the service piece to aid C.P.C. committees when making presentations to professionals be included in the C.P.C. Workbook.
- That the full trustees' C.P.C. Committees' responsibility is to participate in updating the C.P.C. Workbook and that each member forward their suggestions to the staff member on the C.P.C. assignment by January 1, 1990.
- That a C.P.C. video not be developed at this time for the following reasons: a) Too costly (approximately \$70,000) and b) the committee would need clarification of the purpose of a C.P.C. video. *NOTE:* The Conference C.P.C. Committee felt a video would address a need to inform both professionals and A.A. members how professional friends historically have helped the Fellowship and how we can or cannot cooperate within the framework of our purpose, experience and Traditions, and that a report be made back to the 1990 Conference.

The committee accepted the subcommittee's report and recommendations and will report their conclusions to the Conference C.P.C. Committee. The Professional Exhibit was also discussed at length. It was decided that the staff should work on letting the planners of national professional conventions know that the Fellowship would be willing to participate in the convention programs in 1990 and that efforts be made to use trustees, C.P.C. staff and/or C.P.C. committee members for presentations.

In October, the committee reviewed the Professional Exhibit schedule for 23 national conventions in 1990 and made appropriate deletions as well as adding the Exhibition of the President's Committee on Employment of Disabled People, AARP, American Medical Student Association, Canadian Public Health Association. The special request from C.P.C. chairperson to exhibit at the Employee Assistance Society of North America National Convention in Denver, Colorado, was approved. A motion was made that the C.P.C. secretary begin a system of grading and evaluating the Professional Exhibits, including cost factors, number of responses, size of meeting, etc.

The preliminary budget for 1990 was reviewed with some modifications. The committee proposed that an extra tabletop-type exhibit ("FS" Unit) be prepared by the Exhibit Corporation. This unit would be available, on loan, to area C.P.C. committees who would be encouraged to participate in local professional meetings. Guidelines on this subject will be developed at the July meeting.

At the January meeting, the chairperson read a letter of resignation from Terry Barrett, appointed committee member. Her resignation was accepted with regret and the committee wished her a speedy recovery, thanking her for her service on the trustees' C.P.C. Committee. The committee discussed qualifications for appointed committee member and reviewed the trustee's Nominating Committee procedure for appointed committee members.

The C.P.C. staff member reported the pamphlet "A.A. and Occupational Alcoholism Programs" had been revised with the new title "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs." It could be ready for the April Conference. We have 65,000 old pamphlets in stock, a fifteen-month's supply and an inventory worth \$1,659.00. The committee recommended G.S.O. print the new pamphlet but continue to distribute the old ones until supply is exhausted. *NOTE:* The General Service Board did not accept the recommended action and moved the printing of the pamphlet "A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs" be delayed because of budget restraints until the current supply is exhausted. This action will be reported to the Conference C.P.C. Committee.

The committee accepted the revised text of "Members of the Clergy Ask About Alcoholics Anonymous," with title change, and recommended it be submitted to the Conference C.P.C. Committee.

The C.P.C. Workbook was reviewed and suggestions were referred to the subcommittee that is working with the Conference C.P.C. Committee to update its contents. The subcommittee will meet after the Conference.

The committee discussed subjects for *About A.A.* for 1990-1991. Topics suggested were: Anonymity, 1990 International Convention, 1989 A.A. Membership Survey results and reaching out to correctional professionals.

John Hartley Smith, M.D., chairperson

Staff report: The C.P.C. staff person responds to all mail and telephone inquiries from professionals outside the Fellowship. In 1989 and early 1990 there were many mail inquiries from health professionals, treatment facilities administrators, nurses and social workers. Whereas ten years ago A.A. meetings were starting on college campuses, now inquiries come in to start A.A. meetings in high schools. Serving as a representative of A.A., in a liaison capacity, on the Advisory Council to the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse & Alcoholism, the C.P.C. coordinator has reported regularly to the G.S.O. and GV staff and the A.A.W.S. Board what is going on in the field of alcoholism.

Communication with area, district and central office C.P.C. committees is an ongoing part of the staff assignment. We have approximately 75 area C.P.C. chairpersons listed out of 91 areas, and a total of 833 area, district and central/intergroup office C.P.C. committees. We read minutes of C.P.C. committee meetings and share them with others, and through our bimonthly newsletter *Box 4-5-9*.

The C.P.C. staff assistant forwards information about professional conventions at which A.A. is scheduled to exhibit to area C.P.C. chairpersons and area delegates. Some state and local professional meetings that have requested A.A. to exhibit have been forwarded to area C.P.C. committees to follow through. We provide complimentary literature for these events, as we do for the national exhibits. A.A. has five professional exhibits, which are sent to conferences of national professional organizations. In 1989 A.A.'s exhibits were shown at 26 meetings resulting in more than 1,005 requests for more information about Alcoholics Anonymous, and 1,195 requests to receive *About A.A.*, a newsletter for professionals, which now has a mailing list of approximately 28,000.

Some meetings that staff or board members have attended since the last Conference are: National Council of Community Health Centers, American Orthopsychiatric Association, National Rural Health Association, National Organization of Student Assistance Programs, National Association of Alcoholism and Drug Abuse Counselors, American Bar Association, American Correctional Association, and Alcohol and Drug Problems Association. They have also participated in various local, district and area C.P.C. workshops. C.P.C. literature and guidelines have been updated by Conference and trustee C.P.C. committee action. The C.P.C. Workbook is in the process of being evaluated and updated by the Conference C.P.C. Committee and a subcommittee of the trustees' C.P.C. Committee. There is an opening for an appointed committee member on the trustees' C.P.C. Committee. The C.P.C. staff member is coordinating the interviewing process working together with the trustees' C.P.C. Committee chairperson and G.S.O.'s general manager.

Efforts are being made to produce smaller professional exhibits and to set aside some money from the trustees' C.P.C. Committee budget to help area C.P.C.s exhibit at various national, regional and state professional conferences. Guidelines are being developed in this regard. The staff member, serving as secretary of both trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees, is working on ways to provide more C.P.C. services to those who come in contact with professionals who work with still-suffering alcoholics and, at the same time, keep the budget balanced.

Susan Ulseth

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities is to recommend more effective ways to carry the message to alcoholics in correctional facilities. Since the last Conference, the committee met three times and the following projects are in progress:

- The publication by A.A.W.S., Inc. of a soft-cover book of institutions stories from previous Grapevines. Details regarding costs and necessary copyright permission were developed by the committee, and are being forwarded to the Conference Committee for consideration, along with the recommendation that such a book be published.
- The 1982 "State of the Nation" survey in the Correctional Facilities Workbook is being redone in order to bring the data up-to-date.
- All the material in the Correctional Facilities Workbook has been reviewed and updating recommended. However, we now have on hand a supply to last through November 1990. The updated information will be reflected in the next printing along with any suggestions for change made by the Conference Committee.
- A guide for using the literature contained in the Correctional Facilities Workbook was developed and will be added at the next printing.
- A.A.W.S., Inc. is in the process of producing a tape for beginners which will contain several pamphlets usually recommended for newcomers, i.e. "Is A.A. for You?", "A Newcomer Asks," "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship," etc. The committee recommended that a free Beginners Tape be sent to all corrections committee chairpersons as soon as it is available.
- The easy-to-read pamphlet "Is A.A. for Me?" is now available and will be added to the Correctional Facilities Workbook.

The committee reviewed and considered the usefulness of the Correctional Facilities Directory and recommended that we continue to publish it in its present form until such time as the Conference Ad Hoc Committee on A.A. Directories reports back to the 1990 Conference. As always, the committee is searching for new and better ways to carry the message into correctional facilities in the United States and Canada and we welcome suggestions from the Fellowship through correctional facilities chairpeople and Conference delegates.

Amos E. Reed, chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities Desk services approximately 1,650 correctional facilities groups and their outside A.A. contacts, 700 correctional facilities and institutions chairpersons. A.A. groups in correctional facilities, which are listed in the Correctional Facilities Directory, receive a Correctional Facilities Group Handbook that contains Conference-approved pamphlets directed to members who are confined, and the Correctional Facilities Directory. In addition, each group receives a copy of the Big Book, complimentary literature and Box 4-5-9. Discount packages of A.A. literature in English, Spanish and French are always welcomed by inside groups and correctional facilities committees. The Grapevine donates back issues and damaged literature to groups and confined A.A.s.

A.A. members in prison write to G.S.O. for prerelease group, individual, or intergroup/central office contacts. Before the inmate's release the G.S.O. staff member works with correctional facilities committees and the central office and local A.A. groups to help the A.A. member make this transition with a meeting list and telephone number in his or her pocket.

The staff member on this assignment answers all correspondence from inmates and correctional facilities committees and writes approximately 6,000 letters a year. She reads committee minutes and newsletters and prison newsletters prepared by



A.A.s on the "inside." The staff member is also responsible for the correctional facilities section of *Box 4-5-9*. A.A. inmates frequently contact the staff member on this assignment for help bringing "outside" A.A.s to share in prison meetings. Local contacts are found to answer these requests. The staff member on this assignment visited the Nassau County Jail Dart program since rotating to this responsibility in September 1989.

Correctional Correspondence Service, outside A.A. prison contacts, group sponsors, individual A.A. members who visit men and women behind the walls, all offer a ray of hope to A.A. members who are incarcerated. Each of these is a means of communication with Alcoholics Anonymous worldwide. We see letters which share with us the miracles of recovery which are a result of your Twelfth Step work; voices of gratitude for your sharing experiences, strength and hope for a future of spiritual Fellowship a day at a time. Hundreds of free-world A.A. members share experience, strength and hope with A.A. members who are in correctional facilities through the Corrections Correspondence Service, which is administered at G.S.O. Regretfully, male inmates must often wait for months before we are able to match them up with an A.A. member on the outside willing to correspond with a newcomer who is incarcerated.

The Correctional Facilities Workbook is sent to new chairpersons. We are redoing the "State of the Nation" survey, so that results reported in the Workbook are up to date. We are adding the Native American pamphlet to the literature pack as well as the new easy-to-read piece "Is A.A. for Me." A Guide for using the A.A. literature contained in the Workbook has been developed.

The video "It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell" has been well-received. A total of 1,086 video cassettes were sold and 86 complimentary copies were sent out. The films "A.A.—An Inside View," "Bill's Own Story," and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," and the film strips and videos "Circles of Love and Service" are available at no charge to correctional facilities groups.

Betty Liddle

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: A review of 1989's operations was highlighted by several key items. The first and most important, was the fact that we incurred not only an operating loss of \$69,700, but a total deficit of \$1,204,800, which included 1989's portion of the computer acquisition project of \$507,400. This was brought on by contributions for 1989 being less than budgeted by \$159,900, gross profit from sales \$566,600 below budget (sales were \$380,300 below) and cost of production due to paper costs increasing higher than anticipated, being \$309,100 higher, offset by royalties at \$52,400 less than expected due to lower than budgeted sales. Although contributions and sales were higher than 1988, the reduction in sales prices, along with lower than anticipated unit sales, helped generate this deficit.

Total expenses were \$38,900, (0.4%) below budget, while operating expenses were \$31,400 (0.3%) over budget. Although there were expense items which were contained where possible there were items beyond our control which went over budget. In particular, our medical insurance costs rose dramatically, a situation many companies across the country have experienced. We have addressed this situation by changing insurance carriers in 1990 and anticipate a sizable reduction (over \$100,000) of this expense in 1990. Contributions were \$153,800 greater than 1988, but \$159,900 less than budgeted. This created a 1989 shortfall of contributions against G.S.O. service expenses of \$860,000 (exclusive of computer costs of \$507,400); this is compared to a shortfall of \$546,000 in 1988.

The 1990 budget was approved in the Finance Committee of the General Service Board on February 15, 1990, and endorsed on February 26, 1990, by a special executive committee established to act on behalf of the General Service Board between board meetings. This action was brought about due to the serious considerations given to the entire 1990 budget. The budget, as approved, reflects an operating income of \$929,800 and a net surplus, after computer and relocation/renovation considerations, of \$297,800. It also reflects an increase in operating expenses of only 3.6% and total expenses of 4.8%. The budgeted net surplus equals 3% of total income. Although sales revenue is budgeted for an increase of 28.1%, it has been budgeted based on very conservative unit growth. This takes into consideration the fact that unit sales vs. budget declined in 1989.

Although prices were raised effective 1/1/90, the increase should be considered as almost restoring the prices to the level they were at prior to the series of reductions over the past couple of years. We are still at a single pricing, and the Big Book, for example, is priced at \$4.60. The price to A.A. purchasers was \$4.65 when there was two-tier pricing. In reflecting on the attempt to be self-supporting from our own contributions and less dependent on literature income, perhaps we reduced our prices too much, too soon. We should not, however, abandon the concept of self-support, but should be even more determined to achieve the goal of covering office expenses with contributions, perhaps now marching to a slower drummer. Contributions have been budgeted for an increase of only 1.1% based on 1989's results of being only 3.9% over 1988.

Grapevine's results were positive for 1989. Revenue increased \$232,500 over 1988 and was \$137,900 over budget, a result of all categories of sales being ahead of budget. Expenses were \$237,600 over 1988 but \$697,000 below budget. Net income for the year, including interest, was \$233,200, \$21,200 higher than 1988 and \$232,750 over budget. The Grapevine's net surplus is commendable and represents a modest cushion going forward into 1990. The Grapevine's 1990 budget was approved as presented and reflects a net budgeted surplus of \$19,850, or just under 1% of budgeted revenues for 1990.

The General Service Board Reserve Fund had a fund balance of \$6,462,100 yielding approximately 8.3% on book value, and represented about 7.9 months of combined operating expenses (G.S.O. and Grapevine). This is down \$741,200 from the end of 1988 which represented 9.7 months of coverage. The change reflects the drawdown of \$1,300,000 during 1989 offset by interest earned on the balances. The drawdowns reflected the need to start off 1989 with sufficient working capital, mid-year 1989 budget adjustments, and finally a realization and recognition that faltering sales combined with a fall-off in contributions were not going to correct themselves in 1989.

As I stated last year, while it is improper to "budget" a deficit, we might expect some unusual cash flow patterns from these endeavors. We sure had them in 1989. Financial risks might ensue for a period of time until we get a handle on what the groups are prepared to pay for. The Reserve Fund was and is a comfort during this period. Without the Prudent Reserve Fund as full as it was over the past several years, very serious cutbacks in services and literature publishing may have been necessary.

The major lesson we have learned is that changes in financial policies must be undertaken slowly and with measured response to changing conditions, that one year's abundance of surplus can quickly become the next year's deficit. For the good of the Fellowship, present and future, financial prudence is a virtue well-worth practicing.

Robert P. Morse, treasurer

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: The three General Sharing Sessions since the last Conference discussed issues of specific interest to the board and the Fellowship. In July, an in-depth report was given for A.A. World Services, Inc. It was explained that A.A. World Services has two basic responsibilities: publication of A.A. books and pamphlets; and oversight of the General Service Office. The composition of this board was described as well as what a typical agenda included. The July meeting included presentations on "The General Sharing Session Takes Its Inventory." The presentations included information regarding the history and background of the sessions and the many different formats through the years. It was felt that despite the change in format, the session at the present time lacks participation, and it was noted that the most stimulating Sharing Sessions have been when other groups, such as Young People in A.A. and Narcotics Anonymous, were invited to attend, or when there had been controversial topics addressed.

Conclusions from the discussion which followed indicated that in-depth reports should be given perhaps once a year, or on a case-by-case basis when the need arises; suggested topics were submitted at the end of this session in an effort to put forth some worthwhile agenda topics for future sessions that would generate informal sharing on A.A.'s current and future concerns.

In October, the topic was "The General Service Trustee—The What, Where and Why of Them." Two excellent, thought-provoking presentations were given by a general service trustee and a regional trustee on how their roles were originally conceived, what they are or are supposed to be, and how they are selected. Discussion led to an exchange of ideas, with most in attendance feeling that the qualifications and the method of election for general service trustees should not be changed. No firm conclusions were reached, however, concerning residence requirements for general service trustees.

The most recent General Sharing Session (January 1990) addressed the topic "Should the General Service Board Own Property?" One presenter thought the topic to be addressed was "real property," since property in the form of computers, equipment, furniture, etc., is already owned. Both presentations included individual interpretation of Traditions and Concepts and the thought that, at least for now, we should not. However, we should continue thinking it through and investigating, merely to indicate a prudent fiscal policy to our members.

Don Bruner, chairperson



GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: The primary responsibility of the group services coordinator is to provide communication services to the Fellowship as a whole, overseeing the production of service material, which includes the 15 A.A. Guidelines, new Group Handbooks (English, Spanish and French), self-support materials, and G.S.R. kits.

G.S.O. continues to work toward providing services to all A.A. groups within the U.S./Canada Conference structure in the three major languages of North America. G.S.O. now lists approximately 1,670 French- and 770 Spanish-speaking groups.

A variety of service material is available to A.A.s upon request. This material differs from Conference-approved literature in that it has not come about through the Conference process and is not the result of an Advisory Action. Rather, service material reflects A.A. experience and information that is subject to change.

The group services coordinator also has oversight responsibility for the production of the five A.A. directories; he or she serves on the A.A. World Services Self-Support Committee; acts as a liaison person for central office/intergroups, including participation in the Central Office/Intergroup seminars. 1989 marked the fourth such seminar.

Pat Rosenstiel

INTERNATIONAL / WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' committee: This committee is the focal point for information about A.A. around the world. It develops ways to help A.A. growth in countries where A.A. is just getting started.

In accordance with A.A. World Services, Inc.'s revised policy on translating and/or publishing literature for countries overseas, the committee has recommended that translations of the Big Book be undertaken on a prioritized basis, as the budget permits.

To reflect the committee's increased responsibilities, the following was added to the Scope of the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure.

- Consider requests from foreign countries for loans so that they may publish their own literature, and repay us from the proceeds.
- Initiate translations on a case by case basis. (Costs to be determined prior to initiating translations.)
- Establish the need to publish or not to publish translations we have initiated. (Costs to be determined prior to decisions to publish.)
- Review translations of our literature for accuracy prior to submitting to A.A.W.S. for permission to reproduce.
- Review, when asked, foreign translations received, on a case by case basis. (Costs to be determined prior to review and publishing.)

As a final recommendation, under the committee's previous policy to translate our basic pamphlets into foreign languages for A.A. members in our own service structure (other than English, Spanish and French), it was recommended that "This Is A.A.," "44 Questions," and "Is A.A. For You?" be translated into Cambodian.

Further to the committee's change in Scope, it revised its Composition to read: The International Committee has no specific size. The chairperson and committee members are appointed by the chairman of the General Service Board, but will include the two trustees-at-large for U.S./Canada, who are also the World Service Meeting delegates.

Due to the situation in Colombia, the World Service Meeting Site-Selection Committee recommended the Eleventh World Service Meeting move to its alternate site in Munich, West Germany. The meeting dates, October 14-18, 1990, will remain the same.

A request from some A.A. members in Moscow asking that a new office be listed with us as the General Service Office of the U.S.S.R. was discussed. Many of these individuals were from the Moscow Beginners Group. Just a month earlier, G.S.O. New York received a letter from Moscow notifying us that a bona fide Moscow Service Group had been formed. Further, they said they were supported by all of the A.A. groups in Moscow, with the exception of the Moscow Beginners Group.

Wayne Parks, G.S.O.'s general manager, replied, suggesting that the formation of a G.S.O. in Moscow at this time was premature, and encouraged them to support the newly formed service group instead. Nevertheless, they still asked to be listed as a G.S.O. in the International Directory. The committee recommended not to list them as a G.S.O., but to continue to urge them to support the existing service group.

W.F. (Webb) Johnson, chairperson

Staff report: Correspondence from groups and individual A.A.s in countries without a service center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. When correspondence comes to us in a foreign language, it is translated and a response sent in the same language. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 37 G.S.O.s and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada in Argentina, Australia, Belgium (French-speaking), Belgium (Flemish-speaking), Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica, Denmark, Ecuador, El Salvador, Finland, France, Great Britain, Guatemala, Honduras, Iceland, India, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Nicaragua, Norway, Paraguay, Poland, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland (French-speaking), Switzerland (German-speaking), Trinidad/Tobago, Uruguay, Venezuela and West Germany.

When letters are received from groups and individuals in those countries, they are encouraged to correspond with their own G.S.O.s. If an overseas G.S.O. needs a more detailed sharing of experience, it contacts G.S.O., U.S./Canada.

For non-English-speaking countries with their own G.S.O.s, we add English-speaking groups and contacts, intergroup/central offices, and Loners to our mailing list and include them in our International A.A. Directory.

A.A. Literature Overseas—To protect A.A.'s message, careful consideration is given to granting overseas boards, centers, and literature committees permission to print A.A. Conference-approved literature in the language of the country. A request to print should come from the board or representative A.A. committee and before any printing begins G.S.O. first explores how material will be financed and distributed. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to the A.A.W.S. Board.

A.A. World Services, Inc. Board also translates and prints foreign language literature needed overseas. This applies to countries where there is no G.S.O., or no G.S.O. that publishes in the country's language. Each proposal for translation will be considered on an individual basis by A.A. World Services, Inc. as the budget permits. This past year we have published the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in Russian, Hungarian and Czech. We also published *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* and *Living Sober* in Russian.

Hungary—The staff secretary and G.S.O. publications director traveled to Budapest in December in response to a number of inquiries from A.A. members, and members of the professional community, to publish A.A. literature in Hungarian. It was

determined that there is a great need, and A.A. World Services, Inc. is now planning to publish, in addition to the Big Book, *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, *Living Sober*, and three of our basic pamphlets in that language.

World Service Meeting—A major highlight of this assignment is planning and coordinating the World Service Meeting which meets biennially in the United States and overseas. The Eleventh World Service Meeting will be held October 14-18, 1990, in Munich, West Germany.

Interim Zonal Meetings—The European and Ibero-American service meetings are also held biennially, alternating with World Service Meetings. Their primary purpose is to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. They sponsor countries without service structures into service and contribute to the growth of A.A. worldwide.

Sarah Price

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION / A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—The committee was happy to welcome Lonnie Williams, delegate from Washington and chairperson of the Conference Committee on International Convention, and John Sullivan, delegate from Western Missouri and Conference committee member, to our July meeting.

After reviewing the procedures for the opening and closing ceremonies for the Big Meeting Friday night and the Spiritual Meeting Sunday morning, the committee recommended the following format for the meetings in the Kingdome Stadium:

Friday Night—The chairperson of the General Service Board will preside over the opening ceremonies, and the chairperson of the trustees' Committee on International Convention will chair the Big A.A. meeting. The members of the General Service Board, on the dais, will be introduced as a group. Corporate Board directors and General Service Office staff will also be introduced as groups from designated seating areas in the stands. The committee also recommended that past trustees and past and present delegates be recognized. The committee recommended that three people be designated to speak for 15 minutes each and that they be chosen, one from the U.S., one from Canada, and one from a country outside the U.S. and Canada.

Sunday Morning—The committee suggested that the general manager open the meeting and introduce the Host Committee chairperson, Eric Bergman, who will chair the Sunday Morning Spiritual Meeting.

The committee reviewed additional suggestions for Workshops and Topic Meetings and noted that the G.S.O. Planning Committee may add more meetings to the schedule if registration figures indicate a need. The speaker selection process was discussed and delegates, as well as members of the board, were encouraged to suggest speakers. A list of suggested non-A.A. speakers was reviewed and no objections were raised.

The committee agreed that greetings will not be solicited from political figures and VIPs. If greetings are received, they will be acknowledged. Whether or not the greetings should be read at the opening meeting will be left to the discretion of the Planning Committee.

Dates for the International Convention in 2000 were considered and the committee recommended that the Convention be held Thursday, June 29 – Sunday, July 2.

The committee considered invitations to special guests and recommended that the General Service Board invite Nell Wing to accept the ten millionth copy of the Big Book at a presentation

to be held during the Big Meeting on Friday night. The committee also recommended that the board invite Sue Windows and Bob Smith (Dr. Bob's daughter and son) to be special guests of the board in addition to Dennis and Dorrie Manders, Ellie Norris and Charlotte Maxwell.

Responding to concern expressed by several delegates about the lack of participation by black and other minority members at previous International Conventions, the committee suggested that an effort be made to ensure that minorities are adequately represented on the program in Seattle. The Convention coordinator asked delegates to submit names of minority members planning to attend the International Convention who might be willing to participate.

Guidelines were developed for the site selection of the International Convention in 2000 and were submitted for consideration by the Conference Committee on International Convention.

Pending approval of the Conference Committee on International Convention, the committee recommended that Convention posters, in English, Spanish and French, be sold in the registration area at the Convention as mementos.

Inability to pay the registration fee was discussed. It was the consensus that hardship cases should be addressed individually on site by the person in charge of registration, which is how this has been handled at previous International Conventions.

Regional Forum—Dr. Jack Norris, late chairman of the board emeritus (Class A), recognized the need for continuing dialogue between the General Service Board and the A.A. members in all regions. His vision is being fulfilled as A.A. service people in the regions share directly with people from the General Service Board (the directors of the two service corporations, G.S.O., and the Grapevine). There have been 59 Regional Forums held since their inception in 1975, four within the past year.

Regional Forums serve to provide an arena for increasing understanding through communication between all members of the Fellowship and their service boards and staffs. During the year the trustees' committee reviews and provides input on planning these Forums. Responses from members around the United States and Canada indicate how much they have enjoyed these weekends of service sharing. Attendance at the past year's Forums ranged from 376 at the East Central Regional Forum at Ann Arbor, Michigan, to 525 at the North East Regional Forum in Portland, Maine. There were 336 at the West Central Regional Forum in Billings, Montana, and 439 at the South West Regional Forum in Wichita, Kansas. Great enthusiasm, interest, and participation are apparent in all regions.

Workshops and presentations, as well as an overview of the sharing sessions and reports presented during the Forum, are all summarized in the Regional Forum Reports which are produced and mailed to participants, delegates and board members. These are available for all of the Forums in 1989. Box 4-5-9 keeps the Fellowship informed regarding upcoming Regional Forums. The schedule for 1990 and 1991 is as follows:

1990		
May 18–20	Western Canada	Yellowknife, N.W.T.
August 17–19	Pacific	San Diego, CA
September 28–30	Western Canada	Winnipeg, Man.
November 16–18	Eastern Canada	Niagara Falls, Ont.
December 7–9	Southeast	Shreveport, LA
1991		
June 1–3	Northeast	Bethesda, MD
July 12–14	West Central	Omaha, NE
October	East Central	Columbus, OH
December 6–8	Southwest	Tulsa, OK

Ruth Jagodzinski, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention—The theme for A.A.'s 55th-Birthday party, to be held in Seattle, Washington, July 5-8, 1990, is "55 Years—One Day at a Time." A.A.s from over 50 countries will gather in Seattle to celebrate our Fellowship's anniversary and experience the joy of sharing sobriety with more than forty thousand recovering alcoholics from around the world.

Five "get acquainted" dances have been scheduled for Thursday night, July 5 from 8:00-11:00. Attendees who prefer the beat of "Big Bands" will find their music in the Grand Ballroom of the Westin Hotel or at the Washington State Convention Center. The Convention Center will also be the site of the Country and Western Dance. Music from the '50s and '60s will be heard at Seattle Center in the "Gym" atmosphere of the Arena and "Top 40" sounds will be vibrating from the Flag Pavilion at Seattle Center. The marathon meeting will begin at midnight Thursday at the Sheraton Hotel and will run continuously through 8:45 a.m. Sunday.

The Convention includes over 250 sessions (workshops, panels, regional alkathons, topic meetings and marathons) with almost 900 speakers and moderators. Seattle Center, site of the 1962 World's Fair, will serve as the hub for our daytime activities with registration and most of our workshops and panels held there. Additional workshops and meetings are scheduled at Washington State Convention Center, and the Westin, Sheraton, and Holiday Crown Plaza Hotels. The Flag Ceremony and Big Meeting (Friday night), professional entertainment (Saturday night), and the Spiritual Meeting (Sunday morning) will be held at the King County Stadium (Kingdome). An International Convention "Fun Run" has been scheduled for Sunday morning at 7:00 a.m. The three-mile route will start and finish at Seattle Center.

The International Convention assignment involves working with four committees: Trustees, Conference, Host and G.S.O. Planning. The staff secretary coordinates and serves as secretary to the four committees and is also the liaison to the Al-Anon Planning Committee. The local Host Committee consists of more than 2,500 A.A.s who have volunteered countless hours to make the Convention a wonderful weekend of A.A. sharing at its best. It would be impossible without their help.

Lois Fisher



Regional Forums—The responsibilities of this assignment involve coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services and Grapevine Boards, as well as the General Service Office. Regional Forums are held at the invitation of a particular region every two years—thus, usually four Regional Forums take place annually.

Working in conjunction with the regional trustee, area delegates, and the host city contact person, the Regional Forum coordinator requests agenda topics and workshop suggestions. Invitations are mailed to G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area committee officers, central offices and intergroups, past delegates and past trustees. The staff member prepares the agenda for the Forum weekend, following through with the Forum's hotel requirements at each stage of planning, to ensure that all details are covered. She or he is also responsible for seeing that there are literature displays at each Forum. Following a Forum, highlights of the weekend's sharing are produced by the coordinator, and sent to all registrants.

General Service Board personnel attendees usually include the chairman of the board, trustees (from among nonalcoholic, regional, general service and trustees-at-large), directors of A.A. World Services, and Grapevine Corporate Boards and staff members. Work for a Regional Forum begins at least one year in advance, and great care is taken to ensure that each Forum provides a format conducive to open sharing in a comfortable setting.

Pat Rosenstiel

LITERATURE

Trustees report: Projects completed—As the result of General Service Conference approval, the following items have become available: "Is A.A. For Me?" (illustrated, easy-to-read version of "Is A.A. for You?"); "A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic"; *Alcoholics Anonymous* in large print; "A.A.—An Inside View," 16mm film available for sale (in lieu of long term lease).

Projects in progress—(1) A.A. History Book: A detailed status report was provided to the Conference Literature Committee. (2) The possibility of developing a pamphlet on the concept of the spiritual aspects of A.A. (as a way to explain the multidimensional and expansive association which has always been linked to the phrase, "Power Greater Than Ourselves"), was endorsed and forwarded for consideration to the Conference Literature Committee. (3) A Big Book Workshop Questionnaire endorsed for distribution by the 1989 Conference Literature Committee (to serve as part of the 50th anniversary commemoration of the Big Book, and as a guide to the Fellowship's wishes regarding the possible need for a Fourth Edition and/or publication of the Big Book in various formats). Responses continue to be received from areas, districts and groups. An interim report was prepared by the trustees' Literature Committee, and was updated for the Conference Literature Committee.

Projects completed and manuscripts forwarded to the Conference Committee (suggested by previous Conference actions): (1) A thoroughly revised draft of "The A.A. Group" pamphlet. (2) Text and illustrations for an easy-to-read Twelve Steps Illustrated pamphlet. (3) A completed manuscript on the Daily Reflections book together with an overview of this project.

William Croke, chairperson

Staff report: The literature coordinator serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, and works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on preparing all new recovery pamphlets, books, displays and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. The coordinator, along with the editor, follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all recovery pamphlets. Production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department.

The literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. groups and individuals about literature. We maintain contact with all current area, district, intergroups and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and material to assist them in this vital responsibility.

Additionally, the literature coordinator serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, our bimonthly newsletter. Total current circulation of *Box 4-5-9* is: English 76,552; French 3,991; Spanish 13,719. Every A.A. group listed with G.S.O. receives a complimentary subscription to the newsletter, as do overseas general service offices, intergroups/central offices, and literature distribution centers. In the interest of self-support, annual subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* are available for \$3.50 (single copies) and \$6.00 (10 copies).

Joanie Moncrief

LONERS, INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS

Staff report: The following excerpt from the letter of a member of the *Loners/Internationalists Meeting* by mail correspondence service provides a typical example of the comments we receive:

"I graciously appreciate the Loners Directory; you did more of a favor for me than you think. You saved my life! Meetings here aboard the ship are very unreliable since few, if any, show up. At times, I feel very alone. I've lost a lot through my disease and now I'm picking up the pieces. I have received so many gifts being sober, my gratitude toward even little things is immeasurable. I feel so very good to be able to share my experience, strength and hope via paper. I've written many, many letters so far. It'll be nice to get a response back, but I'm giving and I don't expect anything in return. It's doing me good and it is God's will that I give what I have. For a long time, I thought I had nothing to give, but in my heart I knew I had something to give. Thank you so much for answering me when I basically cried for help. You answered my prayer. Lots of love to all."

As the name implies, Loners are A.A.s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are now about 550 Loners in 90 countries, including the United States and Canada. Seagoing A.A.s are known as Internationalists and their numbers continue to grow. There are now about 700 Internationalists and 60 Port Contacts; 60 Internationalists Groups meet aboard ships or in ports. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability. We now have 215 Homers in the Loners/Internationalists Group. Loners, Homers, and Internationalists stay sober reading A.A. literature and sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters and tapes.

A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer, or Internationalist. Each of them also receives a directory of Loners, Homers, and Internationalists. Additionally, they receive complimentary subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners/Internationalists Meeting (LIM)*, which is a bimonthly discussion meeting in print, sharing excerpts of letters received at the General Service Office from LIM members.

A growing number of A.A.s serve as Loner Sponsors, sharing group activities and personal experience with the Loners, Homers and Internationalists. With approximately 3,900 A.A.s (including Loner Sponsors) participating in the *Loners/Internationalists Meeting* by mail, we might call it the largest A.A. group in the world. A.A.'s phenomenal worldwide growth can be attributed largely to Loners in distant lands and Internationalists sailing the Seven Seas who carry the A.A. message wherever they may be.

John Grant

NOMINATING

Trustees' committee: The committee reviewed and approved for mailing the letter, procedures, and resumé forms for election of candidates for regional trustees and approved, as eligible for election, the candidates for Pacific U.S. and Eastern Canada Regions.

The committee moved to rescind its decision of the July 1989 meeting regarding "convenient traveling distance" in the description of the role of general service trustee, and to accept the proposed text which was recommended by the Conference Committee on Trustees. The committee accepted the report for the General Service Board concerning the pros and cons of changing the geographic qualifications for general service trustees and recommended that the report be forwarded to the chairperson of the Conference Committee on Trustees. The board then approved sending this report to all Conference members.

The committee recommended that Jean Smith serve on the A.A. World Services Board, replacing Bill Croke, and also recommended that Jan Whitney serve on the A.A. World Services Board, replacing Jan Kelly Williamson. The committee recommended the nomination of Everett Smethurst to serve as director on the A.A. World Services Board, replacing Jean Smith. The committee recommended that Jackie Martin serve on the A.A. Grapevine Board, replacing Thomas G. Hills.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees for election at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1990 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

Michael Alexander	Robert P. Morse
John N. Chappel, M.D.	Amos E. Reed
Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.	John Hartley Smith, M.D.
John E. King	

Class B

Donald J. Bruner	John A. Sharkey
Phil J. Cels	Stanley Silverman
Harold Greene	Jean Smith
W.F. (Webb) Johnson	Desmond Towey
Jacqueline Martin	Jan Whitney
John J. Quinn	Jan Kelly Williamson

(Two regional trustees to be selected April 25, 1990)

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

<i>Chairperson</i>	Michael Alexander
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D.
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	John E. King
<i>Secretary</i>	Jan Kelly Williamson
<i>Treasurer</i>	Robert P. Morse
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Edward H. Gordon
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Helen Turnquest

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., to be presented to the 1990 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Phil J. Cels	Everett Smethurst
Hugh Freyer	Jean Smith
Harold Greene	Helen Turnquest
Michael J. McPherson	Jan Whitney
Wayne Parks	

The committee reviewed and recommended the following directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 1990 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Bernard C. Benziger	Jane Murphy Schulberg
Donald J. Bruner	Stanley Silverman
John E. King	Ames Sweet
Jacqueline Martin	Desmond Towey
Fran Polek	Ann Warner

Joan Jackson, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with helping the membership carry the message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We try to do that by creating a better understanding about what A.A. does and what it does not do, and by trying to prevent misinformation. We also try to maintain some awareness of the composition and growth of A.A. as a whole through our triannual Membership Survey, which plays an important role in helping us formulate public information communications.

Among the tasks assigned to the trustees' committee are those of producing television and radio public service announcements; producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; preparing health fair and other community exhibits; conducting A.A. membership and other surveys; contributing to the *Box 4-5-9* newsletter; preparing various P.I.-P.R. packages and extending the hand of A.A. to anyone, anywhere, who reaches out for help. The trustees' committee provides guidance to the Public Information desk at the General Service Office and acts as a resource to public information committees who are doing work in the schools, with the public media and with health fairs at the area, district and local levels. In the past year, the committee:

- Approved the distribution plan for the Conference-approved radio PSA cassette to local public information chairpersons and to a sampling of 134 radio stations in 36 major cities in the U.S. and Canada.
- Reviewed and forwarded to the Conference for approval P.I. memos to editors, news directors, writers and commentators; a guide for the International Convention press releases and a change in the paragraph "public information chairpersons" to be inserted in the P.I. Guidelines.
- Appointed a G.S.O. subcommittee to develop taping guidelines to be added to the Conferences and Conventions Guidelines. This is to be discussed by the 1990 General Service Conference Public Information Committee.
- Approved a press release regarding the 50th Anniversary of the Big Book.
- Approved the appointment of a standing committee on minorities to follow-up on the 1989 Conference Advisory Action which asked the trustees' Committee on Public Information to

consider how we can utilize minorities media better to carry the A.A. message to minorities as well as how we can better carry the message into schools with high minorities populations.

- Approved the distribution and collection of the 1989 Membership Survey and is overseeing the editing, computer work and the analysis of the survey, which will be completed and information disseminated in 1990.
- Approved a proposal to send an exhibit similar to the C.P.C. exhibit to two national media conventions in 1990. Anonymity literature and press service pieces would be featured.
- Approved sending the anonymity letter to both the media and to treatment facilities in 1990.
- Approved preparation of a report to the 1990 Conference Committee on Public Information on a proposed Traditions film with focus on anonymity.

The committee hears reports of P.I. activities in the area, district and local levels through staff reports and the input of regional trustees. We applaud the work the areas are doing and we will continue to assist that work with what we hope are effective media materials and the resources for describing Alcoholics Anonymous to the public.

Desmond Towey, chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Public Information assignment is to help to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic and potential alcoholic through the media. The staff member and a staff assistant respond to an average of 12,500 written and telephoned inquiries that come in annually from the general public and the Fellowship. The staff member is also responsible for handling interviews with the media describing what A.A. is and what it can and cannot do, and providing accurate information. A partial list of interviews includes those by *Newsweek*, *The Atlanta Constitution*, *The Washington Post*, *The New York Times*, Independent Television Stations and *U.S.A. Today*.

During the past year, literature has been provided for approximately 250 health and community fairs. We also read and processed 15,000 newspaper, magazine and television feature stories; wrote approximately six letters of gratitude each month to publications printing accurate articles about our Fellowship; followed up on a monthly average of ten anonymity breaks.

New public information chairpersons are automatically sent the Public Information Workbook, and all P.I. committee members and contacts receive *Box 4-5-9*, as well as any new public service materials. Discount packages are also made available to P.I. committees at \$15.60 and \$54.60, respectively. Local committees may also order half-quantities of each package.

The existing and most recent radio and television public service announcements and our films "Alcoholics Anonymous—An Inside View" and "Young People and A.A." have been widely aired by major networks and local television and radio stations. Many requests for help in planning programs including references to Alcoholics Anonymous have been responded to. We have also had contact with cable channels. We are working with the trustees' P.I. Committee on addressing heightening mass awareness of the importance of anonymity in the media. The report of the 1989 Membership Survey is now being prepared, and will be sent out to area delegates upon completion.

G.S.O. services are backed up in a large measure by the tremendous dedication of more than 800 local Public Information committees and about 900 P.I. contacts, as all of us strive to communicate and reach out to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Richard Bush

SPANISH SERVICES

Staff report: Since the late 1930s when our co-founder Bill W. had a small office in Newark, N.J., one of his concerns was "... if A.A. could ever communicate so it could transcend the barriers of the languages." With the passing of the years this G.S.O. has been providing services in several languages. One of these has been Spanish, but it was not until 1984 that the assignment of Spanish Services was formally initiated.

In our general service structure there are more than 25,000 Spanish-speaking A.A. members who don't speak English. They meet in 750 Hispanic groups in the U.S., including Puerto Rico and Canada. The Spanish services coordinator, who does not rotate, coordinates and revises Spanish translations of material from the other eleven staff assignments and assists other staff members in providing services to the Hispanic community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish has a section entitled Spanish Services that gives information on general service activities. All Hispanic groups receive *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving; the groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been added recently to the areas in our service structure. Service material is translated into Spanish and kept up-to-date. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our publications department. Spanish services helps answer the correspondence received in Spanish by most other assignments and especially by the Overseas assignment.

The staff member on this assignment represents G.S.O. at the Ibero-American Commission for Translation and Adaptation of A.A. Literature. In addition, the Spanish services coordinator attends conventions, Hispanic intergroup meetings, Regional Forums, the World Service Meeting and the International Convention. The Spanish services coordinator greets G.S.O.'s Spanish-speaking visitors.

Vicente Mejía

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services provided by G.S.O. to A.A. groups and members are divided at present into 11 staff assignments. In addition to assuming a functional responsibility such as Public Information, Regional Forums, or Literature, most staff members correspond with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. and Canada, or with A.A.s in overseas countries where there is no national G.S.O. Staff members rotate assignments every two years. Staff assignments are monitored by the staff coordinator. Currently, the work is apportioned as follows:

Conference: Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; *Early Bird Box 4-5-9*; *Final Conference Report*; assistant coordinator, 1990 International Convention.

Cooperation With the Professional Community: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; *About A.A.*; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant to C.P.C. page).

Correctional Facilities: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant on Correctional Facilities page).

Group Services Coordinator/Regional Forums: Supervision of service material, Guidelines, and A.A. directories; co-secretary,

trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee; coordinator, Self-support Committee; liaison with Intergroups/Central Offices.

International Convention: Co-secretary, trustees' Committee on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; coordinator for all activities concerning 1990 International Convention in Seattle.

Literature Coordinator: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; preparation of new recovery pamphlets, books, and audiovisual material; updating of recovery pamphlets and books; editor, Box 4-5-9.

Loners, Internationalists: *Loners-Internationalists Meeting;* secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees.

Overseas, World Service Meeting: Secretary, trustees' International Committee; coordinator of World Service Meeting; *World Service Meeting Report.*

Public Information: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; Box 4-5-9 (editorial consultant for P.I. page); assistant coordinator 1990 International Convention.

Spanish Services: Consultant on any committee providing services to the Hispanic community; Spanish language correspondence; editor, Spanish Box 4-5-9.

Treatment Facilities: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; Box 4-5-9 (editorial consultant for Treatment Facilities page).

The staff work is divided in three units so that G.S.O. mail is processed and responded to expeditiously. Unit A consists of P.I., C.P.C., C.F., and T.F. Unit B includes coordinators of Staff, Conference, Literature and Group Services. Unit C includes Overseas, World Service Meeting, Loners/Internationalists and Spanish Services.

During 1989, the G.S.O. staff handled 18,000 pieces of mail. The staff coordinator ensures that mail is answered during vacations, sickness, or a staff member's involvement with a special project. Training new staff members is another segment of the staff coordinator's service assignment. In 1989, two new staff members joined the General Service Office. When there is a staff opening, a letter is sent out to the trustees and directors announcing the opening and briefly describing the requirements for the job. The information is also posted in Box 4-5-9. Six years of sobriety is a requirement for a G.S.O. staff member. Business experience, good communication skills, A.A. service experience

and geographic considerations are some of the criteria used in the selection process.

Weekly staff meetings are scheduled to provide a forum for discussion of problems that require direction from the group conscience. From time to time, a service meeting is scheduled to give the staff an opportunity to become better informed about a particular assignment. The purpose of all staff meetings is to seek more and better ways of providing the most useful services to A.A. groups and members.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff vacations and scheduled trips in order to ensure that the office is covered at all times. She also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments as a member of the Office Policy and Procedures Committee.

In 1989, staff attended 95 conventions, assemblies, roundups and forums in U.S. and Canada. This provides the staff with opportunities to become acquainted with A.A.s all over the U.S. and Canada, to communicate about G.S.O. services and, most important, to gain information on local activities that can be shared with other groups.

During the past year, approximately 1,236 visitors from all over the world visited G.S.O. Each visitor has the opportunity to tour the various G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. These visits create an opportunity to explain services to the Fellowship and learn about A.A. activities in each visitor's hometown or country. Often members and guests attend the weekly A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays, for staff and A.A. visitors.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, and preparing and distributing the minutes of the General Service Board meeting; she also serves as editor of the *Quarterly Report*, the newsletter account of the board's activities.

As secretary of the General Sharing Session during the board weekend, trustees, members of all board committees, G.S.O. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. staff members are encouraged to discuss a wide range of topics, including in-depth reports from trustees' committees, at a two-hour General Sharing Session.

The staff coordinator is a voting member of the General Service Conference and serves as secretary of the trustees' Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. In accordance with Concept IV, the staff coordinator is a director and vice-president of A.A. World Services, Inc.

Helen Turnquest



TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee reviewed the progress of the film targeted for treatment facilities being produced by Crommie & Crommie. In July, the committee listened to a 15-minute voice track in order to check for content. In October and in January, a "rough cut" version of the final film was viewed by the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee. The committee recommended minor editing changes and approved the film to be submitted to the 1990 General Service Conference for their consideration. If approved by the Conference, the film would be ready for production this year. The film covered the topics set down by the 1988 General Service Conference: What A.A. is and is not; Anonymity; Traditions; Steps; Meeting types; Sponsorship; and Home groups.

The committee recommended that the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee consider the publication of two four-page pamphlets, both published by a District Treatment Facilities Committee from Southern Minnesota. They are: 1) "Temporary Contact Program." The pamphlet's purpose is to give an overall view of such programs to treatment facilities personnel and to A.A. as a whole. 2) "Information Program." This pamphlet contains information on A.A. for professionals and their clients/patients.

The trustees' committee was advised of the difficulty of collecting enough material to produce a Treatment Facilities Newsletter. The committee sent an invitation to two A.A. members to collect information for a sample newsletter to be presented to the Conference in April, in the hopes of encouraging A.A. members to send material to the General Service Office on an ongoing basis.

The committee recommended more precise wording be added to the section "Problems Other than Alcohol" in the Treatment Facilities Workbook. They also recommended replacing the reference to Narcotics Anonymous with a list of Twelve Step fellowships in the section "Approaching Treatment Facilities Personnel." A statement indicating that the list was included in the spirit of cooperation not affiliation would be placed in the Workbook.

A proposal to publish a directory listing the 91 area treatment facilities and/or institutions chairpersons was forwarded to the July trustees' committee meeting.

John A. Sharkey, chairperson

Staff report: The goal of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to help A.A. members carry the A.A. message to the suffering alcoholic in treatment facilities. A major staff activity entails being secretary to both trustees' and Conference Committees; responsibilities in this area include responding to mail from the committees, helping set up agendas for committee meetings, and preparing background material. The treatment facilities staff member works with treatment facilities chairpersons, directing them to helpful sources of information such as A.A. literature or other A.A. members involved in treatment facilities work, in order to help the chairpersons carry the message. The staff member also corresponds with potential members currently in treatment facilities, sending out free literature, phone numbers of intergroups, and, occasionally, an encouraging pat on the back.

After approval of a three-minute sample footage film by the 1989 General Service Conference, and as the result of an Advisory Action, a fifteen-minute film designed to carry the A.A. message into treatment facilities was produced. At all three trustee committee meetings, minor editing suggestions were made to the Crommies, the filmmakers, in order to bring the film yet closer into alignment with the original Advisory Action concerning the

When John Benson (New York, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire) gave his area service highlights, he said "I've heard this so many times it's boring." When he finished, he took cotton plugs out of his ears and put them in his mouth.

film made at the 1988 Conference. The staff member worked with the Crommies in carrying out the editing changes.

Interest remains constant in "Bridging the Gap" programs. The "Temporary Contacts" service piece, which has been added to the Treatment Facilities Workbook, has proved helpful to areas and districts looking to set up such services. The assignment was also able to connect those members wanting to start "Bridging the Gap" programs with those who have successfully started such programs. Interest has been expressed for the small pamphlets explaining temporary contact programs produced by various areas such as Southern Minnesota, Kansas, and Oklahoma.

The assignment continues to gather material for articles in the Treatment Facilities section of Box 4-5-9. Articles in the previous year centered on bridging the gap programs and cooperating with treatment facilities personnel. Material has been collected from the temporary contact programs from Oklahoma and Kansas, which will be featured in upcoming Box 4-5-9 issues or in upcoming Treatment Facilities Newsletters. Not enough material was forthcoming from the Fellowship to publish articles in both Box 4-5-9 and the Treatment Facilities Newsletter, and so a Treatment Facilities Newsletter has not been published since the Spring of 1989.

Michael Kelley

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 1990

	Groups	Members
United States	43,107	896,033
Canada	4,866	82,949
Overseas	38,060 ¹	762,046 ¹
Correctional facilities	1,663 ²	51,553
Internationalists		655
Lone members		598
	87,696	1,793,834

1. At the end of 1989, we had reported members from 72 of the 134 overseas countries with A.A. groups. These totaled 30,359 groups and 634,390 members. To establish an estimate for the 62 countries not yet responding, we excluded the ten largest responding and obtained an average of the balance. This average was applied to the 62 and the overall estimate emerged.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.



**REGIONAL MAP
OF UNITED STATES AND CANADA**

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: For the A.A. Grapevine, the year since the 1989 General Service Conference has been a very good one—as good as the board hoped in terms of rising circulation, editorial excellence, and relations with the Fellowship as a whole, and significantly better than anticipated in terms of financial health. The Corporate Board held four quarterly meetings and two special meetings, and also met four times as the planning committee. In September, the board held a new director orientation session, consisting of background on the service structure, the Conference, the role of directors, and the Grapevine magazine and board.

Circulation at the beginning of 1989 was 128,784; by December it had risen to 132,815, and 1990 has started out with a circulation of more than 133,000 for several months in a row. A new practice, begun last April with the Big Book anniversary issue, was that of providing special order forms in the magazine for single copies of special issues. Many readers took advantage of these order forms for the April, June, and October special issues.

Financially, the corporation did better than was projected for 1989, with a profit of \$220,000 compared to a budgeted profit of only \$450. This happy difference can be attributed to a combination of higher-than-budgeted circulation and interest income, unexpectedly large sales of special items as a whole, and several expense categories that came in under budget.

Magazine Price Increase: In the face of such a profitable year, it may seem contradictory to report that a magazine price increase went into effect with the June issue. But let us remember several factors. The Corporate Board had been delaying the implementation of a price increase for some time, since sales of the book of Bill W.'s Grapevine articles, *The Language of the Heart*, were expected to carry the operation through 1989 and well into 1990. For most of the year, sales of this book were running behind budget—and only in November and December did they begin to speed up and reach the budgeted totals. At the same time, as expected, the circulation increase of about 4,000 does not even come close to offsetting the fact that the magazine, in itself, is losing money at a faster rate every year. The 1990 budget approved by the Grapevine Board and by the trustees' Finance Committee shows a profit of slightly less than \$20,000. The new price structure includes an important first: establishment of a set price in Canadian funds as an option for Canadian subscribers, who have either had to send payment in U.S. funds or depend on the fluctuations of the exchange rate.

Last year's Conference Action asking delegates to clarify in their areas the basis of Grapevine financing has been enormously helpful in communicating the need for the price increase to the Fellowship and laying the groundwork for an effortless change. We are confident of having your continuing support now that the price increase is actually in effect.

Magazine Content: Readers tell us that the content of the magazine increasingly reflects the life of A.A. as a whole, and the editorial staff continues to aim for an appropriate mix of articles sharing experience of recovery through the program and those expressing opinions on vital issues in A.A. today. The June 1989 issue, commemorating the Grapevine's 45th anniversary, was a 64-page special issue, and in October, another special expanded issue, "Getting Younger in A.A.—a Day at a Time," came off press. The 1989 series on the Steps was concluded in December, and a series on the Traditions began in the January 1990 issue. Building up to the International Convention in Seattle, a number of "teaser" features have appeared, both in articles and special sections of the magazine.

In response to the 1989 Conference Action, an A.A. history section ("What We Were Like") has been developed. Although initially there seemed to be a problem with obtaining sufficient

material, the Grapevine has received the permission of A.A.W.S. and the trustees' Archives Committee to draw on area and regional material from the manuscript of the original A.A. history book, which did not go to the Conference for approval. As a result, we now have a rich store of history that will reflect A.A. all over the U.S. and Canada—and will expand to history in other countries as well. We are now in a position to follow the spirit of last year's Advisory Action and alternate the history section with the About Alcoholism section.

The Indexing project, after some initial delays, is moving along well, and a comprehensive Grapevine Index, from the first issue to the present, should be completed by the end of 1990 or early in 1991.

Although it does not come strictly under the heading of magazine content, a mention of the G.S.O. contribution envelope bound in to the January 1990 issue seems appropriate here. The board approved this at the October quarterly meeting, and we understand that the response—in terms of both participation and revenue—has been positive.

Special Items: Two new cassette tapes on the Twelve Traditions were produced in 1989, and have been well received. In keeping with the Corporate Board's goal of decreasing dependence on special items, it is significant to report that the 1990 budget contains no provision for a new special item to produce additional revenue. In the recent past, we have budgeted for at least one new special item a year. At the February planning committee meeting, board members considered various concepts and ideas for future special items and recognized the fact that we are currently in a position to produce materials other than the magazine when they are needed, without the extra incentive of a need for revenue.

Grapevine Representatives: A subcommittee appointed to look at ways to increase circulation recommended a revision of some aspects of the existing GvR resources, and that is going forward. The draft of a revised version of the GvR Handbook (included in the kit that is sent to all new GvRs) will go to the Conference Grapevine Committee for its input and for review. Information on the current number of GvRs has been provided as part of the Grapevine materials distributed at this Conference.

The Grapevine, with its always topical articles from A.A. members who are the readers and writers of our international journal, and its sometimes controversial open-for-discussion material from the same members, continues to reflect the open-minded editorial policies of our favorite magazine. It presents to the whole Fellowship "meetings in print" that have enough diverse stories to whet the appetite of almost every reader. As we approach the Grapevine's 46th birthday in June 1990, the future bodes well for the decade of the '90s and provides a sober promise, one day at a time, for the 21st century.

Thomas G. Hills, chairperson

Staff report: Since the Grapevine has been both editorially and financially healthy for several years now, the jobs of everyone in the office have become simpler—though not always easier. Over the past year, with all the major pieces in place, we have been able to put a greater proportion of time and energy into improving the internal operation, reevaluating office procedures and job responsibilities with an eye to becoming even more effective and businesslike in serving the Fellowship.

In December, Don Meurer, long-time controller/business administrator of the Grapevine, moved into new responsibilities as controller of A.A.W.S.—though he remains part-time at the Grapevine for the duration of the computer implementation.

Since Don, in his capacity as business administrator, was part of a three-person management team, one result of his leaving is that Ann Warner as executive editor and Ames Sweet as managing editor have, at least in the short term, assumed a greater share of the day-to-day management and administrative detail. A new controller, Bob Scherer, will be taking over the financial aspects of Don's responsibilities and strengthening the bookkeeping department. Internal office services and most personnel functions continue to be handled by office manager/corporate secretary Naomi Strassberg.

An evaluation of all Grapevine job descriptions in 1988 made clear the fact that the corporation did not have an effective middle-management level, and for some time we have been working toward lodging broader responsibilities with an exceptionally capable and dedicated group of supervisors and administrative personnel. Frequent staff meetings ensure that A.A. and nonalcoholic personnel work closely together and come to a "group conscience" on anything that affects the efficient functioning of the office.

For a number of years, the Grapevine circulation department has been a focal point for subscriber services, and when the new system is in place we plan to make that function explicit by renaming and reconfiguring the department as a customer services department. The circulation supervisor, Zola Bodden, will be taking on the responsibility of heading up and developing this department.

Not surprisingly, a large amount of staff time has been spent on implementation of the AS400 computer, and Grapevine subscriptions went "live" on the new system with the June issue. As we all become familiar with the opportunities the system offers, we will be looking at a variety of ways of processing the magazine faster and making it more readily available to A.A. members. These include such options as earlier acknowledgment of new subscriptions—something that has long been on the "wish list" but could not be effected without greater technological capability—and changes in the renewal sequence.

Whatever the operational needs, the editors always give the major part of their time to the magazine itself, and concentration on editorial planning appears to be paying off in a more lively, relevant, and useful magazine. The job of a Grapevine editor is in some ways remarkably easy, since a rich and plentiful supply of excellent manuscripts comes in through the mail every day. But in recent times, the staff has increasingly taken the initiative in requesting material when we perceive a need—from sharing on the question "Is A.A. Changing?" to more articles on the Steps, Traditions, and other basics such as sponsorship—and we think that effort is reflected in both the variety and the quality of the Grapevine's content.

Editorial content comes from A.A. members outside the office, and likewise a significant amount of work for the Grapevine is done through the service structure. Grapevine representatives at the group, district, and area level are constantly finding new ways of using the Grapevine for sobriety and service, and that experience is shared in the quarterly *GvR News* bulletin. Nearly all Conference areas have standing committees on the Grapevine, and judging by the continuing gradual but steady increase in circulation, their enthusiasm is catching.

Ann Warner, executive editor

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION – GEOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 1990	APRIL 1989	
UNITED STATES			
Alabama	1,527	1,461	66
Alaska	552	518	34
Arizona	1,639	1,531	108
Arkansas	825	781	44
California	14,035	13,600	435
Colorado	1,663	1,590	73
Connecticut	2,366	2,201	165
Delaware	369	392	- 23
District of Columbia	299	311	- 12
Florida	6,179	6,064	115
Georgia	2,927	2,932	- 5
Hawaii	463	411	52
Idaho	699	687	12
Illinois	5,889	5,556	333
Indiana	1,801	1,808	- 7
Iowa	1,715	1,692	23
Kansas	1,791	1,730	61
Kentucky	1,003	1,038	- 35
Louisiana	1,252	1,264	- 12
Maine	860	841	19
Maryland	2,164	2,098	66
Massachusetts	5,931	5,665	266
Michigan	3,614	3,528	86
Minnesota	3,789	3,886	- 97
Mississippi	788	766	22
Missouri	2,363	2,103	260
Montana	850	809	41
Nebraska	1,684	1,788	- 104
Nevada	670	613	57
New Hampshire	799	823	- 24
New Jersey	4,255	3,972	283
New Mexico	694	680	14
New York	9,221	8,584	637
North Carolina	3,406	3,386	20
North Dakota	616	648	- 32
Ohio	4,008	3,663	345
Oklahoma	1,666	1,674	- 8
Oregon	1,274	1,179	95
Pennsylvania	4,898	4,435	463
Rhode Island	667	670	- 3
South Carolina	1,646	1,694	- 48
South Dakota	615	661	- 46
Tennessee	1,689	1,671	18
Texas	5,617	5,366	251
Utah	486	408	78
Vermont	535	506	29
Virginia	2,977	3,116	- 139
Washington	3,389	3,134	255
West Virginia	567	574	- 7
Wisconsin	2,943	2,828	115
Wyoming	424	421	3
Puerto Rico	112	116	- 4
U.S. Possessions	—	—	—
Total	122,211	117,873	4,338
CANADA			
Alberta	1,271	1,335	- 64
British Columbia/Yukon	1,629	1,527	102
Manitoba	627	615	12
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	491	514	- 23
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	874	776	98
Ontario	5,412	5,529	- 117
Quebec	424	360	64
Saskatchewan	841	881	- 40
Total	11,569	11,537	32
FOREIGN			
	1,378	1,400	- 22
Grand Total	135,158	130,810	4,348

Literature Distributed – 1989

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	799,200
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft-cover)	435,780
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	577,150
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	133,670
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft-cover) (new)	50,010
A.A. Comes of Age	30,300
As Bill Sees It	121,090
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	28,360
"Pass It On"	35,080
Total	2,210,640

Booklets

Living Sober	288,100
Came to Believe	143,560
Total	431,660

Pamphlets

A.A. and Occupational Programs	43,200
A.A. and the Armed Services	29,300
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic (new)	58,500
A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession	65,400
A.A. for the Native North American (new)	55,000
A.A. for the Woman	279,000
The A.A. Group	168,800
A.A. in Your Community	157,800
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	88,100
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	81,100
The A.A. Membership Survey	128,300
The A.A. Member – Medications and Other Drugs	240,100
The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service	45,000
A.A. Tradition – How It Developed	96,600
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	33,000
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	258,500
The Clergy Ask About A.A.	52,500
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	69,500
Do You Think You're Different?	303,500
44 Questions	568,300
G.S.R.	87,100
How A.A. Members Cooperate	47,500
How It Works	149,000
If You Are a Professional	112,000
Inside A.A.	120,400
Is A.A. For You?	706,900
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	229,000
It Happened to Alice	126,800
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	125,000
The Jack Alexander Article	100,700
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	39,200
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	186,800
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	151,500
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	96,400
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	34,700
A Newcomer Asks	474,300
Problems Other Than Alcohol	213,800
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	465,500
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	42,800
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	48,300
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	118,700
The Twelve Traditions of A.A.	13,300
This Is A.A.	621,400
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	137,100
Time to Start Living	143,100
Time to Start Living (large print)	20,600
Too Young?	249,400
Understanding Anonymity	162,600
What Happened to Joe	133,300
Young People and A.A.	316,600
Total	8,295,300

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards – two-fold	1,139,700
Wallet cards – I Am Responsible	146,500
Wallet cards – Anonymity	96,700
Parchment – scrolls	8,900
Placards	1,000
C.P.C. Workbook	1,100
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1,300
P.I. Workbook	1,400
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,000
A.A. Guidelines	173,800
Group Handbook	6,600
Wire Racks	3,700
Cassettes	6,300
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	6,100
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	3,300
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	600
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	1,864
Twelve Steps Shade displays	3,136
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	2,887
Fact Files	4,056
Total	1,609,943
Grand total	12,547,543

SPANISH

Books

Alcohólicos Anónimos	22,500
Como Lo Ve Bill	4,700
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad	2,600
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (New)	2,200
Total	32,000

Booklets

Viviendo Sobrio	8,100
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial	1,900
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones	11,800
Llegamos a Creer	3,600
Total	25,400

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad	10,100
44 Preguntas	22,500
Esto es A.A.	29,000
¿Es A.A. para Usted?	47,800
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica	6,370
¿Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida?	4,700
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser un Alcohólico	7,100
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A.	4,000
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander	3,200
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Médicas por Bill W.	3,900
A.A. y el Empleado Alcohólico	1,300
Un Principiante Pregunta	9,000
Como Trabaja el Programa	11,800
Lo que le Sucedió a José	8,900
Comprendiendo el Anonimato	3,500
El Grupo de A.A.	8,000
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento	9,100
El Miembro de A.A. – Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas	8,100
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas	5,100
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento	3,400
Los Jóvenes y A.A.	10,500
La Tradición de A.A. – Cómo se Desarrolló	3,300
Una Breve Guía a A.A.	7,900
A.A. en Prisiones	5,100
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol	7,900
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda	4,700
Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.	1,400
Dentro de A.A.	3,900
A.A. como Recurso para la Profesión Médica	2,100

Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A.	1,800
R.S.G.	2,400
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente?	14,100
A.A. Para la Mujer	5,800
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A.	10,800
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales	2,200
Total	290,770

Miscellaneous

Guías	7,993
Parchments, Spanish	261
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera	11,800
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album)	524
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album)	680
Total	21,258
Grand total	369,428

FRENCH

Books

Gros Livre (First edition)	8,250
Gros Livre (2nd edition, pocket size)	11,609
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte	1,309
Réflexions de Bill	6,199
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions	10,074
Total	37,441

Booklets

Nous en sommes venus à croire	3,802
Vivre . . . sans alcool!	4,725
Total	8,527

Pamphlets

Voici les A.A.	12,236
Les A.A.: 44 Questions	4,394
Les A.A. sont-ils pour vous?	34,625
Les A.A. pour la femme	1,439
Coopération des membres A.A.	487
Les A.A. et le monde du travail	1,570
Le membre des A.A. face aux méd. et à la drogue	1,965
Les A.A. – Article du <i>Saturday Evening Post</i>	502
Collaborons avec nos amis	549
Questions et réponses sur le parrainage	3,818
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les médecins	1,682
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement	749
La Tradition des A.A. et son développement	402
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme?	1,802
Alice l'a trouvée	820
Jean face à son problème d'alcool	1,423
Les A.A. dans votre milieu	2,222
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme	1,667
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A.	1,051
Les Douze Traditions illustrées	1,448
Notre méthode	13,341
Les A.A. dans les établissements correctionnels	1,093
Ca vaut mieux que de poireauter en prison	624
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A.	8,716
Un ecclésiastique s'interroge	456
Biographies des cofondateurs	552
Message à l'intention des détenus	1,743
Le groupe des A.A.	2,347
Le Manuel de services/12 Concepts	1,659
Carte des Etapes et Traditions	2,767
Les Douze Concepts illustrés	526
Le sens de l'anonymat	2,390
Trois causeries à des sociétés médicales	1,196

Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie?	1,748
Si vous exercez des activités professionnel	609
Le R.S.G.	1,104
Causeries à l'extérieur des A.A.	1,356
Suggestions pour réunions de débutants	961
Les meilleurs articles de Bill	7,862
Trop jeune?	1,997
Structure de l'Ass. des A.A.	1,022
L'héritage des Services des A.A.	663
Cercles d'amour et de service	1,014
Vous croyez-vous différent?	1,639
Lettre à une femme alcoolique	1,617
Carte anonymat	826
Sondage sur les membres des A.A.	2,699
Les Jeunes et les A.A.	2,145
Votre B.S.G.	951
Il est encore temps de vivre	1,507
Un nouveau veut savoir	11,950

Total 145,698

Guidelines

Total 4,702

Miscellaneous

Prière Sérénité (Carte)	42,626
Prière Sérénité (5 × 7)	1,654
Prière Sérénité (12 × 16)	444
Prière Sérénité (23 × 34)	198
Slogans (série de 5)	343
Littérature . . . une aide essentielle	404
La Vigne A.A.	811
Etiquettes Allô!	3,200
Liste de réunions – Area 87	5,086
Liste de réunions – Region 88	198
Liste de réunions – Region 89	188
Liste de réunions – Region 90	760
Médailles rhodium français	1,222
Médailles rhodium anglais	222
Jetons aluminium “appelle avant”	13,489
Jetons 3 mois aluminium	2,879
Jetons 6 mois aluminium	1,797
Jetons 9 mois aluminium	1,581
Jetons 12 mois aluminium	1,207
Enveloppe assort. nouveau membre	2,229
Annuaire Est E.-U.	25
Annuaire Ouest des E.-U.	20
Annuaire International	52
Annuaire Canadiens	196
Videocassettes Les Jeunes & AA (video VHS)	157
Videocassette Les Jeunes & AA (U-Matic)	2
Videocassette Ca Vaut Mieux que de poireauter en prison (video VHS)	24
Chez les Alcooliques anonymes (video VHS)	16

Total 81,030

Service literature

Kits nouveaux groupes	81
Assortiments pour centres correctionnels	46
Assortiments Information publique	52
Assortiments C.M.P.	2
Manuels Information publique	22
Aperçu sur A.A.	39,495
La transmission du message dans les prisons	1,727
Message aux adolescents	25,634
Et Maintenant, que vais-je faire?	4,467
Renseignements sur les A.A.	4,682
Problèmes autres que l'alcoolisme (citations)	3,677
Feuilles illustrées sur la finance	612

Total 80,497

Grand total 357,895

Reports on Area Service Highlights

Alaska: Our area has experienced a period of tremendous growth since the inception of districting. We now have 12 districts, which cover an area one-third the size of the lower 48 states. We have an outreach program in each district. These programs carry the message to outlying villages and towns. Whole communities have participated in our quarterly meetings. A.A., on this, the last frontier of sub-zero temperatures, has a warm heart for those who have yet to come to A.A. We openly extend a warm welcome to all in the rooms with a spirit of love and acceptance.

—Clark Doane

Alberta/Northwest Territories: We hold two assemblies and two D.C.M. meetings annually in Red Deer, a centrally located city. Each of these gatherings features at least one workshop. A vote was called in the Fall 1989 assembly and the group conscience was that we get out of the convention business. This means we will not support the Canadian National Convention, proposed for Calgary this year. A Regional Forum will be held in Yellowknife, May 1990. The C.P.C., P.I., treatment facilities and institutional committees are all active in the province as well as in the north. The P.I. committee cooperates with a government-sponsored program called IMPACT, which targets impaired drivers who are repeat offenders. We have 75 districts and 700 groups with approximately 7,000 members. We are the largest geographical area in North America. Young people in our area are active and attract new members through their outreach program.

—Garry McAuley

Arizona: Our area structure parallels that of the General Service Conference with G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, and intergroup liaisons assigned to a committee panel for a two-year rotation. Assemblies are held at various locations around the state to encourage local participation, which is increasing throughout the area. Area Workshop Teams travel where asked to explain area service. In at least one of our major cities, groups sponsor signers for the hearing impaired; conventions are also being signed. We have a Spanish-speaking intergroup as well as a newly formed Spanish-speaking district. Communication is the key to understanding the Traditions and to using the tools available to help fulfill our primary purpose.—Lenette Dunham

California (Mid-Southern): Our area has 23 districts and 2,000 meetings. Our P.I. committee is involved in radio panels and is part of a three-area committee that is working with a local network station to develop PSAs aimed at pre-teens and the elderly. Our P.I. committee is co-chaired by English-speaking and Spanish-speaking members. We have two Spanish-speaking districts and we are purchasing translation equipment for use at area functions. Our newsletter now includes a Spanish section for Hispanic-district activities and functions. Our C.P.C. committee has a literature packet that explains what A.A. does and does not do and includes local meeting lists for use by our municipal courts. We ask that the court provides this to individuals it sends to us. The chairpersons for intergroup, hospitals and institutions committees vote in our area assemblies.—P.J. Doherty

California (Northern Interior): We are made up of 28 districts, 600 groups and 13,400 members and we're growing at a rate of 500 to 600 members a year. We have four assemblies and eight committee meetings each year. Most districts meet monthly. The awareness of self-support is becoming very evident as the G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s receive support from the groups. District and group workshops are popular. C.P.C. and P.I. committees are starting to grow. At our last three-day assembly we sold in excess of \$700 worth of A.A. literature, which shows a strong thirst for knowledge. We are growing and becoming communicative and we are coming together in service.—Fred Barnett

California (San Diego/Imperial): Our assembly voted to file for nonprofit tax-exempt status. Additionally, we voted to increase our operating expense account to \$5,000 and monies over that amount are sent to G.S.O. each quarter. With the increasing participation of Spanish-speaking districts came the decision to purchase translation equipment. Bilingual A.A.s do the translating and English-speaking members benefit when attending A.A. events in Spanish. In 1989 we added eight new standing committees to the area assembly. The ad hoc committee established two years ago to carry the message to Native Americans continued to meet monthly and we now have a total of seven meetings on five reservations. These meetings are run by Native American A.A. members. We tried holding a Unity Day service meeting. The participants were the north and south central office/intergroups, the hospital and institutions committee and the area assembly.—Bobbie Coney

Delaware: Our area has 144 groups and 13 districts. Each of Delaware's three counties has its own active intergroup. The area C.P.C. chairman is liaison to each intergroup C.P.C., which places and stocks literature holders in schools, physicians' offices and hospitals. The intergroups help carry the message into correctional facilities, rehabilitation centers and detoxes. Although we have been districted for 10 years, our area D.C.M.s are just beginning to organize regular district meetings. The area committee continues to emphasize the Seventh Tradition on all levels. This year for the first time we have budgeted funds to send the area officers to the next regional convention and we are encouraging groups and districts to send G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s as well. Our archives committee actively solicits and gathers material.

—Patricia Hagan

Georgia: We have 637 groups and approximately 14,280 members, which represents an increase of some 20% over the past two years. Our state assembly meets in Macon in January, May and September and our 38 districts participate. We hold A.A. service workshops on Saturday; in the evening we hold an open meeting. On Sunday, we present the "Business of A.A." Our prepaid convention is held each October in various locations. Last year's convention was a complete success with over 2,000 attendees. Hurricane Hugo destroyed our sister state's central office in Charleston, South Carolina, and the hat was passed for help. A check for \$1,800 was sent to ease the burden. The Seventh Tradition challenge and the G.S.O. theme of "The Group" will be our focus in 1990.—Sam Sibley

Idaho: Our area has 10 districts and approximately 176 groups. This may not show much of an increase but many of these groups have become larger and some now have multiple meetings. Districts hold monthly meetings and the area committee holds a meeting prior to the two area assembly business meetings each year. These gatherings are well attended and receive active participation. C.P.C., hospitals and institutions, P.I. and Grapevine committees continue to carry the message in their respective fields. Our central office has a toll-free number, which has made it easier for groups to get literature. Our archives person remains active in the pursuit of information, past and present, of value to A.A. records in Idaho.—Berry Wild

Illinois (Northern): Our area has 20 districts and over 800 groups. We have four assemblies and four area committee meetings each year. We have added meetings for the district secretaries, treasurers and those involved in district newsletters. Our area committees are all active and our area service newsletter, *Concepts*, has been welcomed enthusiastically. We stress the need for groups to participate in the Birthday Plan and contributions

reflect our labor. In our effort to involve new people in service, the D.C.M.s are using workshops to increase awareness of the G.S.R.s' responsibility to attend the assemblies. They are also working to carry the message to groups who have no G.S.R.s that we need them and they need us.—*Phyllis Wise*

Indiana (Southern): We hold four area meetings and one assembly meeting each year. Our area has 23 districts with active D.C.M.s. The districts hold workshops that help their G.S.R.s understand the service structure of our area. As a result of active participation by G.S.R.s, a greater interest has been shown in our area meetings. We are planning ways to bring more G.S.R.s to our area meetings and have a committee to make suggestions. An area newsletter is in the works. It will consist of A.A. history, reports on workshops and committees and general information. Each district may include its information sheet in the newsletter.—*Dorothy J. May*

Kansas: We have 386 registered groups in 25 districts; three districts will be up for approval at our next assembly. We hold two-day quarterly assemblies and area committee meetings. Our Kansas Area Conference is held in September and there are five regional conferences during the fall, winter and spring, along with numerous Round Robins throughout the year. Our area hosted the Southwest Regional Forum in December at Wichita. Also, our area assembly was incorporated as a non-profit organization. Our area now has an area office, in Salina, with a full-time staff person. This office also houses our archives and our newsletter. A.A. is growing in Kansas and so are the problems that coincide with growth—people from court referrals, work release centers and treatment centers are causing mild dissension within some groups. Fortunately, many of the groups are able to resolve the problems with the help of Tradition meetings.—*John Evans*

Kentucky: We now have 515 groups within 27 districts. We hold 682 weekly meetings. Our area committee meets quarterly and an area assembly is held in October. The location of these quarterly meetings rotates. The Kentucky state convention is held in February each year. Our corrections, P.I., C.P.C., treatment facilities, Grapevine, and the newly formed finance committees work hard to carry the message. Reports are given at each area meeting. Problems with "court-ordered" newcomers are starting to surface and our P.I. and C.P.C. chairpersons are starting to work on this. C.P.C. has been active in sharing with local nursing associations and colleges about the primary purpose of A.A. An area central office is still being discussed. Interest in area service is quite encouraging.—*Billy Mattingly*

Maine: Our area has 377 groups and 850 meetings. The area is 450 miles long and 350 miles wide and consists of many small towns and a few major cities. Our area has been redistricting for the past six years and we've gone from eight districts to 16, with talk of more districts splitting. We hold two area assembly meetings each year, in March and October. These two-day affairs include workshops on service. We also have four to five area committee meetings each year. We have active P.I./C.P.C., hospitals and institutions, Grapevine and bridging-the-gap committees. We have started "circle of love in service with fun" days, which seem to help bring more people into contact with service.—*Guy Frigon*

Manitoba: The year we'll host two general service assemblies as well as the Western Regional A.A. Service Assembly and a Regional Forum in September. Manitoba is a vast geographical area and therefore the table officers will participate in a service function

in the north this summer. We have 14 districts with active D.C.M.s. Most districts meet monthly. Committees are active. We now have a nonrotating archivist and a rotating archives committee. Institutional work is done regularly and weekly meetings take place at correctional facilities. Literature is distributed to these facilities. Schools are extremely appreciative of our distribution of Big Books to their libraries. P.I. committee members speak at schools and have enthusiastic responses. Our area will adopt the 1990 Conference theme in some of our workshops and activities.—*Pat Morehouse*

Maryland: Area 29, which has 45 districts, is 20 years old; it was formerly a part of Area 13, D.C. We have an active service structure and have five assemblies and four area committee meetings a year. We usually have two area conventions, the state convention in June, and NYPIAA in the fall. This year we are hosting the Northeast Regional Convention. We have an Inter-group Liaison Committee which meets during assembly meetings; the turn-out of the nine intergroups being represented has been remarkably good. There are some "holes" in our area, and last year, and again this year, our five officers are each taking nine districts to personally "push." Of our 45 districts there are seven without D.C.M.s; officers are visiting these districts and are encouraging the G.S.R.s to elect D.C.M.s. G.S.R.s are being informed at workshops and participate beautifully. I'm really impressed with Maryland general service.—*Tom Couzens*

Massachusetts (Western): Our area has 182 groups and five districts. District and service committees meet monthly. The biannual area assemblies last two days and feature workshops on the Traditions, service, the Concepts and the Conference theme as well as a business meeting. The area committee is available for service presentations and as a result, interest in service has increased. Our P.I. committee last year spoke with over 240 school and civic groups. The institutions committee conducts 37 meetings weekly. C.P.C. uses the opening Round-up meeting as a "Professional Night." Archives put together a pamphlet detailing the history of A.A. in our area. We've also published a pamphlet on self-support that shows the needs in our area. Attendance at the Grapevine, archives and C.P.C. meetings has more than doubled. More G.S.R.s now attend district meetings. Problems include our constant growth, problems other than alcohol and the dilution of the value placed on sponsorship.—*John B. O'Connor*

Michigan (Western): We have 16 districts, 380 groups and 7,138 members. Our area assembly meets monthly in various cities. Our districts are dividing their areas so that more D.C.M.s may be elected. District 6 set up district meetings and all committees were filled. District 11 opened their central office in 1989 and last year volunteers operated it 24 hours a day, seven days a week. District 16 held their district meeting inside prison walls and now anyone going inside may use one clearance to enter all four prisons in the area. Our new meeting directory lists meetings by district. At the 1989 General Service Conference, Panel 36 delegate Jan Whitney was elected East Central U.S. regional trustee. Jack Meagher, former delegate and trustee, passed away in July. We sent four people to the Regional Forum.—*Charlie Oakes*

Minnesota (Northern): Our area has about 500 groups and 20 districts. We hold assemblies in the spring and fall in addition to four area committee meetings and one service workshop. Assembly and workshop sites rotate to increase participation. Our D.C.M.s have been assigned to action committees to enhance the pool of experience for each committee and our committees

have been active. Our institutions committee has been split into corrections and treatment facilities committees. An area action booklet informs and guides our area and our outstanding archives display is an ongoing attraction. A statewide service conference with Area 36 was discontinued. Attendance was poor in the second year and we recognized that we perhaps have enough activities on the area and regional level.—*Robert Jokela*

Mississippi: Our area has 26 districts and 217 groups. We redistricted three years ago and now our groups are better informed and more active. We have four assemblies each year and most districts hold a meeting prior to each assembly. There were 656 people at our fall assembly. We will host the seventh annual Mid-South Conference of Young People in A.A. in 1990. Some groups located near treatment centers are concerned about our singleness of purpose. Some of the treatment centers send patients with the wrong information about A.A., in addition to court referrals and people with problems other than alcohol. Our archives have been revised. We hold a workshop every election year to better inform new G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s of their duties. Some groups are sponsoring A.A. in the state penitentiary, satellite prisons and jails. All other committees are active.

—*T.L. (Dooley) Harris*

Montana: Our area is the largest in the “lower 48” and we have an ongoing concern with communication. Our 4,000 or so members are spread throughout a state of over 145,000 square miles, so we’ve been splitting districts and adding D.C.M.s for several years. We now have 16 districts and more may be added. A major problem is assembly attendance. We feel that the G.S.R.s should have an active voice and vote in our assemblies but many cannot attend because the funding isn’t available for the G.S.R. of a small group to travel nearly 450 miles with at least two nights on the road. We have many new groups and member contributions helped finance a computer for the area secretary-treasurer. We’re accepting donations for a second computer for the area newsletter editor. Recovery continues to blossom in “big sky country.”

—*Maryann Wells*

Nebraska: We have 28 districts, each with a D.C.M. All of the committee positions are filled and being done well. Of our 683 groups, only 334 contributed to the area last year. We seem to have enough money but it is being supplied by only 51% of the groups. We hold separate G.S.R. and area meetings and hold a D.C.M. “coffee” while the G.S.R.s are having their meeting. When the G.S.R.s have finished the two-year term, they’re ready to step into an area position. Rotation seems to go very smoothly in Area 41. We are setting up a finance committee to work with the chairman and treasurer to solve money problems. Our alternate delegate is a member of the finance committee. We feel this will be helpful should the alternate have to fill the delegate’s position.—*Roger Luther*

New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: Our area includes the provinces of New Brunswick and Prince Edward Island. We have 224 groups and 13 districts. Each year we have two workshops, two assemblies and two area committee meetings. The May and October assemblies are held in conjunction with a social weekend or roundup. Various districts host these assemblies as well as the workshops in January and June. The area committee meetings are usually held in March and December in Moncton, N.B., which is the approximate geographical center of the area. Our service committees include treatment facilities, Grapevine, literature, archives, area newsletter, correctional facilities, conference and roundup, P.I. and C.P.C. We look forward to the nineties as an opportunity to improve communications.—*Jim McIntyre*

New Hampshire: Our area has approximately 500 groups located throughout 15 districts. Our area assemblies rotate within the districts and meet on a quarterly basis; our state area convention is held in June. We are proud and privileged to host the 1991 Northeast Regional Convention, in the White Mountains. Our area assembly has twelve committees that are active and responsive to the needs of the individual districts and groups. They include: archives, public information, C.P.C., function, finance, correctional, treatment facilities, service office committee, the Grapevine, the *Pipeline*, and District Needs Committee. We continue to publish our newsletter *Pipeline* on a monthly basis, which provides our area with significant happenings and updates. Everyone is working diligently in our efforts to “Pass it on!” We continue to grow in members and new groups.—*Martin P. Garry*

New Jersey (Southern): We have 408 groups and 25 districts. We have four sections and have found section leaders helpful in supporting our D.C.M.s. At our last assembly we redefined the role of the section leaders. We have recently developed a beneficial and close working relationship with our three intergroups. Progress is reflected in the growth of our districts. In 1988 we had 19 districts and we now have 25 districts. In addition, groups that have never been involved before are participating in the area assembly. Our area activities include workshops, Third Legacy speakers and the rotation of all assembly meetings throughout the area. The recent area convention hosted our first quarter assembly meeting.—*Ruthann P. Cluna*

New Mexico: We have 15 districts in New Mexico; six have more than 20 groups, and three have more than thirty. Redistricting is being discussed. Our new area service manual, the Area Information Pamphlet, is working well and is updated every two years to reflect assembly actions. The archives chairman is now a nonrotating position, although the archives committee still rotates every two years. We are looking forward to hosting the Second Annual Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly in Albuquerque, October 19-21. We have three area assemblies per year held at various locations around the state, and are excited that we are meeting in three new towns during 1989-90.

—*George Biggs*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): Our area now has 660 groups, which represents a 22% increase over 1988. However, we still have 12 districts. Growth has increased communication problems and to help solve the problems we are emphasizing training workshops for G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. Some districts have made local committee members responsible to and for certain groups in the district. Other districts may establish an intergroup office. We are publishing an area service manual aimed at the newcomer, particularly the new G.S.R. The manual also includes a confidential directory of all district and area officers and all past delegates. We now have an outside contact system for people coming out of treatment facilities. Increased attendance at our district meetings, area meetings, assemblies and day of sharing reflects greater interest in service work.—*John E. Benson*

New York (Western): We have about 3,000 members who belong to 249 groups that support 23 districts. We hosted informational workshops in 1988, where P.I., C.P.C., treatment center, correctional facilities and Grapevine committee reports, histories, topics and opinions were discussed. We hosted the 24th New York State Convention in 1989 on the theme, Joy of the Journey. We are drawing guidelines for the General Service Assembly of Western New York, certain to stay within the Traditions and the G.S.O. guidelines. Our Panel 38 delegate was unanimously approved to be our first registrar.—*Elvester McRucker*

North Dakota: We have 169 groups and 13 districts. D.C.M.s are making better contact with groups in their area. We have begun to rotate our assembly meetings to different sites throughout the state. More G.S.R.s have started to attend the assembly meetings since we added a G.S.R. sharing session, held at the same time our area committee meets. On Friday night before the start of the assembly we hold an "early bird" meeting for early arrivals. Two years ago we added a state institutions committee chairperson and since then several districts have elected institution chairpersons. Our first central office was opened recently in one of our districts and right now it is operating one day at a time. We plan to host the 1991 West Central Regional A.A. Service Conference. We also plan to publish a state newsletter soon.—*Maggie Cole*

Ohio (Northwest)/Michigan (Southeast): We have 227 groups and 15 districts. We hold 10 area assemblies and one mini-conference each year. At these meetings we conduct our business and hold panels with our newly elected G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s and with our past delegates. Our goal is to increase attendance at our assemblies. Ninety-seven attended the January meeting, up from previous meetings. We hold our D.C.M. meetings on a different date from the area assemblies. This allows us more time to resolve problems within each district. In 1989, 54% of our groups donated money to G.S.O. This is the first time our area has reached 50%, a notable increase that reflects how effectively we've carried the message of self-support. Quarterly funds over \$2,000 are sent to G.S.O.—*Richard Sarahman*

Ohio (Southwest): We have 30 districts and about 500 meetings, with new ones forming at the rate of about six per month. We have assembly meetings once a month and the attendance and donations are good at all of them. Area 56 has been asked to display P.I./C.P.C. material at the American Association for Counseling and Development Convention, in Cincinnati in March 1990. Our area will host the 35th Ohio State Conference in 1991. We have a mini-conference every year and a workshop about once a month. We purchased a new computer this year to help keep our reports in good form. Our area is a good place to get and stay sober in, one day at a time.—*Vera H. Martin*

Ontario (Western): Our area has 22 districts and 437 groups. We are working hard to become self-supporting and we support our subcommittees financially as they are actively involved in carrying the A.A. message. We have begun to order and distribute literature to all our subcommittee members. Our intergroup liaison duties are the responsibility of the alternate delegate and this helps the delegate to be better informed about intergroup activities. Our efforts to become self-supporting have been well-received by our groups and we have been receiving contributions over and above the area's assessment of a set amount. Growth in our area has been slow, but consistent.—*Dan Peterson*

Oregon: We have 630 registered groups and 33 districts. We have 24 service positions; eight are elected and 16 are appointed. Our three assemblies are held in February, May and November and our general service assembly is held in September. Participation at the area level of service is about 33%, both in attendance and in contributions. We educate and inform the area about the need for participation. Our area institutions committee now carries the message into 14 institutions, up from five. Some of our districts are trying different forms of subdistricting to better carry the message. We encourage each district to sponsor at least two workshops per year.—*Chuck Crist*

Puerto Rico: We have 110 groups, seven districts and 2,000 members. We hold monthly area meetings and a national convention in February, to which we invite members of the government, family counselors, members of the clergy and other professionals. Our national convention encourages our friends to participate in A.A. activities throughout the year and it helps keep our First Tradition and Third Legacy lively. Puerto Rico has about five in-patient alcoholism treatment programs and we cooperate actively with them. We hold three general assemblies each year. During the assemblies we discuss the financial situation of our area and service matters such as C.P.C., P.I. and G.S.O. activities. We also discuss seminars and area committee alkathons. In addition, we hold a special session for sharing and studying the guidelines for our different activities.—*Juan Benet*

Quebec (Northwest): Our area has 336 French-speaking groups and 17 districts. Rather than a central office, each district has its own phone number, which is answered by A.A. members. The area executive committee has two general meetings for G.S.R.s and six regional meetings for D.C.M.s. The area executive committee meets twice a month. We have 10 district conventions. Our area has 17 penal institutions and each one has a sponsor. Most have weekly meetings. Approximately 92% of our groups respect the Seventh Tradition, an 8% increase from 1988. Our bulletin is printed every two months. The area executive committee visits each district twice a year and answers questions about A.A. and informs them of new developments, including literature from A.A.W.S. By the end of 1990 we may have three or four new districts.—*Jean-Claude Paquette*

Quebec (Southwest): Our area hosted the 33rd International Convention for Young People in A.A. Our guidelines committee defined the duties of area officers. We are bilingual and our French-speaking members would greatly appreciate more communication with G.S.O. in French. Our area comprises 32 districts and 560 groups in six languages. We have nine subcommittees. We're establishing a permanent home for our archives. Our most active committee prepares our annual bilingual convention each October. This year it will present 180 A.A. meetings, 23 Al-Anon meetings and 9 Alateen meetings. Our P.I. and C.P.C. committees are active. Treatment facilities, correctional facilities and "La Vigne" committees are busier than ever. *La Boite 460*, the informational paper on area activities, is issued every other month. We hold information sessions with D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s.—*J. Ovila Blais*

Rhode Island: Our area holds quarterly assembly meetings featuring a service workshop and a business meeting. The area committee consists of five elected officers and meets regularly. Service committees meet monthly. We now have eight districts that meet monthly for a business meeting and a structure school. The P.I. committee books speakers in school and other interested organizations and works with the media. The C.P.C. committee takes medical students and other professionals to A.A. meetings. Our active correctional facilities committee holds approximately 23 meetings at a local prison. The treatment facilities committee set up a temporary contact program for patients leaving facilities, conducts A.A. meetings within facilities, holds in-service meetings for the staff and offers A.A. orientation programs for the clients. We have also recently initiated an area newsletter.—*Jack MacManus*

Sam Wiley (Georgia), in his area service highlights: "We have 30 districts and almost all participate; those that don't we send a get well card."

Saskatchewan: We have 16 districts and approximately 325 groups. Travel between groups can be difficult due to distance, but interest in service is still strong. We hold a spring and fall assembly and a January D.C.M. meeting for D.C.M.s and table officers. Assemblies are held in various locations and 150 to 200 people usually attend. We have participated in the last three regional service assemblies. Our D.C.M.s and table officers are given travel assistance to Regional Forums in western Canada. A good percentage of our groups are small. We also have several cities with groups galore and plenty of A.A. activity. Roundups, gratitude nights, district meetings and most important of all, good old A.A. meetings, form the largest part of our A.A. character.—*Ken Johnston*

South Carolina: Recently our three districts split into eight smaller territories. Our area assembly still meets three times a year with concurrent workshops on each opening day. We are planning our state convention, to be held in conjunction with the 1990 Southeastern Regional Forum in Charleston in August. Many alcoholics are finding that avenues of recovery through treatment centers are now closed to them for lack of insurance, changes in insurance policies, or ever-increasing treatment fees. To combat this situation, our districts are holding seminars on Twelfth-Step work and techniques to assist the growing number of "off the street" alcoholics. We are pleased to report a significant increase in the number of black alcoholics successfully entering A.A. in our area.—*Crawford Poe*

South Dakota: Our area encompasses the entire state. We have 139 groups, the largest number ever for us. More members attend our semiannual area conferences and two midterm workshops. We are a rural state, with approximately 700,000 people spread over 75,956 square miles. We have nine Native American reservations in our area and A.A. is alive and well throughout the state. We have a slate of new area assembly officers, committee chairmen, district committee members and G.S.R.s; 70% of our 15 districts are active and hold meetings and special mini-conferences. The chairmen of the institutions committees are divided between the "east river" and "west river" because the Missouri River flows north to south through South Dakota. P.I., C.P.C., Grapevine and the area archives committees are all active.—*Rod Horn*

Tennessee: We have 412 groups and 32 districts. Assemblies are held quarterly and 152 G.S.R.s attended our first quarterly assembly. All six standing committees are very active. We have just started an archives office and have a lot of support. Our corrections support is as strong as anywhere, and C.P.C. and P.I. committees have come of age. Assemblies are held all across the state, and over 450 attended the last one. Our G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s are well informed and enthusiastic about doing things by the Traditions. Our young people come to assemblies, conventions, and especially TCYPAA and the International Conference of Young People. Our concerns are with singleness of purpose, in addition to self-support, as our state has dropped to 15% participation of groups contributing to our state assembly.—*Larry Anderson*

Texas (Northwest): We have 224 groups and 14 districts, of which nine are active in our four area assemblies. We have P.I., C.P.C., Grapevine, correctional facilities and treatment facilities standing committees and we support a correctional facilities chairperson at the state level. Our area structure was adopted in 1980 and we've since outgrown it so a committee is reviewing the area structure. Most districts have active committees that

work with the five area standing committees. Sixty groups and five or six conferences contribute regularly to our area assembly fund. We hold two area assemblies in conjunction with conferences and two freestanding area assemblies. We have several Spanish-speaking groups that are active in our area assembly.—*Sue "Susie" Pigg*

Texas (Southwest): We have 439 groups and 29 districts in an area stretching over 500 miles—approximately 9,000 members. Each year we have four area meetings. Two are workshops, one is held before the General Service Conference and the other is our fall assembly. We have area committees for correctional facilities, treatment facilities, archives, C.P.C., P.I., bilingual, intergroups/central office and the Grapevine. Many of the districts have corresponding committees. The area committee chairpeople travel throughout the area and hold mini-workshops at the district level. We have an area newsletter. We fund all mileage and lodging for the area officers and committee chairpeople. Because we have such a wide area, we rotate meeting locations to make our meetings more accessible to all.—*Robert P. McGill*

Vermont: We have ten districts serving 206 groups. The state's first intergroup was established to serve the city of Burlington. The area P.I. provides area meeting lists at selected interstate highway rest areas near our state borders. The practice has met with a favorable response as reported by visitors to several groups in the area. We established an area finance committee to prepare and review budgeting and nonbudgetary items prior to vote at the area assembly. We hold four area assemblies and eight area committee meetings yearly. Last year we held our first weekend assembly in conjunction with our pre-Conference sharing session and this resulted in our best attended assembly. All G.S.R.s receive the minutes of all assembly and committee meetings.—*Pete McHugh*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: We have 567 groups and 21 districts. Almost all districts hold monthly or bimonthly G.S.R. meetings. Our workshops, assemblies and conferences are well attended. Thanks to the literature on the hearing impaired, we now have a meeting where a bonded interpreter signs. Our monthly newsletter reaches many in our area; several subscriptions go to Canada and one goes to Australia. At our last fall conference, the alternate delegate, who is our area chairperson, became responsible for conducting service workshops throughout the area. We have also added a treatment facilities committee. Additionally, we have Grapevine, P.I., archives and correctional facilities committees. We have allotted monies to help pay expenses for the delegate, alternate, secretary and treasurer.—*Paul Heindel*

Wyoming: Within our large geographic area we have about 2,000 members, 130 groups and many institutional meetings in our 11 districts; C.P.C., P.I., treatment and Grapevine committees are all active. Our area D.C.M. sharing sessions are helping to stimulate more informed sharing throughout our area. They are being chaired by the alternate delegate. We have area newsletters available at both assemblies and both conventions. Our Wyoming young people will celebrate their fourth annual convention this summer in Jackson. The Grapevine committee hosted its second Grapevine retreat last September in the beautiful Big Horn Mountains near Ten Sleep.—*Dan Gramke*

Financial Overview

OVERALL: G.S.O. had a total net expense of \$1,204,800 (after paying extraordinary expenses for the computer implementation project of \$507,400, the 1989 portion of an expected \$1,200,000 project cost which started in the Fall of 1988 and nears completion). As a result, there was no surplus cash to transfer to the Reserve Fund in 1990. This resulted in an operating loss for 1989 of \$697,400, as opposed to a revised budgeted net income of \$72,300. This difference was a result of contributions falling short of projections, lower sales and higher cost of paper than anticipated.

G.S.O. efforts to contain expenses were offset by increases in the cost of doing business, such as the cost of medical insurance, part of employee benefits.

SERVICES: Contributions for 1989 were \$4,054,100, a 3.9% increase over 1988, but short of projections (8%). This follows 1988's poor results of a 6.8% increase over 1987 against a 15% projection. The shortfall of \$860,000 relative to all service expenses was \$137,300 greater than anticipated. (Contributions were \$159,900 below expectations.)

PUBLISHING: 1989 literature sales net of discounts were \$8,288,900, up 6.8% from 1988, however this was \$323,300 less than budgeted due to lower unit sales. Gross profit from literature was \$566,600 less than budgeted as a result of the lower sales and higher cost of products.

Expenses charged to publishing increased by 5.5% over 1988, but were within 0.3% of budget.

COMPUTER ACQUISITION PROJECT: The acquisition and implementation of the new computer system is an extraordinary expense charged against the General Service Board. The total projected cost now stands at \$1,200,000, including \$232,000 to be spent in 1990 to complete the project.

We embarked on this project back in 1987 with an E.D.P. system review. With the assistance of a professional consulting firm we searched for the best computer solution for G.S.O., by seeking out the product best suited to our needs and then the equipment to run it on. Delivery of the equipment (four computers) started in October of 1988 and by March 1989, the Records Department application had been converted from the old system to the new system. Word processing came on-line on its own computer during 1989, ahead of the planned schedule. Additional applications in the bookkeeping area were computerized for the first time at the beginning of 1990. The balance of applications, including the Grapevine subscriptions system (converted during April 1990), order entry, inventory control, accounts receivable, and contributions, are scheduled for implementation during May. Applications which were computerized on the old system are being converted to the new system on an application by application approach, as planned. The integration of the applications to the new system is being taken step-by-step, and the necessary bridging back between the old and new systems has caused some unanticipated but not unexpected delays. Various approaches to this conversion were considered, but with much consideration, the current approach was felt to be the best way we could reflect results of the effort along the way.

IMPACT OF WORLD EVENTS: The opening of borders of Eastern European countries has presented new challenges to the G.S.O. and the board. The board's initiative to translate recovery literature for the purpose of making it available to those who wish to acquire it, but where the A.A. structure is not yet in place, will add to our cost of writers' fees and much higher than usual foreign literature assistance costs in 1990.

WORKING CAPITAL: The balance sheet reflects an increase in cash from \$542,300 to \$1,578,000. The influx of cash, in spite of deficits experienced in 1989, is due to the monies received from advance registrations for the International Convention through December 1989. Some of this has been used to offset monies advanced by G.S.O. for pre-Convention travel and deposits for the event. The short-term cash segregated for royalties reflects monies segregated but not yet paid to the beneficiaries of Lois Wilson's estate, pending distribution instruction from the executor of her estate. This liability is included in our accounts and accruals payable.

GRAPEVINE: The Grapevine's results for 1989 shows increased revenues of \$232,500 over 1988 and \$137,900 over the 1989 budget. Most categories of revenues were greater than anticipated.

Grapevine's expenses for 1989 were \$1,993,100 compared with a budget of \$2,062,850 and \$1,755,500 in 1988. Grapevine's net income for 1989, including interest earned, was \$233,200, compared to a budgeted net income of \$450, and 1988's net income of \$212,000.

Grapevine's budget for 1990 projects revenue of \$2,024,000, including \$59,000 anticipated revenue from Convention activities. This total revenue is \$109,200 less than 1989 which reflects the anticipated fall-off of sales of *The Language of the Heart*, which was introduced in 1988. Projected expenses are \$2,091,150. Net income including interest earned is anticipated to be \$19,850.

RESERVE FUND: The General Service Board Reserve Fund had a fund balance at December 31, 1989, of \$6,462,100, yielding approximately 8.3% on book value. No transfers were made to the fund balance during 1989, but \$1,300,000 was drawn down during the year. The first \$500,000, was authorized in January, to start off the year with sufficient operating cash; the next \$250,000 was authorized in May based on negative cash flow projections; the next \$150,000 was authorized in July, reflecting mid-year budget adjustments and additions to computer hardware; the final \$400,000 was approved in October, based on poor operating results for the first nine months of 1989 and projections of declining income for the balance of the year.

The Reserve Fund, after interest earned, stood at a level of 7.8 months as measured against one year's operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., The General Service Board of A.A., Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

SUMMARY: The continuing decline in growth of contributions in 1989, coupled with a slow down in literature sales, and the growth of services being required by G.S.O. to the Fellowship around the world, left no choice but to restore the price of literature as of January 1, 1990.

The 1990 budget reflects conservative estimated income and a cut-back in expenses, to achieve a sufficient net income to cover all anticipated projects in 1990 without further reducing the Reserve Fund in 1990.

Your General Service Office is optimistic about 1990 and looks forward to a good year for Alcoholics Anonymous and a successful International Convention in Seattle.



The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1989

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Office	Other	General Service Office Total
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$8,676,239			\$8,676,239
Discounts	<u>(387,320)</u>			<u>(387,320)</u>
<u>Net Sales</u>	8,288,919			8,288,919
Cost of products	(3,636,169)			(3,636,169)
Royalties	<u>(901,084)</u>			<u>(901,084)</u>
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	3,751,666			3,751,666
Contributions—A.A. groups and members		\$4,054,111		4,054,111
Interest income	<u>- 0 -</u>	<u>13,238</u>		<u>13,238</u>
<u>Total Income</u>	3,751,666	4,067,349	\$ - 0 -	7,819,015
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,336,291	1,874,798		3,211,089
Pension/retirement expense	237,616		14,163	251,779
Rent and electric	357,985	262,970		620,955
Box 4-5-9		160,329		160,329
A.A. Directories		88,515		88,515
Other service materials		322,016		322,016
Shipping and mailing	1,263,308			1,263,308
Other office expenses	71,757	644,919		716,676
Insurance and payroll taxes		765,820		765,820
Professional services	63,967		22,654	86,621
Board, committee and staff meetings	57,636	12,516	142,037	212,189
Writers' fees	113,937			113,937
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	15,151		95,385	110,536
General Service Conference		341,760		341,760
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	70,767		507,379	578,146
Regional Forums and other			103,617	103,617
Film development			25,880	25,880
Leasehold improvements			3,436	3,436
World Service Meeting (every other year)			- 0 -	- 0 -
Self-support Project			32,905	32,905
Board Expense—Int'l. Visits			362	362
Foreign literature assistance (net)	13,950			13,950
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>3,602,365</u>	<u>4,473,643</u>	<u>947,818</u>	<u>9,023,826</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>149,301</u>	<u>(406,294)</u>	<u>(947,818)</u>	<u>(1,204,811)</u>
NOTE:				
Extraordinary expenses:				
Computer system acquisition			507,379	507,379
NET OPERATING INCOME (EXPENSE)				
<u>exclusive of extraordinary expenses</u>	<u>149,301</u>	<u>(406,294)</u>	<u>(440,439)</u>	<u>(697,432)</u>
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND				
Balance, January 1				\$7,203,273
Transfer from A.A.W.S.				0
Transfer to General Fund				(1,300,000)
Investment Income				558,863
Balance, December 31				<u>\$6,462,136</u>
() denotes red figures				

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund, and the basis of such allocation. "It should be remembered that this distribution of expense is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not as to the individual accounts."

The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1988

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund		General Service Office Total
		Office	Other	
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$8,107,743			\$8,107,743
Discounts	(346,298)			(346,298)
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>7,761,445</u>			<u>7,761,445</u>
Cost of printing	(3,130,928)			(3,130,928)
Royalties	(872,854)			(872,854)
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	<u>3,757,663</u>			<u>3,757,663</u>
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$3,900,327		3,900,327
Interest income	7,524	14,681		22,205
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>3,765,187</u>	<u>3,915,008</u>	<u>\$ - 0 -</u>	<u>7,680,195</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,348,690	1,698,796		3,047,486
Pension/retirement expense	208,640			208,640
Rent and electric	333,931	245,301		579,232
Box 4-5-9		142,617		142,617
A.A. Directories		95,757		95,757
Other service materials		283,152		283,152
Shipping and mailing	1,112,445			1,112,445
Other office expenses	70,018	587,339		657,357
Insurance and payroll taxes		587,724		587,724
Professional services	136,525		23,000	159,525
Board, committee and staff meetings	57,675	8,746	129,411	195,832
Writers' fees	65,997			65,997
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	12,852		92,295	105,147
General Service Conference		241,937		241,937
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	67,415		513,926	581,341
Regional Forums and other			96,331	96,331
Film development			28,472	28,472
EDP system review			26,944	26,944
Leasehold improvements			20,756	20,756
Self-support project			12,843	12,843
Foreign literature assistance (net)	84			84
World Service Meeting (every other year)			59,579	59,579
Board sponsored international visits			65,329	65,329
<u>Total Expenses</u>	<u>3,414,272</u>	<u>3,891,369</u>	<u>1,068,886</u>	<u>8,374,527</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>350,915</u>	<u>23,639</u>	<u>(1,068,886)</u>	<u>(694,332)</u>
NOTE:				
Extraordinary expenses:				
Computer system acquisition			513,926	513,926
NET OPERATING INCOME (EXPENSE) exclusive of extraordinary expenses	<u>350,915</u>	<u>23,639</u>	<u>(554,960)</u>	<u>(180,406)</u>
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND				
Balance, January 1				\$6,961,426
Transfer from A.A.W.S.				450,000
Transfer to General Fund				(760,000)
Investment Income				551,847
Balance, December 31				<u>\$7,203,273</u>
() denotes red figures				

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund, and the basis of such allocation. "It should be remembered that this distribution of expense is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not as to the individual accounts."

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1989

	1989	1988
INCOME — from magazine and other sales	<u>\$2,133,241</u>	<u>\$1,900,718</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including temporary help	\$185,866	\$196,140
Printing	261,880	230,337
Mailing — service	81,933	89,126
postage	183,037	167,561
Other production costs	211,023	190,715
Occupancy costs	84,650	78,738
Magazine indexing project	10,000	—
Office supplies and other	<u>9,690</u>	<u>13,682</u>
<u>Total</u>	1,028,079	966,299
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	451,801	336,086
Data processing costs	19,800	19,374
Stationery and supplies	8,414	10,004
Occupancy costs	84,650	78,710
Office expense, including agency fees	21,706	15,355
Selling expense — Regular	55,196	48,157
GvR program	17,566	30,306
Postage	<u>79,985</u>	<u>52,705</u>
<u>Total</u>	739,118	590,697
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	3,996	3,996
Insurance	102,237	68,236
Professional fees	19,053	21,039
Payroll taxes	44,904	40,694
Meetings and conferences	22,033	18,527
Furniture and equipment	12,321	4,054
Contribution to Retirement Plan	17,496	19,107
Canadian exchange and other	2,328	3,916
Compensation study	<u>1,505</u>	<u>18,952</u>
<u>Total</u>	225,873	198,521
<u>Total Costs and Expenses</u>	<u>\$1,993,070</u>	<u>\$1,755,517</u>
<u>Income from Operations</u>	140,171	145,201
<u>Interest earned</u>	<u>93,028</u>	<u>66,757</u>
<u>Net Income for Year</u>	<u><u>233,199</u></u>	<u><u>211,958</u></u>

The General Service Office and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

December 31, 1989

	December 31, 1989		December 31, 1988	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
OPERATING FUNDS				
Assets				
Cash — checking accounts	\$ 592,942	\$ 59,530	\$ 268,764	\$ 233,120
Short-term cash investments	985,077	406,187	273,513	162,985
S/T cash investment — segregated for royalties	869,825	—	—	—
Investment (Note C)	—	917,941	—	767,941
Accounts receivable	157,435	103,520	100,569	75,718
Due from Grapevine	31,761	—	804	—
Inventories	1,417,215	131,368	1,772,060	157,571
Prepaid expenses and deposits	664,677	45,868	241,630	48,946
<u>Total Assets</u>	<u>4,718,932</u>	<u>1,664,414</u>	<u>2,657,340</u>	<u>1,446,281</u>
Deduct Liabilities				
Accounts and accruals payable	2,628,772	69,976	1,083,636	107,540
Deferred income	453,678	1,119,765	32,411	1,097,267
<u>Total Liabilities</u>	<u>3,082,450</u>	<u>1,189,741</u>	<u>1,116,047</u>	<u>1,204,807</u>
Net Worth				
Balance, January 1	1,541,293	241,474	1,925,625	29,516
Net income (loss) (Exhibits A and B)	(1,204,811)	233,199	(694,332)	211,958
Transfer (to) from Reserve Fund (net)	1,300,000	—	310,000	—
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>1,636,482</u>	<u>474,673</u>	<u>1,541,293</u>	<u>241,474</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION OR FUND				
Publishing — A.A. World Services, Inc. (Note A)	\$1,579,469		\$1,484,280	
General Fund — G.S.B. (Note B)	57,013		57,013	
Total Operating Funds — as above	1,636,482		1,541,293	
Reserve Fund	6,462,136		7,203,273	
<u>Total Net Worth</u>	<u>8,098,618</u>		<u>8,744,566</u>	
RESERVE FUND				
Cash	—		\$ 277	
Short term cash investments	\$489,270		827,104	
Due from (to) A.A. Grapevine	(75,500)		(57,500)	
U.S. Treasury obligations	6,804,483		7,048,297	
Accrued interest	161,824		153,036	
Less: Liability for Grapevine subscribers	(917,941)		(767,941)	
Balance, December 31	<u>6,462,136</u>		<u>7,203,273</u>	
() denotes red figures				

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. NOTES TO FINANCIAL STATEMENTS, DECEMBER 31, 1989

NOTE A — PURPOSES AND RESTRICTIONS OF DIFFERENT FUNDS

The RESERVE FUND was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which, during 1977, was re-defined as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The 1977 General Service Conference also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and, since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. were amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers and, therefore, reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund.

The GENERAL FUND comprises assets not included in any of the other funds and which may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed.

NOTE B — After transfers of \$1,354,112 in 1989 and \$285,247 in 1988 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE C — Grapevine investment with Reserve Fund — \$917,941, represents the deferred subscription income of the Grapevine at December 31, 1979, plus subsequent net investments of \$437,221 as shown below:

	Investment (Withdrawal)
1981	\$ (100,000)
1983	13,418
1984	60,000
1985	60,000
1986	52,803
1987	51,000
1988	150,000
1989	150,000
	<u>437,221</u>

The attached financial statements and above notes have been prepared from the reports on the three separate corporations submitted by our independent certified public accountants.

The General Service Office

1990 BUDGET

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Office	Other	General Service Office Total
INCOME				
Sales of literature	\$11,115,300			\$11,115,300
Discounts	(491,000)			(491,000)
<u>Net Sales</u>	<u>10,624,300</u>			<u>10,624,300</u>
Cost of products	(3,872,800)			(3,872,800)
Royalties	(1,176,000)			(1,176,000)
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	<u>5,575,500</u>			<u>5,575,500</u>
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$4,100,000		4,100,000
International Convention			\$ 47,400	47,400
Interest income	<u>20,000</u>	<u>10,000</u>		<u>30,000</u>
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>5,595,500</u>	<u>4,110,000</u>	<u>47,400</u>	<u>9,752,900</u>
EXPENSES				
Salaries	1,604,900	1,950,300		3,555,200
Pension/retirement expense	175,200		22,000	197,200
Rent and electric	382,000	280,600		662,600
Box 4-5-9		167,500		167,500
A.A. Directories		39,800		39,800
Other service materials		331,500		331,500
Shipping and mailing	1,133,200			1,133,200
Other office expenses	69,300	577,400		646,700
Insurance and payroll taxes		727,000		727,000
Professional services	65,900		26,100	92,000
Board, committee and staff meetings	49,800	13,500	137,000	200,300
Writers' fees	124,300			124,300
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	10,000		127,200	137,200
General Service Conference		316,300		316,300
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	143,800		232,000	375,800
Regional Forums and other			133,900	133,900
Film development			33,600	33,600
Leasehold improvements			- 0 -	- 0 -
Self-Support Project			11,900	11,900
Foreign literature assistance (net)	109,100			109,100
World Service Meeting (every other year)			55,000	55,000
Board sponsored international visits			5,000	5,000
Relocation/Renovation			400,000	400,000
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>3,867,500</u>	<u>4,403,900</u>	<u>1,183,700</u>	<u>9,455,100</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>1,728,000</u>	<u>(293,900)</u>	<u>(1,136,300)</u>	<u>297,800</u>
NOTE:				
Extraordinary expenses:				
Computer system acquisition			232,000	232,000
Relocation/Renovation			400,000	400,000
NET OPERATING INCOME (EXPENSE) exclusive of extraordinary expenses	<u>1,728,000</u>	<u>(293,900)</u>	<u>(504,300)</u>	<u>929,800</u>
CHANGES IN RESERVE FUND — PROJECTION				
Balance, January 1, 1990				\$6,462,100
Transfer from A.A.W.S.				0
Transfer to General Fund				0
Investment Income — estimated				517,000
Balance, December 31, 1990				<u>6,979,100</u>
() denotes red figures				

In the annual report prepared by our outside Certified Public Accountant the following comment is made regarding total office expenses, the allocation between A.A. World Services, Inc., and the General Fund, and the basis of such allocation. "It should be remembered that this distribution of expense is deemed to be fair and reasonable as to total expenses only, and not as to the individual accounts."

1990 G.S.O. Budget

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC. — PUBLISHING

Income: The sales income budget of \$11,115,300 is \$2,439,100 (28.1%) greater than 1989. This reflects price increases effective 1/1/90, and a conservative estimate of unit growth. The increase was planned to restore a sufficient gross profit on literature sales.

Expenses: Expenses charged against the publishing operation are budgeted at \$3,867,500, about 7.4% higher than 1989 actual.

Net: Net publishing income is expected to be \$1,728,000, an increase of \$1,579,700 over 1989. The substantially higher net planned for 1990 over 1989, is required to offset the anticipated shortfall as well as the balance of the computer project, and provision for possible relocation/renovation.

GENERAL FUND — GROUP SERVICES

Income: The budget reflects a conservative projection of 1.1% increase in contributions over 1989 (1989 had a 3.9% increase over 1988, following 1988's 6.8% increase over 1987).

Expenses: Total group expenses to be directly charged against contributions are budgeted to be \$4,403,900, \$69,800 less than 1989. This results in an anticipated shortfall of these expenses charged against contributions of \$303,900.

GENERAL FUND — OTHER EXPENSES

Other expenses of the General Service Board are budgeted at \$1,183,700. This includes extraordinary expenses of \$232,000 towards the completion of the implementation of the new computer system and \$400,000 set aside as a contingency for possible Relocation/Renovation expenses anticipated in 1990 (our lease expires 3/31/91). Exclusive of these two items, Other Expenses are budgeted \$111,300 higher than 1989. This increase is mainly attributed to the cost of a fifth Regional Forum and the World Service Meeting. The *total* Other Expenses, including the extraordinary expenses, is budgeted to be offset by the excess net publishing income, as well as an anticipated modest projected net income from the International Convention in Seattle of \$47,400.

RECAP

The shortfall for 1990 "Group Services" (as defined by the 1986 General Service Conference) supported by group contributions, is budgeted to be \$855,600. It is anticipated that the net publishing income will offset the shortfall and the extraordinary expenses and that no drawdown from the Reserve Fund is planned for 1990.

1990 Grapevine Budget

Total revenue: The 1990 budget shows revenues of \$2,024,000, including anticipated net revenues from International Convention activities of \$59,000. This anticipates paid subscriptions of almost 133,000, a price increase effective with the 6/90 issue, and \$565,000 in revenue from sale of special items.

Total expenses: Editorial and printing costs are budgeted at \$1,034,100, \$6,020 (0.6%) over 1989 actual. Printing of the magazine shows a negligible increase, a result of being able to hold the line of the printing contract and anticipating lower paper costs. Production costs of other materials is up slightly based on a 50% reduction in *Language of the Heart* sales this year.

Total Circulation and Business expenses are budgeted at \$773,500, \$34,430 (4.7%) over 1989 actual.

Total General and Administrative expenses are budgeted at \$283,500, \$57,630 (20.3%) over 1989 actual. General and Administrative expenses are up significantly due to anticipated costs for insurance, retirement fund, and indexing project being higher than 1989.

Total Costs and Expenses are budgeted at \$2,091,150, \$98,080 (4.9%) higher than 1989.

Net: After including interest income of \$87,000 we show a modest net income of \$19,850.

COMPARISON OF SHORTFALL OF 'GROUP SERVICES' SUPPORTED BY GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS

April 1986 Conference Advisory Action 16.a:

16. The area delegates strongly consider implementation of the following suggestions to improve contributions to G.S.O., area assemblies, districts, and central or inter-group offices:

- G.S.O. make available to all delegates an itemized list of group service expenses and other expenses of the board, combined into one total, representing group services supported by group contributions.

The following is a recap of these lists [detailed reports appear in delegates' Manual and *Final Conference Report*]:

1988

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$3,900,327
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$3,891,369		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board		\$1,068,886	
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Computer Acquisition	(513,926)	554,960	4,446,329
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(546,002)</u>

1989

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$4,054,111
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$4,473,643		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board		\$947,818	
Less: Extraordinary Expenses:			
Computer Acquisition	(507,379)	440,439	4,914,082
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(859,971)</u>

1990 BUDGET

Contributions — A.A. Groups & Members			\$4,100,000
General Fund — Office Expenses	\$4,403,900		
General Fund — Other Expenses of the Board		\$1,183,700	
Less: Extraordinary Exp.			
Relocation/Renovation	(400,000)		
Computer Acquisition	(232,000)	551,700	4,955,600
<u>Shortfall of "group services" supported by group contributions</u>			<u>(855,600)</u>

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

1990 BUDGET

	1990	
INCOME — from magazine and other sales		\$1,965,000
— Convention activities (net)		<u>59,000</u>
		<u>2,024,000</u>
 EDITORIAL AND PRINTING		
Salaries, including part-time and temporary help	\$198,850	
Printing	274,000	
Mailing — service	85,000	
— postage	195,000	
Other production costs	179,250	
Occupancy costs	88,000	
Office supplies and expenses	6,500	
Other editorial expenses	<u>7,500</u>	
<u>Total</u>		1,034,100
 CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including part-time and temporary help	483,050	
Computer processing costs	12,000	
Stationery and supplies	9,000	
Occupancy costs	88,000	
Office expense	18,500	
Selling expense — regular	70,000	
— GvR program	30,000	
Postage	<u>63,000</u>	
<u>Total</u>		773,550
 GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Indexing project	25,000	
Organization/Compensation review	5,000	
Consultant fee	4,000	
Insurance	112,000	
Professional fees	23,500	
Payroll taxes	53,000	
Meetings, conferences and travel	23,000	
Furniture and equipment — normal operations	5,000	
Contribution to Retirement Fund	30,000	
Canadian exchange	1,000	
Bad debts	<u>2,000</u>	
<u>Total</u>		<u>283,500</u>
 TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES		<u>2,091,150</u>
 INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS		(67,150)
Interest earned		<u>87,000</u>
 NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR YEAR		<u><u>19,850</u></u>

() denotes red figures

(For Management Presentation Only)

The General Service Office

INCOME STATEMENT

Year Ended December 31, 1989

	A.A.W.S. Publishing	A.A. G.S.B. General Fund Service Expenses	General Service Office Total
INCOME			
Sales of literature	\$8,676,200		\$8,676,200
Discounts	<u>(387,300)</u>		<u>(387,300)</u>
<u>Net Sales</u>	8,288,900		8,288,900
Cost of products	(3,636,100)		(3,636,100)
Royalties	<u>(901,100)</u>		<u>(901,100)</u>
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	3,751,700		3,751,700
Contributions — A.A. groups and members		\$4,054,100	4,054,100
Interest income	<u>—0—</u>	<u>13,200</u>	<u>13,200</u>
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>3,751,700</u>	<u>4,067,300</u>	<u>7,819,000</u>
EXPENSES			
Salaries	1,072,500	2,138,600	3,211,100
Pension/retirement expense	84,500	167,300	251,800
Rent and electric	358,000	263,000	621,000
Box 4-5-9		160,300	160,300
A.A. Directories		88,500	88,500
Other service materials		322,000	322,000
Shipping and mailing	870,400	392,900	1,263,300
Other office expenses	392,000	324,700	716,700
Insurance and payroll taxes	255,800	510,000	765,800
Professional services	57,200	29,400	86,600
Board, committee and staff meetings	77,800	134,300	212,100
Writers' fees	113,900		113,900
P.I.C., C.P.C.C., travel	15,100	95,400	110,500
General Service Conference		341,800	341,800
EDP system development, equipment, etc.	21,200	49,600	70,800
Regional Forums and other		103,600	103,600
Film development		25,900	25,900
Leasehold improvements	2,200	1,200	3,400
World Service Meeting (every other year)		—0—	—0—
Self-Support Project		32,900	32,900
Board Expense — Int'l. Visits		400	400
Foreign literature assistance (net)	14,000		14,000
Computer Acquisition		<u>507,400</u>	<u>507,400</u>
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>3,334,600</u>	<u>5,689,200</u>	<u>9,023,800</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	<u>417,100</u>	<u>(1,621,900)</u>	<u>(1,204,800)</u>

NOTE:

Extraordinary expenses: Computer system acquisition	<u>507,400</u>	<u>507,400</u>
Net Operating Income (Expense) exclusive of extraordinary expenses	<u>417,100</u>	<u>(1,114,500)</u>
		<u>(697,400)</u>

() denotes red figures

Footnote: This report reflects an allocation of costs based on a more direct costing assumption. Salaries were used as the basis for most "allocable" costs. Direct salaries for the publishing operation and services costs were arrived at first with the balance of administrative salaries distributed according to the relationship of the direct salaries. Related "allocable" costs, such as payroll taxes, insurance, and pension expension, were distributed according to the salary distribution. The allocation of other items were determined on a line by line basis. This particular reallocation results in a greater shortfall than methods previously used. It should be noted that this report has been created for illustrative purposes only.

1989 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA	AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	372	236	63.4%	\$ 21,983.95	5,310	\$4.14	60.	West	648	362	55.9	43,789.11	9,350	4.68
2.	Alaska	205	91	44.4	8,870.27	2,669	3.32	61.	Rhode Island	209	131	62.7	17,926.87	4,286	4.18
3.	Arizona	703	385	54.8	45,914.65	12,105	3.79	62.	South Carolina	258	181	70.2	21,682.36	4,331	5.01
4.	Arkansas	231	153	66.2	12,031.06	3,474	3.46	63.	South Dakota	141	69	48.9	4,654.08	2,958	1.57
5.	California							64.	Tennessee	431	218	50.6	27,303.69	6,977	3.91
5.	Southern	1,633	811	49.7	135,584.63	55,081	2.46		Texas						
6.	N. Coastal	1,815	1,189	65.5	173,076.65	45,901	3.77	65.	Northeast	392	237	60.5	43,842.91	11,536	3.80
7.	N. Interior	585	314	53.7	39,358.86	13,402	2.94	66.	Northwest	227	133	58.6	13,609.61	5,520	2.47
8.	San Diego/Imp.	639	360	56.3	41,973.55	17,693	2.37	67.	Southeast	483	252	52.2	33,750.86	12,794	2.64
9.	Mid-South	1,445	793	54.9	85,789.76	45,037	1.90	68.	Southwest	453	237	52.3	32,507.51	8,289	3.92
10.	Colorado	571	359	62.9	46,985.24	13,298	3.53	69.	Utah	234	155	66.2	15,254.63	4,095	3.73
11.	Connecticut	1,105	590	53.4	90,861.82	23,271	3.90	70.	Vermont	199	99	49.7	15,134.14	3,377	4.48
12.	Delaware	148	99	66.9	17,259.11	2,450	7.04	71.	Virginia	969	601	62.0	87,861.21	18,643	4.71
13.	D.C.	358	229	64.0	47,014.16	11,720	4.01	72.	Washington	1,080	621	57.5	80,266.01	19,915	4.03
14.	Florida							73.	West Virginia	253	148	58.5	11,345.38	2,876	3.94
14.	North	514	317	61.7	49,920.14	9,030	5.53		Wisconsin						
15.	South/							74.	N. Wis./Upper						
16.	Bahamas/V.I.	1,334	713	53.4	102,570.17	22,875	4.48		Pen. Mich.	576	279	48.4	24,858.61	8,645	2.88
17.	Georgia	604	471	78.0	66,511.37	13,070	5.09	75.	South	790	455	57.6	39,729.04	14,463	2.75
18.	Hawaii	225	168	74.7	25,535.41	4,119	6.20	76.	Wyoming	130	78	60.0	6,859.94	1,973	3.48
19.	Idaho	177	99	55.9	8,029.08	2,309	3.48	77.	Puerto Rico	115	68	59.1	4,644.07	1,478	3.14
20.	Illinois							78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	536	257	47.9	32,517.21	6,930	4.69
21.	Chicago	944	431	45.7	63,992.11	22,068	2.90	79.	B.C./Yukon	650	377	58.0	46,193.12	9,984	4.63
22.	North	812	403	49.6	39,113.85	15,111	2.59	80.	Manitoba	155	70	45.2	8,789.99	3,648	2.41
23.	South	392	192	49.0	23,421.41	6,573	3.56	81.	N.B./P.E.I.	220	109	49.5	7,238.91	3,172	2.28
24.	Indiana							82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	263	140	53.2	11,158.64	2,974	3.75
25.	North	550	280	50.9	28,175.74	8,607	3.27		Ontario						
26.	South	352	217	61.6	24,696.93	7,076	3.49	83.	East	537	289	53.8	50,550.02	12,399	4.08
27.	Iowa	637	361	56.7	35,252.53	12,071	2.92	84.	Northeast	183	70	38.3	12,095.77	2,223	5.44
28.	Kansas	372	223	59.9	21,917.80	8,820	2.49	85.	Northwest	89	38	42.7	5,288.31	1,335	3.96
29.	Kentucky	503	318	63.2	55,362.28	7,751	7.14	86.	West	441	233	52.8	37,564.20	7,426	5.06
30.	Louisiana	486	252	51.9	26,209.17	8,524	3.07		Quebec						
31.	Maine	392	198	50.5	22,691.05	6,973	3.25	87.	Southwest	565	459	81.2	34,037.10	14,605	2.33
32.	Maryland	753	423	56.2	59,077.20	10,760	5.49	88.	Southeast	236	189	80.0	29,099.41	3,327	8.75
33.	Massachusetts							89.	Northeast	350	280	80.0	20,455.94	6,492	3.15
34.	East	1,165	614	52.7	117,503.93	36,802	3.19	90.	Northwest	341	314	92.0	63,266.78	5,947	10.64
35.	West	187	109	58.3	21,914.87	4,456	4.92	91.	Saskatchewan	335	180	53.7	14,726.76	4,318	3.41
36.	Michigan								Total U.S./						
37.	Central	464	251	54.1	39,735.67	9,952	3.99		Canada	47,973	26,963 ^①	56.2% ^①	\$3,551,500.33 ^②	978,982	\$3.63 ^②
38.	Southeast	517	279	54.0	49,583.20	11,653	4.25		Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				195,169.04		
39.	West	391	205	52.4	33,298.63	7,342	4.54		Specials				272,089.37		
40.	Minnesota								Total for U.S. & Canada				\$4,018,758.74		
41.	North	499	303	60.7	22,048.15	7,829	2.82		FOREIGN AND OTHER						
42.	South	921	459	49.8	41,024.12	25,345	1.62		Birds of a Feather				60.00		
43.	Mississippi	223	125	56.1	8,345.14	2,843	2.94		Correctional facility groups				151.13		
44.	Missouri								Foreign				20,473.68		
45.	East	506	279	55.1	31,892.30	7,559	4.22		International Advisory Council of Young People in A.A.				11,570.00		
46.	West	223	147	65.9	18,187.66	4,966	3.66		International Doctors in A.A.				25.00		
47.	Montana	333	158	47.4	13,006.19	4,142	3.14		Internationalist groups				8.50		
48.	Nebraska	687	391	56.9	49,810.49	12,627	3.94		Internationalists				145.00		
49.	Nevada	296	155	52.4	14,938.52	4,863	3.07		Loners				911.40		
50.	New Hampshire	405	197	48.6	23,853.54	5,564	4.29		Treatment facility meetings				1,880.70		
51.	New Jersey								World Hello				127.01		
52.	North	1,129	563	49.9	85,730.10	24,860	3.45		Grand Total				\$4,054,111.16		
53.	South	343	204	59.5	32,882.98	5,354	6.14								
54.	New Mexico	276	157	56.9	14,216.35	4,109	3.46								
55.	New York														
56.	Central	584	305	52.2	55,833.75	9,028	6.18								
57.	H.M./B.	601	298	49.6	32,406.46	7,440	4.36								
58.	Southeast	1,541	846	54.9	179,733.94	42,171	4.26								
59.	West	249	115	46.2	12,531.04	3,625	3.46								
60.	N. Carolina/Ber.	705	471	66.8	67,256.37	11,043	6.09								
61.	North Dakota	175	90	51.4	5,244.80	2,961	1.77								
62.	Ohio														
63.	Cent. & S.E.	507	272	53.6	25,299.16	5,947	4.25								
64.	Northeast	974	323	33.2	29,574.91	22,843	1.29								
65.	N.W. Ohio/														
66.	S.E. Mich.	231	127	55.0	16,172.98	3,160	5.12								
67.	S.W. Ohio	420	247	58.8	26,165.58	7,778	3.36								
68.	Oklahoma	364	268	73.6	27,449.61	5,125	5.36								
69.	Oregon	645	353	54.7	39,435.22	9,558	4.13								
70.	Pennsylvania														
71.	East	1,066	648	60.8	99,242.53	24,603	4.03								

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

② Group contributions reported on this schedule do not include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1989-1988

(in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. & Canada 1989	47,973	26,963 ^①	56.2% ^①	\$3,551,500.33 ^②	978,982	\$3.63
U.S. & Canada 1988	45,442	25,214 ^①	55.5	3,314,582.18 ^②	916,782	3.62
Increase (Decrease)	2,531	1,749	0.7%	\$ 236,918.15	62,200	\$0.01

1989 Total Contributions — by State / Province

U.S.	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA	CANADA (stated in Canadian dollars)	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alabama	271	170	62.7%	\$ 18,746.19	4,097	\$4.58	Alberta	471	232	49.3%	40,674.68\$	6,184	6.58\$
Alaska	205	91	44.4	10,286.73	2,669	3.85	Atlantic Provinces						
Arizona	682	367	53.8	53,686.01	11,948	4.49	New Brunswick	163	80	49.1	6,311.71	2,119	2.98
Arkansas	230	154	67.0	13,537.20	3,468	3.90	Newfoundland	98	42	42.9	4,664.64	880	5.30
California	6,177	3,503	56.7	544,881.94	179,194	3.04	Nova Scotia	166	97	58.4	10,047.96	2,083	4.82
Colorado	571	359	62.9	63,919.84	13,298	4.81	Prince Edward Island	74	36	48.6	3,172.60	1,275	2.49
Connecticut	1,115	600	53.8	114,087.58	23,571	4.84	Labrador	2	1	50.0	70.00	44	1.59
Delaware	145	97	66.9	18,699.36	2,378	7.86	British Columbia	685	396	57.8	67,831.53	10,432	6.50
District of Columbia	165	87	52.7	22,819.26	5,529	4.13	Manitoba	155	70	45.2	11,258.67	3,648	3.09
Florida	1,929	1,091	56.6	201,589.07	32,985	6.11	N.W. Territories	28	8	28.6	743.26	284	2.62
Georgia	604	471	78.0	68,691.40	13,070	5.26	Ontario	1,209	600	49.6	134,073.70	22,777	5.89
Hawaii	225	168	74.7	32,453.43	4,119	7.88	Quebec	1,469	1,245	84.8 ①	162,098.72	28,777	5.63
Idaho	222	117	52.7	9,558.45	2,748	3.48	Saskatchewan	336	180	53.6	21,530.82	4,337	4.96
Illinois	2,148	1,026	47.8	151,333.78	43,733	3.46	Yukon Territory	10	3	30.0	1,190.00	109	10.92
Indiana	935	522	55.8	67,849.00	16,166	4.20	TOTAL for (Canadian CANADA dollars)	4,866	2,990①	61.4%①	463,668.29\$	82,949	5.59\$①
Iowa	637	361	56.7	41,043.07	12,064	3.40	(converted to U.S. dollars \$				404,462.32		\$4.88)
Kansas	370	222	60.0	24,655.95	8,794	2.80	TOTAL for U.S. (U.S. and CANADA dollars)	47,973	26,963①	56.2%①	\$4,018,758.74	978,982	\$4.11①
Kentucky	472	294	62.3	64,234.00	7,363	8.72							
Louisiana	487	252	51.7	28,928.70	8,537	3.39							
Maine	381	192	50.4	24,726.59	6,854	3.61							
Maryland	940	559	59.5	92,187.60	16,863	5.47							
Massachusetts	1,380	730	52.9	148,711.54	41,607	3.57							
Michigan	1,545	803	52.0	134,973.56	31,363	4.30							
Minnesota	1,416	757	53.5	73,023.81	32,922	2.22							
Mississippi	221	125	56.6	8,537.64	2,811	3.04							
Missouri	729	426	58.4	57,507.90	12,567	4.58							
Montana	333	158	47.4	13,528.23	4,142	3.27							
Nebraska	687	391	56.9	57,581.37	12,627	4.56							
Nevada	251	137	54.6	14,133.51	4,181	3.38							
New Hampshire	404	197	48.8	27,991.94	5,530	5.06							
New Jersey	1,473	767	52.1	124,041.40	30,211	4.11							
New Mexico	278	160	57.6	15,909.41	4,033	3.94							
New York	2,982	1,566	52.5	313,664.40	62,144	5.05							
North Carolina	682	472	69.2	70,146.17	10,843	6.47							
North Dakota	176	90	51.1	7,766.71	2,972	2.61							
Ohio	2,115	963	45.5	107,826.25	39,064	2.76							
Oklahoma	367	268	73.0	32,049.55	5,163	6.21							
Oregon	649	356	54.9	44,309.42	9,611	4.61							
Pennsylvania	1,732	1,021	58.9	158,062.44	34,241	4.62							
Rhode Island	207	130	62.8	21,248.09	4,189	5.07							
South Carolina	258	181	70.2	23,834.67	4,331	5.50							
South Dakota	140	69	49.3	7,799.82	2,937	2.66							
Tennessee	429	217	50.6	31,335.89	6,966	4.50							
Texas	1,552	854	55.0	141,512.32	38,148	3.71							
Utah	237	156	65.8	16,456.95	4,133	3.98							
Vermont	201	100	49.8	16,977.60	3,423	4.96							
Virginia	976	606	62.1	96,307.62	18,788	5.13							
Washington	1,019	593	58.2	83,843.81	19,228	4.36							
West Virginia	241	141	58.5	11,881.61	2,752	4.32							
Wisconsin	1,224	682	55.7	69,442.84	21,542	3.22							
Wyoming	133	79	59.4	7,042.94	2,018	3.49							
Commonwealth of Puerto Rico	115	68	59.1	5,805.42	1,478	3.93							
Bahama Islands	10	1	10.0	75.00	139	.54							
Virgin Islands	9	5	55.6	2,424.44	263	9.22							
of U.S.	25	1	4.0	627.00	218	2.88							
Bermuda													
TOTAL for U.S.	43,107	23,973	55.6%	\$3,614,296.42	896,033	\$4.03							

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists submitted by areas).

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON 1989-1988 (IN U.S. DOLLARS)

	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. 1989	43,107	23,973	55.6%	\$3,614,296.42	896,033	\$4.03
U.S. 1988	40,693	22,487	55.9	3,504,486.77	835,489	4.19
Increase (Decrease)	2,414	1,486	(0.3%)	\$ 109,809.65	60,544	\$(.16)
Canada 1989	4,866	2,990①	61.4%①	\$ 404,462.32	82,949	\$4.88①
Canada 1988	4,749	2,727①	57.4 ①	362,263.35	81,293	4.46①
Increase (Decrease)	117	263	4.0%	\$ 42,198.97	1,656	.42
U.S. and Canada 1989	47,973	26,963①	56.2%①	\$4,018,758.74	978,982	\$4.11①
U.S. and Canada 1988	45,442	25,214①	55.5 ①	3,866,750.12	916,782	4.22①
Increase (Decrease)	2,531	1,749	0.7%	\$ 152,008.62	62,200	\$(.11)

1990 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

¹Robert Barros
Bobbie Coneen
Marty Garry
Jim McIntyre
Dan Peterson
²Karen Raschella-Norbert
Chuck Rice
Reba Warren

Secretary: Eileen Gatza

Finance

John Benson
John Evans
Jimmy Gann
²Ginny Jackson
Hazel King
¹Dick Mabery
Jack MacManus
Rich Sarahman

Secretary: Ed Gordon

Policy/Admissions

Ovila Blais
²Jim Drysdale
¹Robert FitzSimons
Pat Morehouse
Judy Mize
John O'Connor
John Sullivan
Maryann Wells

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

Treatment Facilities

²George Cerny
Clark Doane
Serge Filion
Garry McAuley
Juan Martinez
¹Annemarie Matulis
Berry Wild
Phyllis Wise

Acting Secretary: Sarah Price

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Mary Branche
P.J. Doherty
Lenette Dunham
Dan Gramke
Dooley Harris
¹Joe McCoy
Ann White
²Les Williams

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

Grapevine

Ruthann Cluna
Chuck Crist
Jim Engel
¹Katie Gellately
Paul Heindel
Bob Greenfield
Sam Sibley
Jerry Smith
²Lonnie Williams

Secretary: Ann Warner

Public Information

²Bobby Broussard
Maggie Cole
Tom Couzens
Herman Gremmel
Bob Jokela
Billy Mattingly
Rosemary Palmeri
¹Jan Petska

Secretary: Richard Bush

Trustees

Jean Bureau
²Frances Cherry
Roger Luther
Ken Johnston
Elvester McRucker
Vera Martin
Mike Oester
Crawford Poe
¹Beth Rabren

Secretary: John Grant

Correctional Facilities

George Biggs
Carol Casaleggio
²Roger Crist
Gareth Davis
Dorothy May
Pete McHugh
Jean-Claude Paquette
¹Frank Piazza

Secretary: Betty Liddle

Literature

Larry Anderson
Boyce Bengé
¹Bill Bungay
Guy Frigon
Rod Horn
²Mary Ann Huggins
Charlie Oakes
Susie Pigg
Patti Walters

Secretary: Joanie Moncrief

Report and Charter

Fred Barnett
²Carolyn Beaupre
Juan Benet
Melvin Blades
Pat Hagan
Bob McGill
Maxine Miller
¹Joyce Yourdon

Secretary: Pat Rosenstiel

1990 International Convention

Gareth Davis
Roger Luther
Bob McGill
Dorothy May
Judy Mize

Secretary: Lois Fisher

Pat Morehouse
Maxine Miller
John Sullivan
¹Lonnie Williams

1991 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Dan Peterson, W. Ontario	Martin Garry, New Hampshire
Cooperation With the Professional Community	P.J. Doherty, California, Mid-Souther	Lenette Dunham, Arizona
Correctional Facilities	Peter McHugh, Vermont	Dorohty May, S. Indiana
Finance	Jack MacManus, Rhode Island	John Benson, New York, H/M/B
Grapevine	Chuck Crist, Oregon	Ruthann Cluna, S. New Jersey
Literature	Susie Pigg, N.W. Texas	Rod Horn, South Dakota
Policy/Admissions	Ovila Blais, S.W. Quebec	Pat Morehouse, Manitoba
Public Information	Tom Couzens, Maryland	Maggie Cole, North Dakota
Report and Charter	Fred Barnett, California, Northern Interior	Bob McGill, S.W. Texas
Treatment Facilities	Clark Doane, Alaska	Garry McAuley, Alberta/N.W.T.
Committee on Trustees	Crawford Poe, South Carolina	Ken Johnson, Saskatchewan

¹ Chairperson

² Alternate Chairperson

1990 Trustees' Committees

Archives

John King, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Harold Greene
Thomas Hills
Jacqueline Martin
Jane Murphy Schulberg
Jan Kelly Williamson
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

Phil Cels, *chairperson*
Don Bruner
Hugh Freyer
Ruth Jagodzinski
Jacqueline Martin
John Sharkey
Jan Kelly Williamson
Jan Whitney
Eileen Gatza, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

John Hartley Smith, M.D., *chairperson*
Terry Barrett
Peter Brock
Don Bruner
John Nelson Chappel, M.D.
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Webb Johnson
Michael McPherson
Stanley Silverman
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

Amos Reed, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Don Bruner
John Nelson Chappel, M.D.
Ray McDermott
Olga Morris
John Quinn
Dennis Robbins
Jean Smith
Betty Liddle, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Robert Morse, *chairperson*
Phil Cels
William Croke
Hugh Freyer
Harold Greene
Gary Glynn
Tom Hills
John Quinn
Amos Reed
Stanley Silverman
Jean Smith
Jan Kelly Williamson
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Dennis Manders, *senior advisor*
Edward Gordon, *secretary*

International

Webb Johnson, *chairperson*
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Michael McPherson
Fran Polek
John Quinn
Amos Reed
Jane Murphy Schulberg
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Desmond Towey
Sarah Price, *secretary*

International Convention/ A.A. Regional Forums

Ruth Jagodzinski, *chairperson*
Harold Greene
Webb Johnson
Jacqueline Martin
Fran Polek
John Sharkey
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Jan Whitney
Lois Fisher, *secretary*
— *International Convention*
Pat Rosenstiel, *secretary*
— *Regional Forums*

Literature

William Croke, *chairperson*
Phil Cels
John Nelson Chappel, M.D.
John King
Jacqueline Martin
Michael McPherson
Fran Polek
Jean Smith
Jan Whitney
Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Joanie Moncrief, *secretary*

Nominating

Joan Jackson, Ph.D., *chairperson*
William Croke
Thomas Hills
Ruth Jagodzinski
Webb Johnson
John King
John Sharkey
Desmond Towey
Jan Whitney
John Grant, *secretary*

Public Information

Desmond Towey, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Jill Hargrave
Ruth Jagodzinski
Alicia Martinez
Edward McDougall
John Quinn
Mary Ann Ryan
Jane Murphy Schulberg
Richard Bush, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

John Sharkey, *chairperson*
John Nelson Chappel, M.D.
Hugh Freyer
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Robert Lewis
Nancy McComas
Amos Reed
Stanley Silverman
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Mike Kelley, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

John Hartley Smith, M.D.,
chairperson
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*
All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S., and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Michael Alexander and Wayne Parks are ex officio members of all committees.



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
Michael Alexander
First vice-chairperson
Joan Jackson, Ph.D.
Second vice-chairperson
John King
Secretary
Ruth Jagodzinski
Treasurer
Robert Morse
Assistant secretary
Helen Turnquest
Assistant treasurer
Edward H. Gordon
The new slate of officers
(post-Conference)
is given on page 39.

1990 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Michael Alexander (460 Park Ave., New York, NY 10022) was elected chairperson of the board at the meeting following the 1988 Conference. Mike served as a trustee from 1976 to 1985, after 20 years as legal advisor to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith—so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director and past president of the British American Chamber of Commerce, director and national secretary of the Ireland-United States Council for Commerce and Industry, and trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society.

John Nelson Chappel, M.D. (School of Medicine, University of Nevada, Reno, NV 89557) was elected to the board in 1989. A graduate of the University of Alberta Medical School, John has been professor of psychiatry, University of Nevada School of Medicine since 1974. He serves as consultant to many professional organizations and is widely published in the field of alcoholism. He serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Communities, Correctional Facilities, Literature, and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Joan K. Jackson, Ph.D. (72 Downs Rd., Bethany, CT 06525) was elected to the board in April 1983. A graduate of McGill University, Montreal, and the University of Washington, Seattle, Joan taught sociology at both universities for many years. She has served on many local, state and national boards and committees on alcoholism and on health and human behavior. At the University of Washington Medical School in Seattle, she was involved in research and teaching about alcoholism, A.A., and Al-Anon. Joan chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, International, and Treatment Facilities Committees.

John E. King (423 Hawthorn, Fayetteville, AR 72701) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of St. Mary's College, Kentucky, and Tulane University, Louisiana, John was an ordained priest and has a background in social work. Currently, he is on the faculty of the University of Arkansas in the Social Work Program, where he serves as consultant to many local, state, and regional agencies as well as in a treatment capacity. John has received numerous awards and honors for his professional and civic/community service. He chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the Literature and Nominating Committees, and the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Robert P. Morse (96 Cove Rd., Oyster Bay, NY 11771) was elected to the board in April 1984 after serving as a consultant to the Finance Committee from April 1981. A graduate of the Wharton School and the University of Pennsylvania, he has over 21 years' experience in the investment business, with an in-depth background in the fixed-income sector and management of equity portfolios. Robert is president of Morse Williams & Co., Inc., investment counselors, and is chairperson of the Wall Street Fund, a public mutual fund. He is also treasurer and an executive committee trustee of the Bermuda Biological Station for Research, Inc. Robert is chairperson of the Finance & Budgetary Committee.

Amos E. Reed (2840 Holiday Dr. S., Salem, OR 97302) was elected to the board in April 1986. A graduate of McKendree College and Northern Illinois University, he has extensive background in corrections, education, and public welfare. He is past president of the American Correctional Association, National Association of State Correctional Administrators, and National

Association of Training Schools and Juvenile Agencies, and has received many awards for his services in corrections and other agencies. Retired from his position as Washington Secretary of Corrections, Amos has also held leadership positions in North Carolina, Florida, Oregon, and Illinois. He chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the International, Treatment Facilities and Finance and Budgetary Committees.

John Hartley Smith, M.D. (828 West 10th Ave., Vancouver, B.C. V5Z 1L8, Canada) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of the Queens' University Medical School, Belfast, he has specialized in occupational medicine and public health and has served on many professional committees and advisory councils, both local and national. John has been assistant deputy minister in the British Columbia Ministry of Health since 1979; in 1986 he was appointed senior medical consultant in occupational and environmental health to the government. He was also a director of the American Board of Preventive Medicine and part-time clinical associate professor in the Faculty of Medicine at the University of British Columbia. John chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community Committee and serves on the International, International Convention/Regional Forums and Treatment Facilities Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Donald J. Bruner (6420 Bluff Dr., Bloomington, MN 55438) was elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in April 1988. Don has been active in area activities from home group to intergroup board member, and served as Panel 33 Conference delegate. He was trained as a civil engineer and was an officer of an international construction company and has served on the boards of several construction and engineering companies. Don, who is now retired, chairs the General Sharing Session of the quarterly board meetings, and serves on the Conference, C.P.C. and Correctional Facilities Committees and on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Phil J. Cels (5 Balmoral Bay, Brandon, Manitoba, R7A 6E5 Canada), who was elected Western Canada trustee in April 1988, served as a Panel 32 Conference delegate. He is involved in C.P.C. and P.I. work for Southwest Manitoba, as well as being active in local A.A. activities. Phil is in his 14th year as an account executive with a brokerage house. He chairs the Conference Committee, and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Literature Committees. Phil is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

William H. (Bill) Croke (165 Perry Ave., Norwalk, CT 06850) was elected general service trustee in April 1986. He has been active in service to the General Service Office since 1976, when he was first appointed to the trustees' Committee on Public Information, and has served as A.A.W.S. director since 1983. Bill's background is in advertising and marketing, communications, and he is currently a partner in a New York City advertising agency. Bill chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees. He is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Harold Greene (695 Americana Dr., #54, Annapolis, MD 21401) was elected general service trustee in April 1989. Harold's services commitment began at the group level in Staten Island, N.Y.; he

has served as a D.C.M. and as a member of the N.Y. Intergroup Steering Committee. From 1985-88 he was a director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Harold currently heads a Federal agency involved in developing and financing rehabilitation of housing for the homeless in the Maryland/Washington, D.C. area. He serves on the Archives, Finance & Budgetary and International Convention/Regional Forums Committees and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Thomas G. (Tom) Hills (48 McGregor Road, Scarborough, ON M1P 1C8, Canada) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1986. Tom has been active in group, intergroup, and area service and was a Panel 33 Conference delegate. He was formerly a director of Ontario's Employees Benefits Branch, and recently served as a senior advisor to the Ontario Pensions Advisory Board. Tom chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board. He also serves on the Archives, Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees.

Ruth C. Jagodzinski (PRN Home Health Care, Inc., 2600 S. Rainbow Blvd., Las Vegas, NV 89102), elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in April 1986, has been active in group, intergroup, and area service and was a Panel 29 Conference delegate. Ruth's background is in the home-health-care and nursing fields; she co-owns and administers a home-health-care program. She is a member of the governor's Advisory Board for Alcohol and Drug Abuse and vice-president of the We Care Foundation board of directors (a small rehabilitation house for alcoholic women). Ruth chairs the International Convention/Regional Forums Committee, and serves on the Conference, Nominating and Public Information Committees.

W.F. (Webb) Johnson (1105 Palmerston Ave., West Vancouver, BC V7S 2J5, Canada), elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1987, has served his area as G.S.R., D.C.M., area treasurer, and was a Panel 31 Conference delegate. A former stock broker and broker dealer, Webb is currently president of NTV Oil Services Industries, Inc. and director of Melinga Resources Ltd. He chairs the International Committee, and serves on the C.P.C., International Convention/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

Jacqueline Martin (1305 Bluff Springs Ct., Louisville, KY 40223) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 1989. A Panel 30 delegate, Jackie has been active in her area's intergroup and treatment facilities committees and is past president of the Kentucky Alcoholism Council. With a background in real estate, Jackie recently went back to school to prepare for a new career in management. She serves on the Archives, Conference, International Convention/Regional Forums and Literature Committees.

Greg Muth (P.O. Box 30068, Honolulu, Hawaii 96820) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in April 1990. Greg, who has been active from group coffee maker on, served as a Panel 37 delegate, when he chaired the Conference Report and Charter Committee. An executive of a commercial construction company, he is also involved in the Therapeutic Horsemanship Society.

Marc Pineau (185 - 14th Ave., Iberville, Quebec J2X 1B5, Canada), who was a Panel 36 delegate, was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1990. He has served as G.S.R., D.C.M. and area secretary and chair. Marc is an engineer with Westinghouse Canada, where he has participated in employees' programs, as well as setting up other rehabilitation programs.

John J. Quinn (66 Brookwood Pkwy., Jackson, NJ 08527) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1989. A Panel 35 delegate, he has also served his area as D.C.M., treasurer and area committee member. With a background in accounting, taxation and personnel, John is currently vice-president of a major international bank in New York City. He serves on the Correctional Facilities, Finance & Budgetary, International and Public Information Committees.

John A. Sharkey (9 Valley Way, West Orange, NJ 07052). Elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1987, John is a past area chairperson and was a Panel 33 Conference delegate. He currently serves on the Essex County Alcoholism Advisory Board and was trustee of his intergroup committee. John, who owned and operated a tavern for seven years, is supply coordinator with New Jersey Bell Telephone Company. He chairs the Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the Conference, International Convention/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

Stanley N. Silverman (137 E. 36th St., New York, NY 10016), who was elected a general service trustee in April 1989, served on the Grapevine editorial board and later on the Grapevine Corporate Board from 1983-87. Active at the group level, Stanley is a member of the American Institute of C.P.A.s and the New York State Society of C.P.A.s, and is a partner in a New York certified public accounting firm.

Jean Smith (100 Bank St., New York, NY 10014) was elected general service trustee in April 1990. Jean has served on the Grapevine editorial board and was an A.A.W.S. director from 1987 to 1990, when she served on several trustees' committees. She is a senior vice-president of St. Martin's Press, and director of their college division.

J. Desmond Towey (425 E. 58th St., #4H, New York, NY 10022) was elected general service trustee in April 1988. Des's introduction to service work was as a consultant on the trustees' Public Information Committee. He is owner and president of a firm specializing in shareholder relations and marketing financial products. Des chairs the Public Information Committee and serves on the International and Nominating Committees. He also serves on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Jan Whitney (9700 Avalon Rd., Greenville, MI 48838) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1989. A Panel 36 delegate, she has served as area secretary, chairperson for the area assembly, and program chair for area conferences. She also served as area Grapevine chairperson, and chaired the board of the local chapter of N.C.A. Now retired, Jan's professional background was in business and real estate. She serves on the Conference, International Convention/Regional Forums, Literature and Nominating Committees.

Jan Kelly Williamson (3208 Lampliter Place, El Paso, TX 79925), elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1987, has been active in her local intergroup, N.W. Texas Area, and in the Southwest Regional Delegate Assembly; she was a Panel 28 Conference delegate. A retired executive secretary, Jan is primarily involved with local A.A. She serves on the Archives, Conference and Finance & Budgetary Committees. Jan also chairs the A.A.W.S. Board.

¹ Rotating at the close of the 1990 Conference meeting.

² New trustee, elected by the General Service Board, April 28, 1990.

A.A. World Services Directors

Jan Kelly Williamson, *chairperson*
 Phil Cels
 William Croke
 Hugh Freyer
 Harold Greene

Michael McPherson
 Wayne Parks
 Jean Smith
 Helen Turnquest

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Thomas Hills, *chairperson*
 Bernard Benziger
 Don Bruner
 John King
 Fran Polek

Jane Murphy Schulberg
 Stanley Silverman
 Ames Sweet
 Desmond Towey
 Ann Warner

General Service Office Staff

Wayne Parks, *general manager*
 Richard Bush
 Lois Fisher
 Eileen Gatzka
 John Grant
 Tom Hubbard
 Betty Liddle
 Joanie Moncrief

Sarah Price
 Pat Rosenstiel
 Helen Turnquest
 Susan Ulseth
 Tom Jasper, *services director*
 Frank Mauser, *archivist*
 Vicente Mejia, *Spanish services*

Grapevine Staff

Ames Sweet Ann Warner

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Rosa Blanco, *financial secretary*
 Chris Bradley, *supervisor, data processing*
 Jenice Cameron, *Grapevine editorial secretary*
 Joseph Dennan, *staff assistant*
 John de Stefano, *editor*
 Yee Eng, *staff assistant*
 Lynda Ernst, *staff assistant*
 Catherine Femia, *staff assistant*
 Owen Flanagan, *independent C.P.A.*
 Edward Gordon, *director of finance/business administrator*
 Lee Halligan, *director, human resources*
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
 Margie Janicek, *clerical*
 John Kirwin Jr., *assistant controller*
 Steve Linek, *purchasing department*
 Elizabeth Lopez, *manager, staff assistant/clerical department*
 Irene Lump, *hotel coordinator*
 Vinnie McCarthy, *publications director*
 Jim McConnell, *designer, Conference Report*
 Don Meurer, *controller*
 John Naydich, *Grapevine art director*
 Edward Reilly, *data processing manager, systems & operations*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *staff assistant*
 Bob Scherer, *Grapevine controller*
 Frank Segui, *staff assistant*
 Darlene Smith, *staff assistant*
 Joan Smith, *staff assistant*
 Naomi Strassberg, *Grapevine administrative assistant*
 Gregg Talley, *events coordinator*
 Cynthia White, *staff assistant*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*

Trustees emeritus

Gordon Patrick

* Unable to attend Conference. Alternate delegate Bob Greenfield was seated.

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 40th Conference includes Panel 39 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 40 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	39	Jim Drysdale, 739 Milgray Ln., Bessemer, AL 35020
Alaska	2	40	Clark Doane, 2253 Jack St., Fairbanks, AK 99709
Arizona	3	40	Lenette Dunham, 4351 W. Camino Pintoresco, Tucson, AZ 85745
Arkansas	4	39	Robert Barros, 10901 Yosemite Valley Dr., Little Rock, AR 72212
California Southern	5	39	Juan Martinez, 15769 Loukelton St., La Puente, CA 91744
Northern Coastal	6	39	Frank A. Piazza, 2201 Village Ct., #2, Belmont, CA 94002
Northern Interior	7	40	Fred Barnett, 1232 Hobson Ave., W. Sacramento, CA 95605
San Diego/Imperial	8	40	Barbara Coneen, 11203 Corte Playa Madera, San Diego, CA 92124
Mid-Southern	9	40	P. J. Doherty, 603 Ninth St., Hermosa Beach, CA 90254
Colorado	10	39	*Frank King, 5435 W. Leawood Dr., Littleton, CO 80123
Connecticut	11	39	Robert FitzSimons, 32 Lydia St., Waterbury, CT 06705
Delaware	12	40	Patricia Hagan, 26 Sanford Dr., Newark, DE 19713
District of Columbia	13	39	Ann White, 3639 Cousins Dr., Landover, MD 20785
Florida North	14	39	Jimmy Gann, 1544 Landon Ave., Apt. 2, Jacksonville, FL 32207
S. Florida/Bahamas/V.I.	15	39	Frances Cherry, 3901 S.E. St. Lucie Blvd., #14, Stuart, FL 34997
Georgia	16	40	Sam Sibley, Box 2843, Augusta, GA 30904
Hawaii	17	39	Lester Mabery, 217 Prospect St., D-11, Honolulu, HI 96813

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Idaho	18	40	Berry Wild, 1427 Manitou, Boise, ID 83706	Missouri Eastern	38	39	Ginny Jackson, 11597 Esperanza, Florissant, MO 63033
Illinois Chicago	19	39	James Engel, 315 N. Salem, Apt. 310, Arlington Heights, IL 60006	Western	39	39	John Sullivan, HC R81, Box 17-C, Cassville, MO 65625
Northern	20	40	Phyllis Wise, 234 S. Center St., Oneida, IL 61467	Montana	40	40	Maryann Wells, 413 E. Benham, Glendive, MT 59330
Southern	21	39	Herman Gremmels, RR #4, T5, Waterloo, IL 62298	Nebraska	41	40	Roger Luther, Box 147, Alda, NE 68810
Indiana Northern	22	39	Michael Oester, 1031 Tulip Ln., Lafayette, IN 47904	Nevada	42	39	Joyce Yourdon, 1850 Arcane, Reno, NV 89503
Southern	23	40	Dorothy May, 6121 N. Pershing Ave., Indianapolis, IN 46208	New Hampshire	43	40	Martin Garry, 55 Chapman St., Dracut, MA 01826
Iowa	24	39	Janet Petska, 814 E. Fifth St., Spencer, IA 51301	New Jersey Northern	44	39	Carol Casaleggio, 24 Portland Ave., Fanwood, NJ 07023
Kansas	25	40	John Evans, 6427 Jacqueline, Wichita, KS 67206	Southern	45	40	Ruthann Cluna, 6 Candle Court, R.R. 9, Vicentown, NJ 08088
Kentucky	26	40	Billy Mattingly, 3513 Donna Ln., Bardstown, KY 40004	New Mexico	46	40	George Biggs, 505 Oppenheimer Dr., #805, Los Alamos, NM 87544
Louisiana	27	39	Bobby Broussard, 106 Ave. C, Broussard, LA 70518	New York Central	47	39	Rosemary Palmeri, 12 Hilltop Dr., Pittsford, NY 14534
Maine	28	40	Guy Frigon, 171 E. Main St., Madawaska, ME 04756	Hudson/Mohawk /Berkshire	48	40	John Benson, Jr., 13-2C Lakeshore Dr., Watervliet, NY 12189
Maryland	29	40	Thomas Couzens, 407 Prince St., Salisbury, MD 21801	Southeast	49	39	Boyce Bengé, 153 Hancock St., Brooklyn, NY 11216
Massachusetts Eastern	30	39	Annemarie Matulis, 140 Myrtle St., Brockton, MA 02401	Western	50	40	Elvester McCrucker, 17 Hurlock Ave., Buffalo, NY 14211
Western	31	40	John O'Connor, 83 Miller St., Springfield, MA 01104	North Carolina/ Bermuda	51	39	Judy Mize, Box 5586, Cary, NC 27511
Michigan Central	32	39	Roger Crist, 1501 W. Stewart, Owosso, MI 48867	North Dakota	52	40	Maggie Cole, 2219 28th Ave. So., Fargo, ND 58103
Southeastern	33	39	George Cerny, 815 12th St., Port Huron, MI 48060	Ohio Central & Southeast	53	39	Melvin Blades, 358 Wilson Ave., Columbus, OH 43205
Western	34	40	Charles Oakes, 9520 Silver Creek Rd., Whitehall, MI 49461	Northeast	54	39	Mary Branche, 1882 Forest Hills Blvd., #4, E. Cleveland, OH 44112
Minnesota Northern	35	40	Robert Jokela, 1208 Mississippi Ave., Duluth, MN 55811	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	55	40	Richard Sarahman, 340 S. Reynolds Rd., Lot 28, Toledo, OH 43615
Southern	36	39	L.C. (Chuck) Rice, 2820 Jewel Ln., Plymouth, MN 55447	Southwest	56	40	Vera Martin, 8705 Tudor, Cincinnati, OH 45242
Mississippi	37	40	T.L. (Dooley) Harris, Box 1114, Batesville, MS 38606	Oklahoma	57	39	Joe McCoy, 6910 S. 32nd Ave., Tulsa, OK 74132
				Oregon	58	40	Charles Crist, 1010 N.E. Front, #M7, Portland, OR 97209

CANADA.

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Pennsylvania			
<i>Eastern</i>	59	39	Reba Warren, 5129 Knox St., Philadelphia, PA 19144
<i>Western</i>	60	39	*Maxine Miller, Box 124, Polk, PA 16342
Rhode Island	61	40	John (Jack) MacManus, 7 East St., Providence, RI 02906
South Carolina	62	40	Nelson Crawford Poe, Box 8856, Greenville, SC 29604
South Dakota	63	40	Rod Horn, 509 State, Belle Fourche, SD 57717
Tennessee	64	40	Larry Anderson, 160 Allen St., Lewisburg, TN 37091
Texas			
<i>Northeast</i>	65	39	Les Williams, 505 Cates Dr., Kaufman, TX 75142
<i>Northwest</i>	66	40	Sue Pigg, Box 311, Sanford, TX 79078-0311
<i>Southeast</i>	67	39	Beth Rabren, Rt. 4, 224 First St., Brazoria, TX 77422
<i>Southwest</i>	68	40	Bob McGill, Box 843, Refugio, TX 78377
Utah	69	39	Patricia Walters, 4939 Old Post Rd., #112, Ogden, UT 84403
Vermont	70	40	Peter McHugh, Box 1085, Stowe, VT 05672
Virginia	71	39	Mary Ann Huggins, 10317 Cherryview Ct., Oakton, VA 22124
Washington	72	39	Lonnie Williams, 4708 241st S.W., Mountlake Terrace, WA 98043
West Virginia	73	39	Jerry Smith, Box 2013, Huntington, WV 25720
Wisconsin			
<i>N. Wisconsin/ Up. Pen. Mich.</i>	74	40	Paul Heindel, 504 N. Margaret St., Kaukauna, WI 54130
<i>Southern</i>	75	39	Karen Raschella-Norbert, 2216 Kinzie Ave., Racine, WI 53405
Wyoming	76	40	Dan Gramke, 736 12th St., Evanston, WY 82930
Puerto Rico	77	40	Juan Benet, G.P.O. Box 3953, San Juan, PR 00936-3953

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/ Northwest Territories	78	40	Garry McAuley, 6115-51 Avenue, Stettler, AB T0C 2L0
British Columbia/ Yukon	79	39	Carolyn Beaupre, 1155 W. 11th Ave., Suite 104, Vancouver, BC V6H 1K4
Manitoba	80	40	Pat Morehouse, 3410 Van Horne St., Brandon, MB R7B 3H4
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	81	40	James MacIntyre, 1365 Golden Grove Rd., Saint John, NB E2L 3W4
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/ Labrador	82	39	William Bungay, 24 Johnsons Rd., Corner Brook, NF A2H 1V8
Ontario			
<i>Eastern</i>	83	39	Elizabeth (Katie) Gellately, Box 403, Long Sault, ON K0C 1P0
<i>Northeast</i>	84	39	Hazel King, 883 Tackaberry Dr., North Bay, ON P1B 4R8
<i>Northwest</i>	85	39	Gareth Davis, Box 1333, Red Lake, ON P0V 2M0
<i>Western</i>	86	40	Dan Peterson, 5315 Queen Elizabeth Dr., Windsor, ON N8T 1N2
Quebec			
<i>Southwest</i>	87	40	Ovila Blais, 8584A Cluny, St.-Leonard, PQ H1R 2X5
<i>Southeast</i>	88	39	Jean Bureau, 217 Route 281, St. Magloire de Bellechasse, PQ G0R 3M0
<i>Northeast</i>	89	39	Serge Filion, 1335, de la Belle-Vue, Cap Rouge, PQ G1Y 2S9
<i>Northwest</i>	90	40	Jean-Claude Paquette, 40, 43eme Ave., Montreal, PQ H1A 2Z9
Saskatchewan	91	40	Ken Johnston, Box 148, Grenfell, SK S0G 2B0



It made sense to me!
Herman Grinnick (Southern Illinois) is a member of the Waterloo Friday Night Group—they meet on Monday night.

* New Panel 39 delegate. Former delegate William Stigliano resigned due to health.

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- ___ FINANCIAL INFORMATION
- ___ ADVISORY ACTIONS
- ___ WORKSHOPS
- ___ PRESENTATIONS
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- ___ As a sponsor _____
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